
COMPLETE EDITION

The Teacher AI Toolkit

300 PROMPTS · 12 WORKFLOWS

Every chapter of the toolkit in one file, for reading offline or printing. The single chapter files are quicker to work from.

For K-12 classroom teachers

Works in ChatGPT, Claude and Gemini

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Index — all 300 prompts and 12 workflows

Every prompt has an ID like `LP-002`. Find the ID here, then open that chapter file.

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BY NAME

Lesson Planning

ID	PROMPT
LP-001	Build a complete evidence-led lesson
LP-002	Plan a unit backward from mastery
LP-003	Turn a standard into measurable objectives
LP-004	Create a matched warm-up and exit ticket
LP-005	Create a no-surprises substitute lesson
LP-006	Plan a concept-development lesson from prior knowledge
LP-007	Plan an inquiry lesson around a puzzling phenomenon
LP-008	Create an explicit-instruction lesson with guided release
LP-009	Design a discussion-centered lesson with equitable participation
LP-010	Build a no-technology lesson using basic classroom materials
LP-011	Create a lesson around one complex text or source
LP-012	Plan a safe hands-on investigation lesson
LP-013	Design a problem-based mathematics lesson
LP-014	Compress a full lesson into a purposeful 30-minute period
LP-015	Expand a lesson for a 90-minute block without filler
LP-016	Repair a draft lesson whose activities do not match its objective
LP-017	Unpack final mastery into a prerequisite learning map
LP-018	Design a final performance task before planning daily lessons
LP-019	Create a coherent lesson sequence from an approved assessment
LP-020	Place formative checkpoints and reteaching decisions across a unit
LP-021	Audit a unit for gaps, repetition and cognitive progression
LP-022	Shorten a unit while protecting its essential learning
LP-023	Add transfer and reflection to the end of a unit
LP-024	Separate knowledge, skill and reasoning within a standard
LP-025	Rewrite a technical objective as a student-friendly I-can statement
LP-026	Create observable success criteria for an existing objective
LP-027	Check whether an activity truly aligns to a supplied standard

ID	PROMPT
LP-028	Map several objectives into a logical teaching order
LP-029	Identify prerequisite skills without lowering the grade-level target
LP-030	Write evidence statements showing what mastery would look like
LP-031	Design a warm-up that exposes prior knowledge in five minutes
LP-032	Write a misconception-revealing hinge question
LP-033	Create an exit ticket with secure, developing and not-yet response bands
LP-034	Turn yesterday's exit-ticket patterns into today's opening task
LP-035	Build a retrieval-practice warm-up without introducing new content
LP-036	Create a transfer exit ticket that cannot be answered by copying
LP-037	Audit an exit ticket for alignment, ambiguity and reading load
LP-038	Build a realistic minute-by-minute lesson timeline
LP-039	Diagnose where a lesson is likely to run out of time
LP-040	Write concise transitions between lesson segments
LP-041	Create a pacing contingency when discussion runs long
LP-042	Plan meaningful early-finisher work connected to the objective
LP-043	Adapt one lesson for both a regular period and a shortened schedule
LP-044	Build an emergency no-print lesson from materials already in the room
LP-045	Write exact substitute directions that require no subject guessing
LP-046	Create a technology-failure backup for a digital lesson
LP-047	Prepare an independent catch-up lesson for an unexpected absence
LP-048	Audit a substitute plan for safety, clarity and collection procedures
LP-049	Launch a project with a clear driving question and final product
LP-050	Connect two subjects around one authentic problem
LP-051	Break a multiweek project into milestones and checkpoints
LP-052	Create individual accountability inside a group project
LP-053	Design a project rubric that measures learning rather than decoration
LP-054	Plan a public-product option that protects student privacy
LP-055	Turn lesson evidence into a next-day adjustment

ID	PROMPT
LP-056	Write a post-lesson reflection based on observations rather than feelings alone
LP-057	Identify what to keep, change and investigate after a lesson
LP-058	Adapt a lesson after most learners miss the same misconception
LP-059	Plan targeted follow-up for three anonymous response patterns
LP-060	Compare the intended lesson with what learners actually demonstrated

Worksheets and Activities

ID	PROMPT
WA-001	Build a focused practice worksheet
WA-002	Design four learning stations
WA-003	Create an accountable group task
WA-004	Build a review game that measures learning
WA-005	Create practice that moves from a model to independent work
WA-006	Write a worksheet that targets one common misconception
WA-007	Build mixed practice that requires learners to choose a strategy
WA-008	Create a short retrieval worksheet for previously taught skills
WA-009	Design an application worksheet using realistic classroom contexts
WA-010	Adapt a worksheet for black-and-white printing and limited space
WA-011	Create an error-analysis worksheet from fictional student work
WA-012	Write a worksheet with foundation, application and reasoning sections
WA-013	Audit and repair a worksheet whose questions are repetitive or unclear
WA-014	Create hands-on, reading, discussion and writing stations
WA-015	Plan station rotations for a large class and small room
WA-016	Build self-checking stations that do not depend on the teacher
WA-017	Create one quiet station and three collaborative stations
WA-018	Differentiate station access while preserving one shared objective
WA-019	Design a teacher-led reteaching station from exit-ticket evidence
WA-020	Audit station directions, timing, materials and accountability
WA-021	Design a jigsaw task where every learner holds essential information
WA-022	Build a group investigation with rotating cognitive roles
WA-023	Create a consensus task that requires evidence and disagreement
WA-024	Turn an individual worksheet into meaningful collaborative reasoning
WA-025	Audit a group task for participation, access and individual evidence
WA-026	Create a no-speed review game using mini-whiteboards
WA-027	Design a team review game with individual accountability
WA-028	Build a misconception challenge using diagnostic distractors

ID	PROMPT
WA-029	Create a low-prep review game with paper question cards
WA-030	Audit a review game for fairness, accuracy and useful teacher data
WA-031	Create a short homework set with a clear purpose
WA-032	Build homework that mixes retrieval and current learning
WA-033	Design homework with a meaningful no-internet option
WA-034	Create a family-readable homework guide without requiring family teaching
WA-035	Audit a homework set for workload, access and answer-key accuracy
WA-036	Write a student-ready project brief from a supplied objective
WA-037	Create project milestones, checkpoints and submission requirements
WA-038	Design a choice-based project with equivalent learning demands
WA-039	Build a group-project brief with individual evidence of mastery
WA-040	Audit a project brief for clarity, feasibility and privacy

Assessment, Rubrics and Quizzes

ID	PROMPT
AS-001	Create a balanced classroom assessment
AS-002	Create hinge questions for live teaching
AS-003	Build a student-readable analytic rubric
AS-004	Diagnose errors from anonymous work
AS-005	Build a short quiz across recall, application and reasoning
AS-006	Write diagnostic multiple-choice questions with purposeful distractors
AS-007	Create a constructed-response assessment with a scoring guide
AS-008	Design a pre-assessment that separates prerequisite and grade-level skills
AS-009	Build a cumulative assessment without over-weighting recent lessons
AS-010	Adapt an assessment for a shorter testing period
AS-011	Create parallel assessment forms with equivalent demand
AS-012	Audit a test for alignment, ambiguity and answer-key errors
AS-013	Turn a supplied objective list into a complete assessment blueprint
AS-014	Build a five-minute check for understanding during instruction
AS-015	Write an exit ticket that distinguishes three levels of understanding
AS-016	Create a misconception poll with actionable response options
AS-017	Design a show-me task using mini-whiteboards or paper
AS-018	Turn anonymous responses into a next-day formative check
AS-019	Create a transfer question that reveals reasoning rather than recall
AS-020	Audit a formative check for speed, reading load and decision usefulness
AS-021	Create observable descriptors for four performance levels
AS-022	Turn an objective and task into aligned rubric criteria
AS-023	Build a single-point rubric with feedback space
AS-024	Create a rubric for collaborative work with individual evidence
AS-025	Rewrite vague rubric words as observable evidence
AS-026	Calibrate a rubric using fictional work samples
AS-027	Audit a rubric for double penalties, bias and irrelevant criteria
AS-028	Code anonymous responses by misconception rather than score alone

ID	PROMPT
AS-029	Build flexible reteaching groups from response patterns
AS-030	Distinguish a careless slip from a conceptual misunderstanding
AS-031	Create targeted mini-tasks for three misconception groups
AS-032	Plan a reassessment that shows whether reteaching worked
AS-033	Create a complete worked answer key from verified questions
AS-034	Write actionable feedback matched to common response patterns
AS-035	Audit an answer key for mathematical, factual and scoring errors
AS-036	Create learner-friendly solution explanations without hiding reasoning
AS-037	Map assessment evidence to supplied standards and objectives
AS-038	Create a standards-based proficiency scale with observable evidence
AS-039	Summarize class mastery without averaging unrelated skills
AS-040	Audit a standards-based grade summary for missing or weak evidence

Differentiation and Mixed Ability

ID	PROMPT
DF-001	Add temporary scaffolds without lowering the goal
DF-002	Create three routes to the same objective
DF-003	Make a task accessible to multilingual learners
DF-004	Adapt text access while preserving meaning
DF-005	Turn an observed barrier into a targeted support plan
DF-006	Create a graphic organizer that preserves essential reasoning
DF-007	Write sentence frames at three levels of language support
DF-008	Break a complex task into checkpoints without doing the thinking
DF-009	Add worked examples and prompts with a clear fade plan
DF-010	Create a scaffold menu learners can choose from responsibly
DF-011	Audit classroom supports for dependence and hidden lower expectations
DF-012	Build scaffolded, on-level and extension versions of one task
DF-013	Tier a task by representation rather than by easier content
DF-014	Create three entry points with one common mastery product
DF-015	Design tiered questions that move from access to transfer
DF-016	Check that every tier carries equal curricular dignity
DF-017	Create a whole-class debrief that reconnects three task versions
DF-018	Identify the language demands hidden inside a subject task
DF-019	Build an essential vocabulary preview with visuals and examples
DF-020	Create structured partner rehearsal before independent writing
DF-021	Plan purposeful home-language use without assuming proficiency
DF-022	Separate content evidence from English-language evidence
DF-023	Chunk a demanding source without rewriting its claims
DF-024	Create a plain-language companion beside the original text
DF-025	Add glossary, guiding questions and audio-access suggestions
DF-026	Reduce unnecessary reading load in a non-reading assessment
DF-027	Audit adapted materials for lost meaning or unsupported simplification
DF-028	Create an extension that deepens reasoning instead of adding more work

ID	PROMPT
DF-029	Build a transfer challenge using a new context
DF-030	Design an open-ended investigation with clear evidence expectations
DF-031	Audit an extension for novelty, rigor and connection to the objective
DF-032	Build temporary groups from anonymous learning evidence
DF-033	Create a rotation plan for three changing instructional needs
DF-034	Plan mixed-readiness groups with meaningful roles and accountability
DF-035	Audit a grouping plan for labels, access, movement and regrouping triggers

Parent Communication

ID	PROMPT
PC-001	Write a specific positive family message
PC-002	Communicate an academic concern with a next step
PC-003	Prepare a balanced family conference
PC-004	Draft a useful class newsletter
PC-005	Share academic growth using one concrete classroom example
PC-006	Recognize a learner's helpful contribution without using labels
PC-007	Write a brief celebration message suitable for a mobile screen
PC-008	Create a positive note that invites the learner's own reflection
PC-009	Build a reusable strength-note template with visible evidence fields
PC-010	Write a missing-work message using dates and verified counts
PC-011	Explain a recurring learning difficulty without diagnosing its cause
PC-012	Request a brief family check-in with two exact scheduling options
PC-013	Revise a blaming concern email into factual collaborative language
PC-014	Audit a concern message for evidence, tone and unsupported claims
PC-015	Build a 15-minute conference agenda around learning evidence
PC-016	Prepare questions that invite family and student perspective
PC-017	Turn classroom evidence into a shared action-plan table
PC-018	Write a factual post-conference summary with owners and dates
PC-019	Create a concise weekly learning update for families
PC-020	Rewrite a newsletter as a mobile-friendly plain-text version
PC-021	Audit a class newsletter for dates, jargon, access and action items
PC-022	Draft a permission notice from verified trip or event details
PC-023	Create a clear family checklist for materials, dates and return forms
PC-024	Write a schedule-change notice without inventing school policy
PC-025	Audit a logistics message for missing consent, safety and contact details
PC-026	Rewrite school language in plain family-friendly English
PC-027	Create a translation-ready message using short unambiguous sentences
PC-028	Audit a family message for jargon, idioms and hidden assumptions

ID	PROMPT
PC-029	Prepare a calm conversation about a repeated classroom concern
PC-030	Create a fact-based communication plan for disagreement with a family

Report Card Comments

ID	PROMPT
RC-001	Build an evidence-safe comment bank
RC-002	Turn evidence into a balanced report comment
RC-003	Rewrite a comment for clarity and fairness
RC-004	Create comment starters for four levels of demonstrated mastery
RC-005	Build modular strength, evidence and next-step sentence parts
RC-006	Create a comment bank that avoids fixed-ability labels
RC-007	Write concise comments within a strict character limit
RC-008	Create neutral pronoun variants without changing the evidence
RC-009	Build a comment bank with visible placeholders for supporting evidence
RC-010	Audit a comment bank for repetition, vagueness and invented claims
RC-011	Write a strength statement tied to a specific learning objective
RC-012	Convert an error pattern into one achievable next step
RC-013	Build a balanced comment from assessment and classroom evidence
RC-014	Write a comment when evidence is limited or inconsistent
RC-015	Create a learner-friendly next step that families can understand
RC-016	Add an instructional strategy without promising a future result
RC-017	Audit a report comment using a sentence-by-sentence fact trace
RC-018	Write a mathematics comment about concepts, procedures and reasoning
RC-019	Write a science comment about investigation, evidence and explanation
RC-020	Write an English language arts comment about reading and writing evidence
RC-021	Write a social studies comment about sources, claims and perspective
RC-022	Write an arts comment about process, technique and reflection
RC-023	Write a physical education comment using observable skill evidence
RC-024	Audit subject-specific terminology for accuracy and family clarity
RC-025	Create distinct comment drafts from a fictional evidence table
RC-026	Generate bulk comments without mixing one learner's evidence with another
RC-027	Vary sentence structure while preserving every supplied fact
RC-028	Audit a bulk comment set for duplicates, contradictions and evidence leakage

ID	PROMPT
RC-029	Replace harsh or vague judgments with verified learning evidence
RC-030	Shorten a report comment without removing the material concern

Classroom Management and SEL

ID	PROMPT
CM-001	Design and teach a classroom routine
CM-002	Prepare a restorative conversation
CM-003	Teach an efficient entry routine with an immediate learning start
CM-004	Create a calm transition between whole-group and independent work
CM-005	Build a materials routine that reduces waiting and lost equipment
CM-006	Plan a dismissal routine that protects safety and learning time
CM-007	Audit a routine using timing, participation and independence evidence
CM-008	Create a brief private behaviour-reset conversation
CM-009	Write neutral redirection language for a recurring disruption
CM-010	Plan a re-entry routine after a learner leaves the classroom
CM-011	Create a reset menu that preserves dignity and instructional access
CM-012	Audit a response plan for escalation, shame and inconsistent expectations
CM-013	Create questions that explore impact, needs and possible repair
CM-014	Build a voluntary repair agreement with a scheduled follow-up
CM-015	Audit a restorative script for coercion, blame and safeguarding limits
CM-016	Create an age-appropriate lesson on naming and managing emotions
CM-017	Teach a practical strategy for pausing before responding
CM-018	Build an empathy activity without requiring personal disclosure
CM-019	Audit an SEL activity for privacy, culture and clinical overreach
CM-020	Plan a 10-minute morning meeting with a clear community goal
CM-021	Create inclusive check-in options that do not force disclosure
CM-022	Build a weekly morning-meeting sequence without repetitive prompts
CM-023	Create a seating plan from classroom access and learning constraints
CM-024	Build a transparent regrouping plan using temporary learning evidence
CM-025	Audit seating and grouping decisions for labels, isolation and accessibility

Teacher Admin and Paperwork

ID	PROMPT
AD-001	Turn notes into accountable meeting minutes
AD-002	Draft a measurable professional growth goal
AD-003	Write a concise staff email with one clear action
AD-004	Turn rough notes into a professional colleague update
AD-005	Draft a meeting request with purpose, preparation and time limit
AD-006	Write a follow-up email that separates decisions from open questions
AD-007	Audit a staff email for tone, recipients, dates and unnecessary detail
AD-008	Build a timed agenda around decisions that must be made
AD-009	Convert discussion notes into decisions, actions and a parking lot
AD-010	Audit meeting minutes for invented consensus, owners or deadlines
AD-011	Turn baseline evidence into a realistic semester action plan
AD-012	Create leading and outcome indicators for a teaching goal
AD-013	Build midpoint decision rules for revising a professional goal
AD-014	Write an evidence-based reflection after a classroom observation
AD-015	Separate observed events, interpretation and next action
AD-016	Turn observer feedback into one measurable instructional experiment
AD-017	Build a field-trip planning checklist from official requirements
AD-018	Create a trip-day schedule with owners, counts and contingency fields
AD-019	Audit a field-trip draft for permissions, access, safety and unknowns
AD-020	Create a club launch plan with purpose, routines and supervision fields
AD-021	Build a fair duty rota from supplied availability and policy
AD-022	Audit a club or duty plan for gaps, overload and unclear responsibility
AD-023	Turn a verified classroom need into a concise proposal outline
AD-024	Build a grant budget narrative from supplied costs and restrictions
AD-025	Audit a proposal for unsupported claims, missing evidence and compliance

Subject Deep Dives

ID	PROMPT
SD-001	Create a concept-first mathematics explanation
SD-002	Design an evidence-based science investigation
SD-003	Connect concrete, visual and symbolic mathematics representations
SD-004	Build a mathematics error-analysis lesson with verified solutions
SD-005	Build a close-reading lesson from an authorized supplied text
SD-006	Create an evidence-based writing task with a clear mentor model
SD-007	Design a revision lesson that separates ideas, organization and conventions
SD-008	Build a claim-evidence-reasoning task from supplied observations
SD-009	Audit a science explanation for causation, uncertainty and safety
SD-010	Create a source-analysis lesson using origin, purpose and context
SD-011	Build a corroboration task with multiple supplied perspectives
SD-012	Design a historical claim task that distinguishes evidence from interpretation
SD-013	Create a skill-development lesson with modelling, practice and reflection
SD-014	Adapt a performance task for space, equipment and physical access
SD-015	Build an observable process rubric for an arts, PE or elective task

Multi-step Workflows

ID	PROMPT
WF-001	Standard to complete unit
WF-002	Mixed-ability lesson pack
WF-003	Incident to parent conversation
WF-004	Scores to report comments
WF-005	Standard to aligned assessment
WF-006	Emergency substitute pack
WF-007	Project launch pack
WF-008	Parent conference pack
WF-009	Evidence to intervention-plan draft
WF-010	Field-trip planning pack
WF-011	Weekly teacher admin pack
WF-012	Class data reflection

BY GRADE BAND

Most prompts carry no age of their own — the wording you fill in sets that. Those are marked **All grades** and they work in every band.

BAND	PROMPTS YOU CAN USE
K-2	125
3-5	290
6-8	296
9-12	293

All grades (118 prompts) — every prompt not listed below.

The rest assume a reading level or a stage of schooling:

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12 (165) — AS-001, AS-002, AS-003, AS-004, AS-005, AS-006, AS-008, AS-009, AS-011, AS-013, AS-014, AS-015, AS-016, AS-017, AS-018, AS-019, AS-021, AS-022, AS-023, AS-024, AS-026, AS-028, AS-029, AS-030, AS-031, AS-032, AS-033, AS-034, AS-036, AS-037, AS-038, AS-039, CM-013, CM-014, CM-017, CM-018, CM-024, DF-002, DF-004, DF-005, DF-006, DF-007, DF-008, DF-009, DF-010, DF-012, DF-013, DF-014, DF-015, DF-016, DF-017, DF-018, DF-019, DF-020, DF-021, DF-022, DF-024, DF-025, DF-026, DF-028, DF-029, DF-032, DF-033, DF-034, LP-001, LP-002, LP-004, LP-006, LP-007, LP-008, LP-009, LP-010, LP-011, LP-

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Grades 6-8, 9-12 (10) — AS-007, DF-023, DF-030, LP-015, RC-021, SD-010, SD-011, SD-012, WA-022, WA-023

Grades K-2, 3-5 (4) — CM-020, CM-022, PC-004, WA-034

Grades K-2, 3-5, 6-8 (3) — CM-005, CM-016, SD-003

The 12 workflows in Chapter 10 follow the grade band of the prompt you start them with.

BY SUBJECT

Every prompt outside this list is subject-neutral — you name the subject when you fill the prompt in. These are the ones written for one subject:

ID	PROMPT
SD-001	Create a concept-first mathematics explanation
SD-003	Connect concrete, visual and symbolic mathematics representations
SD-004	Build a mathematics error-analysis lesson with verified solutions
SD-002	Design an evidence-based science investigation
SD-008	Build a claim-evidence-reasoning task from supplied observations
SD-009	Audit a science explanation for causation, uncertainty and safety
SD-005	Build a close-reading lesson from an authorized supplied text
SD-006	Create an evidence-based writing task with a clear mentor model
SD-007	Design a revision lesson that separates ideas, organization and conventions
SD-010	Create a source-analysis lesson using origin, purpose and context
SD-011	Build a corroboration task with multiple supplied perspectives
SD-012	Design a historical claim task that distinguishes evidence from interpretation
SD-013	Create a skill-development lesson with modelling, practice and reflection
SD-014	Adapt a performance task for space, equipment and physical access
SD-015	Build an observable process rubric for an arts, PE or elective task

How to use this book

THE SHORT VERSION

1. Find the prompt for what you are actually doing right now. 2. Copy everything between **COPY FROM HERE** and **TO HERE**. 3. Paste it into ChatGPT, Claude or Gemini. 4. Fill in the parts in **[SQUARE BRACKETS]** with your real details. 5. Read what comes back before anyone else does.

That is the whole method. Nothing to install, nothing to learn first.

TWO FILES FOR EVERY CHAPTER

Each chapter comes as a **PDF** and an **HTML page**, with the same content.

	PDF	HTML PAGE
Copy button on every prompt	no	yes
Works offline / prints	yes	no
Search inside	yes	yes
On a phone	fine	better

A PDF cannot carry a working copy button — the feature exists in the format, but no browser or phone viewer runs it. So **use the HTML page when you are actually working**, and keep the PDF for printing or reading offline.

WHICH CHAPTER DO I OPEN?

Each chapter is a separate file, so you only open the one you need.

IF YOU ARE DOING THIS	OPEN
Planning a lesson or a unit	Chapter 1
Making worksheets, activities, stations	Chapter 2
Writing a quiz, test or rubric	Chapter 3
Adapting one task for a mixed class	Chapter 4
Writing to a family	Chapter 5
Report card season	Chapter 6
Routines, behaviour, morning meeting	Chapter 7
Emails, goals, forms, admin	Chapter 8
Subject-specific work	Chapter 9
A whole job, start to finish	Chapter 10

Start with the index. It lists all 300 prompts by name, and again by grade band and by subject, so you can find one in about ten seconds.

FILLING IN THE BRACKETS

Every prompt has parts like `[GRADE_SUBJECT]` or `[UNIT_TOPIC]`. Replace the whole thing, brackets included.

`[GRADE_SUBJECT: exact age/grade and subject]`

becomes

`Year 7 science`

Be specific. "Year 7 science, mixed ability, 26 students, 50-minute lesson, no lab access this week" gets you something usable. "Science" gets you something generic.

If a prompt asks for something you genuinely do not have, say so in the chat rather than inventing it. The prompts are written to ask you back.

GETTING A BETTER RESULT

Answer its questions. If it comes back asking for the assessment date or the reading level, the prompt is working correctly. Answer, and the next draft will be much closer.

Ask for a change instead of starting again. "Same plan, but guided practice is too long for 15 minutes" is faster than a fresh prompt.

One task at a time. These prompts are deliberately narrow. Asking for a lesson plan, a worksheet and a parent email in one go gets you three mediocre things.

WHAT THE SECTIONS MEAN

When you need this — the situation, so you can tell two similar prompts apart.

Fill in — what you need to hand before you start.

COPY FROM HERE / TO HERE — the prompt. Copy all of it.

Before you send it — what usually goes wrong on *this* kind of task. Short, and specific to this prompt.

Example — where included, an illustration of the shape of a good answer. It is an editorial illustration, not a logged AI run.

THREE THINGS THIS BOOK WILL NOT DO

It will not know your students. Nothing here should be given identifying details. See the safety page.

It will not check your subject facts. Verify content and calculations yourself, especially anything a student will be marked on.

It will not decide anything. Grades, placements, behaviour outcomes and anything touching safeguarding stay with you and your school's process.

IF A PROMPT DOES NOT WORK

Tell us which one — the ID is at the top of every prompt, like **LP-002** — and what you got instead. That is the fastest way to get it fixed.

Before you use any prompt in this book

Read this once. It applies to every prompt in every chapter.

THE ONE-MINUTE VERSION

AI writes a **first draft**. You are the teacher. Nothing in this book produces something that goes to a student, a family, or a permanent record without you reading it first.

NEVER PASTE THESE INTO AN AI TOOL

- Student names, initials or ID numbers
- Contact details for students or families
- Medical information, diagnoses, or protected plans
- Confidential incident or safeguarding records
- Any story detailed enough to identify one child

Write **"a Year 5 student"** or **"Student A"** instead.

Taking the name out is not the same as making it anonymous. A class of 28 with

one wheelchair user is identifiable without any name at all. If the detail is

what makes the request work, that is exactly the detail to leave out.

Use whatever AI tool your school has approved. If your school has not approved one, ask before putting any school information into any of them.

WHAT AI MAY WRITE, AND WHAT IT MAY NOT

It may invent: teaching activities, practice questions, worked examples, fictional scenarios, sentence starters, structures and sequences.

It must never invent:

NOT THIS	WHY
What a student said or did	You were there. It wasn't.
Research findings or quotations	It will produce plausible fake citations
Standards, codes, or policy wording	Check the real document
Dates, approvals, meeting records	These are factual records
Test scores or measured results	These are evidence, not text

If something you need is missing, the prompt is written to **ask you** rather than fill the gap. When it asks, answer — do not let it guess.

JUDGEMENTS THAT STAY WITH YOU

AI does not decide a final grade, a placement, a disciplinary outcome, or anything to do with safeguarding. It can help you draft the words. The decision is yours, and so is the responsibility.

Never let it infer a diagnosis, a home situation, a motivation, an identity, or a fixed ability level. It cannot know these, and a confident sentence about them is still a guess.

Keep any accommodation or constraint you supplied. If you said a student has extra time, that must survive into the draft.

TWO HABITS WORTH BUILDING

Check the maths and the facts yourself. If you ask the model to check its own work it will say it checked. That is not verification.

Read the draft as the person receiving it. A parent email that reads fine to you at 9pm may not read fine to a family at 8am.

IF A REQUEST TOUCHES HARM OR DANGER

Stop. Do not work it through with an AI tool. Follow your school's safeguarding or emergency procedure. That process exists for exactly this moment.

PASTE THIS ONCE, AT THE START OF YOUR CHAT

Instead of repeating rules in every prompt, paste this at the top of a new conversation. Everything after it inherits the rules.

COPY THIS PROMPT

You are helping a classroom teacher draft materials.

Rules for this whole conversation:

- I will not give you any student's name, ID, or identifying details, and you must not ask for them.
- You may invent activities, examples and fictional scenarios. Never invent student observations, research, quotations, standards, policies, dates, approvals or measured results.
- If something essential is missing, ask me. Do not fill the gap yourself.
- Keep any constraint or accommodation I give you.
- Do not infer a diagnosis, home situation, motivation, identity, or fixed ability level.
- Separate what I told you, what you are proposing, and what you are unsure of.
- End each answer with a short list of what I should check before using it.

Confirm you have these, then wait for my first task.

Then paste any prompt from any chapter.

Chapter 1 — Lesson Planning

60 PROMPTS

Most lesson planning goes wrong in the same place: you start listing activities before deciding what would count as proof the lesson worked. These prompts push the evidence to the front — what will you actually see in the room that tells you they got it — and build backward from there.

WHAT'S IN HERE

GROUP	PROMPTS	USE WHEN
Complete lessons	12	You need the whole thing, start to finish
Backward unit planning	8	You have three weeks and an end assessment
Standards and objectives	8	Turning official wording into something teachable
Warm-ups and exit tickets	8	The first five minutes and the last five
Pacing and transitions	6	The lesson is right but the timing is not
Substitute and emergency plans	6	You are ill at 6am
Projects and interdisciplinary	6	Longer work, more than one subject
Reflection and adaptation	6	It did not go as planned; now what

WORTH KNOWING BEFORE YOU START

Give it the real constraints — 50 minutes, 26 students, no lab this week. Vague input produces a plan for a class that does not exist.

If a standard has to be followed, paste its exact wording. Never ask the model to recall a standard code; it will produce something that looks right.

Treat every suggested timing as optimistic. Handing out paper takes four minutes.

COMPLETE LESSONS

LP-001

Build a complete evidence-led lesson

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

You have an objective and a slot in the timetable, and nothing else yet.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Plan a [MINUTES]-minute [GRADE] [SUBJECT] lesson on [TOPIC].

Objective: [OBJECTIVE – what students should be able to do by the end]

Class: [CLASS SIZE, anything I should know about the group]

Available: [MATERIALS, room, technology – say if there is none]

Build it backward. Decide first what you would need to see from a student to believe they met the objective, then design the lesson to produce exactly that.

Give me:

1. The objective as a student-facing "I can" statement
2. A 5-minute opening that surfaces what they already know
3. The modelling steps, in the order I say and do them
4. Guided practice, plus what I should look for while circulating
5. Independent practice
6. An exit ticket – one question that separates real understanding from students who followed the steps without understanding
7. The most common misconception on this topic, and the exact question I ask to catch it

Keep every section short enough to read at a glance while teaching. If any of my inputs are missing or too vague to plan from, ask me before drafting.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Does every activity produce evidence about the objective?
- Could a student who understood nothing still answer the exit ticket?
- Are the materials ones you genuinely have this week?

LP-006**Plan a concept-development lesson from prior knowledge**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

The concept is new, but they already hold pieces of it without knowing.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Plan a [MINUTES]-minute [GRADE] [SUBJECT] lesson that develops the concept of [CONCEPT], starting from what students already know.

Already taught: [PRIOR LEARNING]

Do not open by defining the concept. Instead:

1. Start with 2-3 examples they can already reason about
2. Add one example their current thinking cannot explain
3. Give them the question that gap creates, and let them work on it
4. Introduce the concept as the answer to that question
5. Return to the first examples so they can see what changed

For each stage, tell me what a student still holding the old idea would say, so

I can hear it while circulating.

End with a check that distinguishes a student who has the new concept from one who has memorised the new vocabulary.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Is the "cannot explain" example genuinely unexplainable with prior knowledge?
- Does the definition arrive after the need for it, not before?

LP-007**Plan an inquiry lesson around a puzzling phenomenon**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

You want them asking the question rather than answering yours.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Plan a [MINUTES]-minute [GRADE] [SUBJECT] inquiry lesson about [TOPIC].

Available materials: [MATERIALS – say if this must be paper only]

Open with something genuinely puzzling students can observe or examine directly, not a question I ask them.

Give me:

- The phenomenon, described exactly as students will encounter it
- What students typically notice first, and what they usually miss
- Three questions students are likely to raise, and which is most productive to pursue
- How I steer toward the productive question without announcing it
- The point where I give direct instruction, and why there
- A closing that names what is now explained and what is still open

If the phenomenon needs equipment I have not listed, say so rather than assuming I have it.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Is the phenomenon actually puzzling, or just unfamiliar?
- Is there a point where you teach directly? Pure discovery rarely works.

LP-008**Create an explicit-instruction lesson with guided release**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

A procedure where practising it wrong first would be costly.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Plan a [MINUTES]-minute [GRADE] [SUBJECT] lesson teaching [SKILL OR PROCEDURE] using explicit instruction with gradual release.

Structure it as I do it / we do it / you do it together / you do it alone, with rough timings.

For "I do it": write out the exact worked example, including what I say aloud about the decisions I am making – not just the steps.

For "we do it": two examples where I hand over one more decision each time. Name which decision is being handed over.

For "you do it together": the task, plus the one thing pairs usually get wrong.

For "you do it alone": three items increasing in difficulty, with answers.

Between each phase, tell me the checkpoint – what I need to see before moving on, and what I do if I do not see it.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Does the worked example include the thinking, or only the steps?
- Is there a stated checkpoint before each release?

LP-009**Design a discussion-centered lesson with equitable participation**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

The same six students answer everything and you want that to change.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Plan a [MINUTES]-minute [GRADE] [SUBJECT] discussion lesson on [TOPIC OR TEXT] for [NUMBER] students.

Design it so a quiet student has a real route in.

Give me:

- An opening question with no single right answer, that everyone can say something about
- A silent thinking or writing step before any talking
- A pairs step, with the exact instruction students hear
- Two follow-up questions that push for evidence rather than opinion
- Three moves for when discussion stalls, and three for when a few voices dominate
- A closing task each student completes alone, so participation is not the only evidence I get

Do not suggest cold-calling as the main participation strategy.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Is there thinking time before talking time?
- Does a student who says nothing still leave evidence you can read?

LP-010**Build a no-technology lesson using basic classroom materials**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

The wifi is down, the trolley is booked, or you simply do not want screens.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Plan a [MINUTES]-minute [GRADE] [SUBJECT] lesson on [TOPIC] using nothing but paper, pens, a board, and what is already in an ordinary classroom.

No printing – assume I cannot photocopy anything this morning. Anything students need to see must be writable on the board or dictated.

Give me:

- Exactly what I write on the board, and when
- The task, worded as I would say it aloud
- How students record their work on plain paper
- A way to share answers that does not need a document camera
- An exit ticket on a scrap of paper

This should not feel like a downgraded technology lesson. Use the constraint – physical grouping, movement, talk – as an advantage.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Could this actually run with zero preparation this morning?
- Is anything here secretly assuming a printer?

LP-011**Create a lesson around one complex text or source**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

One difficult text, and you want them to work through it rather than survive it.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Plan a [MINUTES]-minute [GRADE] [SUBJECT] lesson built around the text below.

Do not summarise the text for students. Design a lesson that makes them work through it.

Give me:

- The two or three places students will get stuck, quoted exactly, and what to do at each
- A first-read task with a single narrow purpose
- A second-read task that goes deeper, not wider
- Four text-dependent questions from literal to inferential, with the lines that answer each
- The vocabulary that genuinely blocks comprehension – not merely unfamiliar words – with a student-friendly gloss
- A final writing or talking task using evidence from the text

TEXT:

[PASTE THE FULL TEXT HERE]

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Do the quoted sticking points actually appear in your text?
- Is the second read deeper, or just more of the same?

LP-012**Plan a safe hands-on investigation lesson**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Practical work, where safety is part of the plan and not an afterthought.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Plan a [MINUTES]-minute [GRADE] [SUBJECT] hands-on investigation into [QUESTION OR PHENOMENON].

Equipment I actually have: [LIST]

Room: [BENCHES, SINKS, SPACE, CLASS SIZE]

Give me:

- The investigation question in student words
- Setup, including how materials are distributed and collected
- What students record, and the exact table or format they record it in
- The safety points specific to this activity, stated as instructions rather than warnings
- What to do about the group that finishes in half the time
- A discussion that separates what they observed from what they concluded

Flag anything needing equipment I have not listed, or that my room as described cannot support. Do not assume a fume hood, gas or running water unless I said so.

I will check all safety guidance against my school's own procedures.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Check every safety point against your school's policy, not this draft.
- Is the equipment list what you actually have on the day?

LP-013**Design a problem-based mathematics lesson**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

You want them to need the method before you teach it.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Plan a [MINUTES]-minute [GRADE] mathematics lesson on [TOPIC].

Open with a problem students can start without being taught the method – one where an inefficient approach works but becomes painful, so the method answers a need they have felt.

Give me:

- The problem, with numbers chosen so the inefficient route is possible but tedious
- Two student approaches I should expect, one efficient and one not
- The exact question I ask to move a student from the second to the first
- Where the formal method gets named, and how it connects to what they did
- Three practice items: one like the problem, one varying the surface, one varying the structure
- Answers, with working shown

Check every calculation. State any assumption you made about the numbers.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Work all the numbers yourself. This is where wrong answers hide.
- Does the inefficient route genuinely work, or break immediately?

LP-014**Compress a full lesson into a purposeful 30-minute period**

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

An assembly, a fire drill, a shortened day — and the lesson still has to land.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Cut the lesson below down to [MINUTES] minutes for [GRADE] [SUBJECT].

Do not trim every section evenly. Decide what the lesson is really for, protect that, and cut the rest properly.

Tell me:

- The one thing that must survive, and why
- What you cut completely, and what is lost by cutting it
- What moves to next lesson, and what that costs
- The compressed plan with realistic timings
- A one-question check that still tells me whether it worked

If the lesson genuinely cannot be done in this time without losing its point, say so and tell me what a better use of the [MINUTES] minutes would be.

LESSON:

[PASTE YOUR PLAN]

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Do you agree with what it decided was essential?
- Is the timing realistic, or does it assume instant transitions?

LP-015**Expand a lesson for a 90-minute block without filler**

Grades 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

A double period, and you refuse to fill it with extra questions.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Extend the [GRADE] [SUBJECT] lesson below to fill [MINUTES] minutes.

Do not add more practice items of the same kind. Add depth: application, transfer, comparison, or students producing something rather than answering.

Give me:

- The extended plan, with the activity type changing roughly every 15-20 minutes
- At least one point where students move or work with someone new
- A mid-block reset – what I say and do at the halfway point
- One task using the idea in an unfamiliar context
- The point in the block where attention usually drops, and what is placed there

Do not extend by simply increasing the number of questions.

LESSON:

[PASTE YOUR PLAN]

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Is the extra time depth or volume?
- Is anything needing attention placed in the low-attention slot?

LP-016**Repair a draft lesson whose activities do not match its objective**

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

The plan looks fine, but something about it is not adding up.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Audit the [GRADE] [SUBJECT] lesson below against its stated objective.

For each activity, tell me:

- What it actually asks students to do, cognitively
- Whether that matches the objective, partly matches, or does not match
- What evidence about the objective it produces, if any

Then give me the single biggest mismatch and a replacement activity for it that keeps the same time and materials.

Be direct. If the objective itself is the problem – too vague to plan against, or two objectives in one sentence – say that first.

OBJECTIVE: [PASTE IT]

LESSON:
[PASTE YOUR PLAN]

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Do you agree with the mismatch it identified?
- Does the replacement fit your actual time and materials?

BACKWARD UNIT PLANNING

LP-002**Plan a unit backward from mastery**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Three weeks, an assessment at the end, and no clear path between them.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Plan a [NUMBER]-lesson [GRADE] [SUBJECT] unit on [TOPIC].

The unit ends with: [FINAL ASSESSMENT OR PERFORMANCE]

Already taught: [PRIOR LEARNING]

Work backward. Start from what a student must be able to do to succeed on that final assessment, then sequence everything needed to get there.

Give me:

- The 4-6 things students must be able to do by the end
- Those sequenced across the lessons, with a one-line reason for the order
- Which lessons are load-bearing and which could be cut if we lose time
- A checkpoint roughly every third lesson, and what I do if it goes badly
- The two lessons most likely to go wrong, and why

Mark optional extensions separately from the core sequence, so I can see at a glance what is expendable.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Does each lesson clearly serve the final assessment?
- Are the checkpoints early enough to act on?

LP-017**Unpack final mastery into a prerequisite learning map**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

You know the destination; you are not sure what has to come first.

COPY THIS PROMPT

For this [GRADE] [SUBJECT] end goal – [END GOAL] – map what has to be in place first.

Give me:

- The component skills and knowledge, broken down until each could be taught and checked in a single lesson
- Which depend on which, as an ordered list rather than a vague cluster
- Which are usually already secure by [GRADE], and which usually are not
- For each shaky one, a two-minute check I could run before the unit starts

Do not include anything students do not actually need for this goal. A shorter honest list is more useful than a complete-looking one.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Is each component small enough to teach in one lesson?
- Are the dependencies real, or just a plausible-looking order?

LP-018**Design a final performance task before planning daily lessons**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Writing the ending first, so the middle has somewhere to go.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Design the final performance task for a [GRADE] [SUBJECT] unit on [TOPIC].

Learning it must evidence: [WHAT STUDENTS SHOULD BE ABLE TO DO]

Time available: [MINUTES OR LESSONS]

Give me:

- The task as students will receive it, written out in full
- What a strong response contains, specifically
- What a response looks like when a student has the knowledge but not the skill
- What it looks like when they have the skill but thin knowledge
- Which parts of the task are about the learning and which are about presentation – so I do not accidentally grade the poster

Keep it completable in the time given, with the materials a normal classroom has.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Could a student do well on this without the learning? Redesign if so.
- Is presentation separated from substance?

LP-019**Create a coherent lesson sequence from an approved assessment**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

The assessment is fixed and handed to you; the teaching is yours.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Below is the assessment my [GRADE] [SUBJECT] students sit at the end of this unit. I have [NUMBER] lessons before it.

Work out what it actually demands, then plan the sequence.

Give me:

- What each question or section requires, as a skill rather than a topic
- Anything the assessment expects that the topic list alone would not give students – format, command words, time pressure
- A lesson sequence building toward it without becoming test practice
- Where I should give them a question in this format for the first time
- What I would be teaching only for the test, so I can decide whether it is worth the time

ASSESSMENT:

[PASTE IT]

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Is it teaching the learning or teaching the paper?
- Do students meet the format early enough that it is not a surprise?

LP-020**Place formative checkpoints and reteaching decisions across a unit**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

You want to find out who is lost before the end of the unit.

COPY THIS PROMPT

For the [GRADE] [SUBJECT] unit below, place formative checkpoints.

Give me:

- Where they go, and why there specifically
- What each one checks – one thing, not a general review
- The actual question or task for each, short enough to mark in ten minutes
- What each result would show: what it looks like when most of the class is fine, and what it looks like when it has gone wrong
- For each checkpoint, the specific reteach for next lesson if it went badly – not "revisit the concept"

Do not set a pass percentage. Describe what the responses would show; the decision about moving on is mine.

UNIT:

[PASTE YOUR OUTLINE]

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Is each reteach concrete enough to teach tomorrow?
- Can you genuinely mark each checkpoint in ten minutes?

LP-021**Audit a unit for gaps, repetition and cognitive progression**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

The unit exists. You want to know what is wrong with it before you teach it.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Audit this [GRADE] [SUBJECT] unit.

Tell me:

- Where a lesson assumes something never taught
- Where the same thing is taught twice without deepening
- Whether cognitive demand rises across the unit or stays flat – say which lessons sit at which level
- Which lesson does the most work, and which does the least
- What a student who missed lessons [X] and [Y] would be unable to do

Be blunt. I would rather hear that a lesson is redundant than get a tactful list of strengths.

UNIT:

[PASTE IT]

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Do you agree with the gaps, or is it missing context you hold in your head?
- Is the flat-demand judgement fair?

LP-022**Shorten a unit while protecting its essential learning**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Snow days, assemblies, a lost week — and the unit still has to finish.

COPY THIS PROMPT

I have lost [NUMBER] lessons from this [GRADE] [SUBJECT] unit. Cut it down.

Give me:

- What must survive, and why each item is non-negotiable
- What gets cut entirely, and what students will not be able to do as a result
- What gets merged rather than cut, and how
- The revised sequence
- What I should tell students, if anything, about what we are skipping

If shortening it this much would leave the unit incoherent, say so and tell me what a better plan would be – including teaching less content properly.

UNIT:

[PASTE IT]

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Are you comfortable with what it cut? You know the class; it does not.
- Does the shortened version still reach the final assessment?

LP-023**Add transfer and reflection to the end of a unit**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

They can do it in the unit's context and nowhere else.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Design a closing lesson for this [GRADE] [SUBJECT] unit on [TOPIC] that tests whether the learning transfers.

Give me:

- A task in a context we never used during the unit, needing the same thinking
- What a student who only learned the surface pattern will do with it
- A reflection prompt about the thinking, not about how they felt
- A short comparison task: here is something similar but different – which applies, and how do you know
- What I should look for in their answers as evidence of real transfer

Do not make the closing lesson a review of what we already did.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Is the new context genuinely new, or a cosmetic change?
- Does the reflection ask about thinking rather than feeling?

STANDARDS AND OBJECTIVES

LP-003**Turn a standard into measurable objectives**

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

The standard is a paragraph. You need something you can teach on Tuesday.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Break the standard below into teachable objectives for [GRADE] [SUBJECT].

Give me:

- 3-5 objectives, each small enough to teach and check in one lesson
- Each written with a verb I could observe – not "understand" or "appreciate"
- For each, what a student does that shows it
- The order to teach them, with a reason
- Anything in the standard not covered by these objectives, so I can see what I am leaving out

Use only the wording I paste below. Do not add requirements from other versions of this standard, and do not fill gaps with what a standard like this usually says.

STANDARD:

[PASTE THE EXACT WORDING]

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Check the objectives against the standard's real wording, not a paraphrase.
- Is every verb observable?

LP-024**Separate knowledge, skill and reasoning within a standard**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Students can recite it but cannot use it, or use it but cannot explain it.

COPY THIS PROMPT

For the [GRADE] [SUBJECT] standard below, separate what students must know, what they must be able to do, and what they must be able to reason about.

For each of the three:

- List the specific items
- Say how each is best taught, given what kind of thing it is
- Say how each is best checked – the check for knowledge should not look like the check for reasoning

Then tell me which of the three this standard is really about, and which is usually over-taught at the expense of the others.

STANDARD:

[PASTE THE EXACT WORDING]

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Do the three checks genuinely test different things?
- Does the emphasis match what the standard actually says?

LP-025**Rewrite a technical objective as a student-friendly I-can statement**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

The objective on your board means nothing to the students reading it.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Rewrite the objective below as an "I can" statement for [GRADE] students.

Rules:

- Keep the full demand. Do not make it easier to state by making it easier.
- Use words a [GRADE] student already uses, not words they would have to be taught.
- One sentence.

Give me three versions at different levels of directness, and say which you would put on the board and why.

Then give me success criteria as 2-3 "I know I've got it when..." lines a student could check themselves against.

OBJECTIVE:

[PASTE IT]

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Is the demand intact, or has it quietly been lowered?
- Could a student self-check against those criteria without asking you?

LP-026**Create observable success criteria for an existing objective**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

You know what good looks like. You have never written it down.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Write success criteria for this [GRADE] [SUBJECT] objective: [OBJECTIVE]

The task students will do: [TASK]

Give me 3-5 criteria, each something I could point at in a student's work and say yes or no. No criterion should require me to judge effort or attitude.

For each criterion:

- What it looks like when met
- What it most commonly looks like when nearly met
- The feedback sentence I would give for the nearly-met version

Order them so the first is the one that matters most.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Could two teachers apply these and agree?
- Is anything here about effort rather than the work?

LP-027**Check whether an activity truly aligns to a supplied standard**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

It is a good activity. You are not sure it is the right one.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Check whether this activity addresses the standard below.

Tell me:

- What the standard actually demands, in plain words
- What the activity actually asks students to do
- Where these match and where they do not
- What the activity does that the standard does not require – and whether that is worth the time
- What the standard requires that the activity never touches

End with a straight verdict: fully aligned, partly aligned, or not aligned. If partly, tell me the smallest change that would fix it.

STANDARD:

[PASTE THE EXACT WORDING]

ACTIVITY:

[PASTE IT]

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Is the verdict based on your standard's real wording?
- Is the "smallest change" actually small?

LP-028**Map several objectives into a logical teaching order**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

A list of objectives with no indication of what comes first.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Put these [GRADE] [SUBJECT] objectives into a teaching order.

For each position, tell me why it sits there – what it needs from what came before, or what it sets up for what follows.

Then tell me:

- Which pairs could be taught in either order without harm
- Which pair would cause real trouble if reversed, and what that trouble is
- Which objectives could be combined into one lesson
- Which single objective will need more than one lesson

If two objectives are actually the same thing worded differently, say so.

OBJECTIVES:

[PASTE THE LIST]

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Do the stated dependencies hold up when you think through a lesson?
- Does the total lesson count fit the time you have?

LP-029**Identify prerequisite skills without lowering the grade-level target**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Some of the class is not ready, and the target is not moving.

COPY THIS PROMPT

For this [GRADE] objective – [OBJECTIVE] – identify the prerequisite skills.

Give me:

- The prerequisites, ordered from most to least likely to be missing at [GRADE]
- A short diagnostic for each: 2-3 items, answers included
- For each, the fastest way to shore it up inside a lesson aimed at the grade-level objective, rather than as separate remediation

The grade-level target does not change. I want what to scaffold alongside it, not what to substitute for it.

Do not suggest teaching a lower-grade version of the objective instead.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Is the target intact?
- Can the scaffolds run inside a normal lesson, or do they need extra time?

LP-030**Write evidence statements showing what mastery would look like**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Before planning the teaching, you want the finish line described precisely.

COPY THIS PROMPT

For this [GRADE] [SUBJECT] objective – [OBJECTIVE] – write evidence statements.

Each should describe something a student produces, says or does that would convince a colleague they have met the objective.

Give me:

- 4-5 evidence statements, from minimum sufficient to clearly beyond
- For each, an example of what that looks like in actual work
- The one piece of evidence to prioritise if I only have time for one
- Two things students often produce that look like evidence but are not, and why

Do not attach grades or percentages to these.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Would a colleague reading these agree the student met the objective?
- Are the false-positive examples ones you actually see?

WARM-UPS AND EXIT TICKETS

LP-004**Create a matched warm-up and exit ticket**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

You want the first five minutes and the last five to answer the same question.

COPY THIS PROMPT

For a [GRADE] [SUBJECT] lesson on [TOPIC] with the objective [OBJECTIVE], write
a matched pair: a warm-up and an exit ticket.

They must test the same thing, so that comparing them tells me what the lesson changed.

Give me:

- The warm-up: one question, answerable in 3 minutes, that a student could attempt before the lesson
- The exit ticket: the same demand, different surface, so they cannot pass by remembering the warm-up
- The answer to each
- What it means if a student gets the warm-up right and the exit ticket wrong
- What it means if most of the class gets both right – including whether the lesson was needed

Both should fit on a quarter sheet of paper.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Is the exit ticket a genuine variant, not a copy?
- Could you mark thirty of these in ten minutes?

LP-031**Design a warm-up that exposes prior knowledge in five minutes**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

You are about to teach something that depends on last year, and you are not sure last year happened.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Write a 5-minute [GRADE] [SUBJECT] warm-up that tells me what students already know about [PRIOR TOPIC] before I teach [NEW TOPIC].

It should surface what they know without feeling like a test.

Give me:

- The task, written as students see it
- The three levels of response I should expect, from secure to not-yet
- For each level, the one thing I would change about today's lesson
- A version I can run entirely verbally if paper is not practical

Do not include anything from the new topic. This is diagnosis, not a preview.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Does it genuinely avoid the new content?
- Can you sort thirty responses into the three levels while walking around?

LP-032**Write a misconception-revealing hinge question**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

The moment mid-lesson where you decide whether to move on.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Write a hinge question for a [GRADE] [SUBJECT] lesson on [TOPIC], to use at the point where I decide whether to move on.

Requirements:

- Multiple choice, 4 options, answerable in under a minute
- Every wrong option must correspond to a specific, common misconception – no throwaway distractors
- A student holding the misconception must be unable to reach the right answer by luck or elimination

Give me:

- The question and options
- The correct answer
- For each wrong option, exactly what the student is thinking
- What I do next for each: if most choose A, if most choose B, and so on

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Is every distractor a real misconception you have seen?
- Could a confused student guess right? If so, it is not a hinge question.

LP-033**Create an exit ticket with secure, developing and not-yet response bands**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

You want sorting, not scoring — three piles by the end of the corridor.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Write an exit ticket for a [GRADE] [SUBJECT] lesson on [OBJECTIVE].

Design it so responses fall into three visibly different groups, sortable in under five minutes.

Give me:

- The question
- A model answer for a secure response
- A realistic developing response – right idea, incomplete
- A realistic not-yet response – the most common wrong route
- The single feature I look for to sort each pile quickly
- What I do tomorrow with each group

Do not use percentages or marks. I am sorting, not scoring.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Are the three sample responses realistically different?
- Is the sorting feature visible at a glance?

LP-034**Turn yesterday's exit-ticket patterns into today's opening task**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

You read the exit tickets last night and want to act on them in the first five minutes.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Yesterday's [GRADE] [SUBJECT] exit ticket on [TOPIC] produced these patterns:

[DESCRIBE WHAT YOU SAW – e.g. "about half stopped after the first step; four reversed the operation; the rest were fine"]

Write today's opening task that addresses this without announcing who got it wrong.

Give me:

- A 5-7 minute opening that targets the main pattern
- How students who were already secure spend that time productively
- One sentence I say to frame it, that does not single anyone out
- What I check at the end of the opening before moving into today's lesson

Do not use any student names, and do not build anything that reveals who was in which group.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Could a student work out who got it wrong? Redesign if so.
- Do the secure students have something real to do?

LP-035**Build a retrieval-practice warm-up without introducing new content**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Spacing things out so they stay learned, not just met.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Write a 5-minute retrieval warm-up for [GRADE] [SUBJECT].

Pull from:

- Last lesson: [TOPIC]
- Last month: [TOPIC]
- Last term: [TOPIC]

Six short questions, roughly two from each, mixed in order rather than grouped.

Every question must be answerable from memory – no new content, no reference material.

Give me the questions, the answers, and one line on why each item is worth keeping alive.

Then give me the version I would use next week, with the same structure but different items, so I can see the pattern and build my own.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Is anything here actually new content in disguise?
- Are the older items ones you genuinely taught?

LP-036**Create a transfer exit ticket that cannot be answered by copying**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

They can do the examples from the board. You want to know if that means anything.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Write an exit ticket for a [GRADE] [SUBJECT] lesson on [TOPIC] that a student cannot answer by copying the pattern from today's examples.

Today's examples were: [DESCRIBE OR PASTE THEM]

The question must need the same thinking in a different shape – different context, or the unknown in a different place.

Give me:

- The question
- The answer
- Exactly what a pattern-copier will write, and why it is wrong
- One sentence of feedback for that student that points at the thinking rather than the answer

Keep it to one question, answerable in four minutes.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Is it genuinely different, or the same question with new numbers?
- Is it still fair — solvable from today's lesson, not tomorrow's?

LP-037**Audit an exit ticket for alignment, ambiguity and reading load**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

The results were confusing and you suspect the question, not the students.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Audit this [GRADE] [SUBJECT] exit ticket against the objective [OBJECTIVE].

Tell me:

- Whether a correct answer actually demonstrates the objective
- Any wording open to more than one reading, quoted exactly
- Whether the reading demand is higher than the subject demand – if a weak reader who understood the content would still get it wrong, say so
- Anything answerable by general reasoning without the lesson
- Whether it can honestly be done in the time given

Then give me a rewritten version fixing whatever you found, and say what you changed and why.

EXIT TICKET:

[PASTE IT]

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Does the rewrite still test the same objective?
- Is the reading level right for your actual class?

PACING AND TRANSITIONS

LP-038**Build a realistic minute-by-minute lesson timeline**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

The plan is good and you keep running out of time at the same point.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Build a realistic minute-by-minute timeline for this [MINUTES]-minute [GRADE] [SUBJECT] lesson.

Class size: [NUMBER]. Room: [DESCRIBE].

Include the time nobody plans for: settling, handing out and collecting materials, moving between seating arrangements, repeating an instruction, packing up.

Give me:

- The timeline, with those overheads shown as their own lines
- The total, so I can see whether it exceeds the period
- The two segments most likely to overrun, and by how much
- What comes out if I am five minutes behind at the halfway point

Do not compress the overheads to make it fit. If it does not fit, tell me.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Are the overhead estimates realistic for your class?
- Does the total actually fit the period?

LP-039**Diagnose where a lesson is likely to run out of time**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Before you teach it, not after.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Look at this [GRADE] [SUBJECT] lesson plan for [MINUTES] minutes and tell me where it will run out of time.

For each risk point:

- What takes longer than the plan assumes, and why
- A realistic estimate against the planned one
- Whether the overrun is avoidable or built into the activity

Then tell me the single change that buys the most time for the least loss, and what that loss is.

Assume a normal class, not an ideal one.

LESSON:

[PASTE IT]

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Do the risk points match where you have run over before?
- Is the suggested cut one you can live with?

LP-040**Write concise transitions between lesson segments**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Each changeover costs three minutes and you have four of them.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Write the transitions for this [GRADE] [SUBJECT] lesson.

For each changeover, give me:

- The exact words I say, under 15 seconds
- What students do with what they were holding
- How the next thing gets distributed or displayed
- The signal that tells me everyone is ready

Keep instructions to one action at a time. A [GRADE] class will do the first thing you say and forget the rest.

For the transition into group work, also tell me how groups form without a minute of negotiation.

LESSON:

[PASTE THE SEGMENTS]

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Is each instruction one action, or a list?
- Would these words sound like you saying them?

LP-041**Create a pacing contingency when discussion runs long**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

The discussion is going well and you do not want to kill it.

COPY THIS PROMPT

For this [GRADE] [SUBJECT] lesson, give me a contingency for when the discussion is genuinely productive and running over.

Give me:

- The decision point – at what time I decide, and what I am looking at
- What I cut, ranked, so I can cut one thing or three
- What I say to close the discussion without dismissing it
- How the lesson still ends with evidence, even in the shortest version
- The one thing I protect no matter what

Also tell me the signs that a discussion is running long because it is productive, versus running long because it has drifted.

LESSON:

[PASTE IT]

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Is the decision point early enough to act on?
- Does the shortest version still produce evidence?

LP-042**Plan meaningful early-finisher work connected to the objective**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Six students are done and you have eleven minutes left.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Students finishing [TASK] early in [GRADE] [SUBJECT] need work that extends the same thinking, not filler.

Give me five options that:

- Need no new instruction from me
- Take 5-15 minutes
- Use only what is already on their desk
- Could be shared with the class in one sentence

For each, say in one line what deeper thinking it demands.

No word searches, no colouring, and nothing that is simply more of the same questions. If a student would experience it as a punishment for working quickly, do not include it.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Would a student see these as reward or punishment?
- Do they genuinely need no explanation from you?

LP-043**Adapt one lesson for both a regular period and a shortened schedule**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

You teach the same lesson to two classes with different period lengths.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Adapt this [GRADE] [SUBJECT] lesson so it works at both [LONGER] minutes and [SHORTER] minutes.

Give me:

- A shared core both versions contain
- What the longer version adds, and where it fits
- What the shorter version does differently – not just faster
- The check that is identical in both, so I can compare across classes
- What I lose in the shorter version, stated plainly

Do not produce the short version by cutting the end. The lesson has to finish in both.

LESSON:

[PASTE IT]

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Does the short version have a real ending?
- Is the shared check truly identical?

SUBSTITUTE AND EMERGENCY PLANS

LP-005**Create a no-surprises substitute lesson**

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

You are ill at 6am and someone who does not know your subject is covering.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Write a substitute plan for [GRADE] [SUBJECT], [NUMBER] periods of [MINUTES] minutes.

Assume the substitute does not know the subject and has never met the class. The work must be meaningful, not busywork, and need no preparation.

Give me:

- Three lines on what this class is like and what to watch for
- Minute-by-minute timing for the period
- Exactly what to write on the board
- The task written out in full, ready to photocopy
- What to do when students say we have already done this
- What to do if students finish early
- What to leave me a note about

Write it as one page a stranger can follow top to bottom without asking anyone.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Could someone who has never taught your subject run this?
- Is anything here dependent on knowing your routines?

LP-044**Build an emergency no-print lesson from materials already in the room**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

No warning, no photocopier, whatever is in the cupboard.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Write an emergency [MINUTES]-minute [GRADE] [SUBJECT] lesson on [TOPIC] using only a board, students' own paper and pens, and their exercise books.

Nothing printed. Nothing prepared in advance. Nothing that needs a device.

Give me:

- What goes on the board, written exactly
- The task as I dictate it
- How students structure their answer on blank paper
- A partner check step
- How I collect or check the work in the last three minutes

Assume the substitute or I have had zero minutes to prepare. If the topic genuinely cannot be taught this way, say so and suggest a related one that can.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Is there truly nothing needing preparation?
- Is dictating the task realistic for your class?

LP-045**Write exact substitute directions that require no subject guessing**

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Your plan is good but the cover teacher filled the gaps wrong.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Rewrite these directions so a substitute who does not know [SUBJECT] can follow them without making any judgement calls.

For every step, replace anything requiring subject knowledge with an explicit instruction. If the plan says "discuss the answers", write out the answers.

Give me:

- The rewritten directions, numbered
- An answer key or model response for anything students produce
- Three questions students are likely to ask, with the exact reply
- What the substitute should do rather than guess, when something is not covered

Flag anything in my original that only works if the person already knows the subject.

DIRECTIONS:
[PASTE THEM]

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Does anything still assume subject knowledge?
- Are the answers correct? Check them yourself.

LP-046**Create a technology-failure backup for a digital lesson**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

The lesson depends on devices and the devices are a gamble.

COPY THIS PROMPT

This [GRADE] [SUBJECT] lesson depends on [TECHNOLOGY]. Write the backup for when it does not work.

Give me:

- The same learning goal reached without any technology
- What I can prepare in advance so the switch takes under two minutes
- The point in the lesson by which I must decide to switch
- What is genuinely lost in the offline version, stated honestly
- What I say to the class about the change

The backup must be a real lesson, not twenty minutes of holding them until the period ends.

LESSON:

[PASTE IT]

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Can you actually prepare the backup in advance and keep it to hand?
- Is the decision point early enough?

LP-047**Prepare an independent catch-up lesson for an unexpected absence**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

A student missed the lesson and you cannot reteach it one-to-one.

COPY THIS PROMPT

A [GRADE] student missed a [SUBJECT] lesson on [TOPIC]. Write something they can work through alone to catch up.

Give me:

- A short explanation of the idea, written to be read rather than taught
- One fully worked example with the reasoning shown, not just the steps
- Three practice items, increasing in difficulty, with answers
- A self-check: two questions that tell them whether they have got it
- One line telling them what to do if the self-check goes badly

Write it so a student reads it and works, without needing me to explain the explanation. Assume they may be doing this at home with no one to ask.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Could a student genuinely follow this alone?
- Is the reading level right for the student who missed it?

LP-048**Audit a substitute plan for safety, clarity and collection procedures**

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Before you file it in the emergency folder and forget about it.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Audit this substitute plan for [GRADE] [SUBJECT].

Check for:

- Any step needing subject knowledge the substitute may not have
- Any instruction with more than one reasonable interpretation
- Anything requiring materials, access or permissions that may not be available
- Missing procedures: what happens to finished work, who to contact, what if a student leaves the room
- Anything with a safety implication that is not stated as an explicit instruction

Tell me the single most likely point of failure, and the smallest fix for it.

I will check anything safety-related against my school's own procedures.

PLAN:

[PASTE IT]

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Check safety and emergency procedures against your school's policy.
- Is the collection procedure something the office would recognise?

PROJECTS AND INTERDISCIPLINARY

LP-049**Launch a project with a clear driving question and final product**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

The first lesson of a project, which decides whether the rest works.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Design the launch lesson for a [NUMBER]-week [GRADE] [SUBJECT] project on [TOPIC].

Give me:

- A driving question students cannot answer on day one but could by the end – open enough to sustain work, narrow enough to finish
- The final product, described as students will hear it
- The opening experience that makes the question feel worth answering
- What students produce by the end of this first lesson, so the launch is not only talk
- The three things students will ask immediately, with answers ready

Be honest about scope. If [NUMBER] weeks is not enough for this product, say so and suggest one that fits.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Is the driving question genuinely open, or a quiz question in disguise?
- Is the product achievable in the weeks you have?

LP-050**Connect two subjects around one authentic problem**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Cross-curricular work that is more than a shared theme word.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Design a [GRADE] project connecting [SUBJECT A] and [SUBJECT B] around a real problem.

The connection must be structural: the problem should be unsolvable using only one subject.

Give me:

- The problem, in student words
- What each subject contributes that the other cannot
- The specific learning from each subject that is genuinely used
- Where the two strands meet in the timeline
- How I assess each subject's learning separately, so one does not hide behind the other

If the honest connection is thin, say so rather than manufacturing one. A shared topic word is not a connection.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Is the connection structural or decorative?
- Can you separate the two subjects when marking?

LP-051**Break a multiweek project into milestones and checkpoints**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

So you find out in week two, not week five.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Break this [NUMBER]-week [GRADE] [SUBJECT] project into milestones.

Give me:

- A milestone per week, each producing something I can actually look at
- What "on track" looks like at each, and what "behind" looks like
- The specific intervention for a group that is behind at each milestone
- The week where projects most commonly collapse, and the checkpoint that catches it
- What students see, so they can self-monitor without me chasing them

Each milestone should be checkable in under two minutes per group.

PROJECT:

[PASTE THE OUTLINE]

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Can you really check each milestone in two minutes per group?
- Is the first checkpoint early enough to rescue a bad start?

LP-052**Create individual accountability inside a group project**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

One student does everything and three collect the grade.

COPY THIS PROMPT

For this [GRADE] [SUBJECT] group project, build in individual accountability.

Give me:

- A structure where each student produces something identifiably theirs
- An individual check that cannot be completed by a group member on someone else's behalf
- What I look at to see who understood, separately from what the group produced
- How I mark individual and group contributions without one swallowing the other
- What I do about a group where one student genuinely did most of the work

Do not rely on peer-rating forms as the main mechanism; build the accountability into the task itself.

PROJECT:

[PASTE THE OUTLINE]

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Could a passenger still pass? Redesign if so.
- Is the individual check quick enough to run for every student?

LP-053**Design a project rubric that measures learning rather than decoration**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

The best-looking poster keeps getting the best grade.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Write a rubric for this [GRADE] [SUBJECT] project.

Learning it should evidence: [WHAT STUDENTS SHOULD BE ABLE TO DO]

Rules:

- Most of the weight goes to thinking and subject learning
- Presentation is one small criterion, described in terms of whether it helps the reader – not effort or neatness
- Every criterion is something I can point at in the work
- Nothing rewards resources students may not have at home

Give me the criteria, what each looks like at proficient, and one sentence of feedback I could reuse for the most common near-miss on each.

Then tell me which criterion a student could game with effort but no learning.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Could a beautiful project with weak thinking score well? Fix if so.
- Does anything advantage students with better resources at home?

LP-054**Plan a public-product option that protects student privacy**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Real audience, real stakes — without putting children online.

COPY THIS PROMPT

For this [GRADE] [SUBJECT] project, design an option where students present to a real audience without exposing their identities or personal information.

Give me:

- Three audience options ranging from inside school to outside it
- For each, exactly what is shared and what is not
- How students are credited without full names or images
- What has to be checked or permitted before anything leaves the classroom
- An equivalent alternative for a student who cannot participate publicly, that is not visibly a lesser option

Do not suggest anything requiring students to hold personal accounts on public platforms.

I will confirm all of this against my school's own consent and safeguarding policy.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Check against your school's consent policy before anything is shared.
- Is the alternative genuinely equivalent, or obviously the lesser option?

REFLECTION AND ADAPTATION

LP-055**Turn lesson evidence into a next-day adjustment**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

You have the exit tickets in front of you and tomorrow to plan.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Here is what I saw in [GRADE] [SUBJECT] today on [TOPIC]:

[DESCRIBE THE EVIDENCE – exit ticket patterns, what you heard while circulating, what students got stuck on. No names.]

Tell me:

- What this evidence supports concluding, and what it does not
- The one adjustment for tomorrow that addresses the most students
- What that adjustment costs – what gets pushed back
- What I should look for tomorrow to know whether it worked
- Anything in my description that is my interpretation rather than what I observed

Do not recommend reteaching the whole lesson unless the evidence supports it.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Does the conclusion actually follow from what you saw?
- Is the adjustment small enough to do tonight?

LP-056**Write a post-lesson reflection based on observations rather than feelings alone**

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

"It went badly" is not something you can act on next week.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Help me turn this into a useful reflection on a [GRADE] [SUBJECT] lesson.

What happened: [DESCRIBE IT, INCLUDING HOW IT FELT]

Give me:

- What I actually observed, separated from what I concluded about it
- Three alternative explanations for what I observed, including ones that are not about my teaching
- What evidence would tell me which explanation is right
- One thing to try next time, and what I would watch to know whether it helped
- What was fine, so I do not change something that was working

Do not reassure me. I want the analysis.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Are the alternative explanations ones you had not considered?
- Is the "next time" specific enough to actually do?

LP-057**Identify what to keep, change and investigate after a lesson**

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

A quick sort, five minutes after the class leaves.

COPY THIS PROMPT

From this account of a [GRADE] [SUBJECT] lesson, sort it into three lists:

KEEP – worked, and I know why

CHANGE – did not work, and the fix is clear

INVESTIGATE – did not work, but I do not yet know why

For the CHANGE list, give me the specific fix.

For the INVESTIGATE list, give me the one question to answer next lesson and how I would find out.

If something belongs in INVESTIGATE, do not move it to CHANGE by guessing at a cause. Say plainly that the cause is unknown.

LESSON ACCOUNT:

[DESCRIBE WHAT HAPPENED – no student names]

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Has anything been moved to CHANGE that you do not actually understand yet?
- Is the KEEP list honest, or padded?

LP-058**Adapt a lesson after most learners miss the same misconception**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

It is not a few students. It is most of the class, making the same error.

COPY THIS PROMPT

In [GRADE] [SUBJECT], most of the class made this error on [TOPIC]:

[DESCRIBE THE ERROR PRECISELY – what they did, not what they failed to do]

Tell me:

- What thinking produces this error – the reasoning behind it, not just the fault
- Whether anything in a normal explanation of this topic actively encourages it
- A lesson that confronts the misconception directly rather than re-explaining the correct method
- The example that makes the misconception visibly fail
- How I check next lesson whether the old idea has genuinely gone, rather than gone quiet

Re-teaching the same way more slowly is not the answer I am looking for.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Does the explanation of their thinking ring true?
- Does the confronting example genuinely break under the misconception?

LP-059**Plan targeted follow-up for three anonymous response patterns**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Three distinct groups, one lesson, no way to run three lessons.

COPY THIS PROMPT

After a [GRADE] [SUBJECT] check on [TOPIC], responses fell into three patterns:

Pattern A: [DESCRIBE] – roughly [NUMBER] students

Pattern B: [DESCRIBE] – roughly [NUMBER] students

Pattern C: [DESCRIBE] – roughly [NUMBER] students

Plan a single [MINUTES]-minute lesson that moves all three forward.

Give me:

- What each group needs, in one line
- A shared opening all three can do
- The differentiated middle, with what each group works on
- Where I spend my time, and in what order
- A shared closing task that works for all three
- How groups are formed without labelling anyone

No student names, and nothing that makes the grouping visible as ability.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Could students decode the grouping? Change it if so.
- Does the group you are not sitting with have work they can do alone?

LP-060**Compare the intended lesson with what learners actually demonstrated**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

The lesson happened. Whether the learning did is a separate question.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Compare what this [GRADE] [SUBJECT] lesson intended with what students actually demonstrated.

INTENDED: [THE OBJECTIVE]

DEMONSTRATED: [WHAT THE WORK OR RESPONSES ACTUALLY SHOWED – no names]

Tell me:

- Where the gap is: was it the teaching, the task, the check, or the objective
- What the evidence supports, and where I would be over-reading it
- Whether the check was capable of showing the objective at all
- What I would need to see to be confident, and how to get it next lesson
- If the objective was too large for one lesson, say so

Be specific about which of the four is the problem. "A bit of everything" is not useful to me.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Do you agree with where it located the gap?
- Was your check ever capable of showing the objective?

Chapter 2 — Worksheets and Activities

40 PROMPTS

The difference between a worksheet that teaches and one that fills time is whether the difficulty is deliberate. These prompts build practice that ramps — starting where the class actually is, ending where you want them — and activities that keep running when you are on the other side of the room.

WHAT'S IN HERE

GROUP	PROMPTS	USE WHEN
Practice worksheets	13	Independent practice that builds properly
Learning stations	8	Four ways into one topic, one period
Collaborative tasks	5	Group work where everyone has to think
Review games	5	Before an assessment, without the chaos
Homework sets	5	Work that survives leaving your room
Project briefs	5	Longer tasks students run themselves

WORTH KNOWING BEFORE YOU START

Ask for the answer key in the same request. Fetching it separately produces a key that does not quite match the questions.

Say how long students have. A worksheet built without a time limit is always too long.

For anything students do in groups, ask what you should look for while walking around. That line is usually the most useful part of the output.

PRACTICE WORKSHEETS

WA-001**Build a focused practice worksheet**Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Independent practice on one skill, that gets harder in the right order.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Create a practice worksheet on [SKILL] for [GRADE] [SUBJECT].

Students have [MINUTES] minutes. They have just been taught [WHAT YOU TAUGHT].

Structure it in four blocks:

- 2 warm-up items anyone who was present can do
- 5 core items that get harder one step at a time
- 2 items combining this with [EARLIER TOPIC]
- 1 challenge item

For each block, keep the difficulty change to one thing at a time – do not make the numbers harder and the wording harder in the same step.

Give me:

- The worksheet exactly as students receive it
- The full answer key, with working where the answer alone is not enough
- Which single item is the "if they get this, they have it" question
- The item most students will get wrong, and what that tells me

Do not pad the sheet to fill a page.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Work the answer key yourself before photocopying.
- Does difficulty rise one step at a time, or jump?
- Can it honestly be finished in the time you gave?

WA-005**Create practice that moves from a model to independent work**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

The gap between "we did it together" and "now do it alone" keeps losing people.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Create a [GRADE] [SUBJECT] practice sheet on [SKILL] that fades support across the page.

Four stages, in this order:

1. A fully worked example with the reasoning written out, to read not to do
2. The same kind of item with two steps done and the rest blank
3. The same kind with only the first step given
4. Three items with nothing given

The mathematics or content difficulty must stay the same across all four. The only thing changing is how much support is on the page.

Give me the sheet as students see it, the answer key, and one line telling me what it means if a student can do stage 2 but not stage 4.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Is the content difficulty genuinely constant across the four stages?
- Does the worked example show the thinking, or just the steps?

WA-006**Write a worksheet that targets one common misconception**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

You know exactly what they are getting wrong and want to go straight at it.

COPY THIS PROMPT

My [GRADE] [SUBJECT] students are making this error on [TOPIC]:

[DESCRIBE THE ERROR – what they do, not what they fail to do]

Build a worksheet that confronts it.

Include:

- 3 items where the misconception produces a visibly wrong answer
- 2 items where the misconception happens to give the right answer, so students see that being right is not proof of understanding
- 1 item asking them to explain why a fictional student's wrong method fails
- 1 item where they have to decide which of two methods applies

Give me the answer key, and for each item say what a correct answer proves.

Do not simply re-explain the correct method. The sheet should make the wrong idea break in front of them.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Do the "accidentally right" items genuinely work that way? Check them.
- Is the fictional student's error the one your class actually makes?

WA-007**Build mixed practice that requires learners to choose a strategy**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

They can do each method when told which one. Not when they have to decide.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Create a mixed practice sheet for [GRADE] [SUBJECT] covering these methods:

[LIST THE METHODS OR TOPICS]

Do not group the items by method and do not label which is which. Students must work out what applies.

Give me:

- 10 items in a deliberately mixed order
- 2 items where more than one method works, and which is more efficient
- 1 item where a plausible method does not work, and why
- The answer key, with the intended method noted for me only
- A one-line prompt I can put at the top asking students to name their method before solving

Tell me which pair of methods students most often confuse here.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Is the order genuinely mixed, or does a pattern creep back in?
- Does the "more than one works" item actually have two valid routes?

WA-008**Create a short retrieval worksheet for previously taught skills**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Keeping older learning alive without spending a lesson on it.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Write a 10-minute retrieval sheet for [GRADE] [SUBJECT].

Pull from:

- Last week: [TOPIC]
- Last month: [TOPIC]
- Last term: [TOPIC]

Two or three items from each, interleaved rather than grouped by topic.
Everything must be answerable from memory – no reference material, no notes.

Give me:

- The sheet
- The answer key
- A one-line note per item on why it is worth keeping alive
- A version I could run next week with the same shape but different items

Do not introduce anything new. If a topic I listed needs something students have not been taught, say so instead of including it.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Is anything here new content in disguise?
- Are the older topics ones you genuinely taught this class?

WA-009**Design an application worksheet using realistic classroom contexts**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Word problems that do not insult the reader.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Create an application worksheet on [SKILL] for [GRADE] [SUBJECT].

Use contexts a [GRADE] student would actually recognise. No talking animals, no scenarios where nobody would ever need the answer, and no situations that assume money, travel or possessions a family may not have.

Give me:

- 6 items in realistic contexts, increasing in how much the student has to extract from the wording
- 1 item containing information that is not needed, so they have to select
- 1 item where a required piece of information is missing, and the correct response is to say what is missing
- The answer key

Keep the reading demand appropriate for [GRADE]. If a context needs background knowledge some students may not have, flag it.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Do any contexts assume money, travel, or a kind of home life?
- Is the reading level right for your weakest reader?

WA-010**Adapt a worksheet for black-and-white printing and limited space**

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

One page, one side, and the colour printer is a fantasy.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Rework the worksheet below so it prints on one side of one sheet in black and white.

Constraints:

- Nothing that depends on colour to be understood
- No shading that turns into a grey block on a school photocopier
- Enough writing space for a [GRADE] student's handwriting
- Readable at 100% – do not solve the space problem by shrinking the type

Give me:

- The reworked sheet
- What you cut or compressed, and what is lost
- Anywhere colour was carrying meaning, and what replaces it

If it genuinely will not fit on one side, say so and tell me the best two-page split.

WORKSHEET:

[PASTE IT]

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Is the writing space enough for actual handwriting?
- Print one copy on the real photocopier before running thirty.

WA-011**Create an error-analysis worksheet from fictional student work**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Finding the mistake teaches more than avoiding it.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Create an error-analysis worksheet on [TOPIC] for [GRADE] [SUBJECT].

Use fictional students – invented names like "Student A" – and invented work. Do not ask me to supply real student work, and do not imply the examples are real.

Give me 4 pieces of fictional work:

- One with a single clear error
- One where the method is right and the arithmetic is wrong
- One where the arithmetic is right and the method is wrong
- One that is fully correct but looks unusual

For each, students must say: what was done, where it goes wrong, and what to do instead. Give me the answers.

Then tell me which of the four is hardest to diagnose, and why.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Are the errors realistic ones your students make?
- Is the "correct but unusual" one genuinely correct? Check it.

WA-012**Write a worksheet with foundation, application and reasoning sections**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

One sheet the whole class can work on at their own depth.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Create a three-section worksheet on [TOPIC] for [GRADE] [SUBJECT].

Section 1 – Foundation: can the student do the procedure

Section 2 – Application: can they use it in a context

Section 3 – Reasoning: can they explain, justify, or spot when it does not apply

Every student attempts all three sections. The sections are not ability groups and must not be labelled as such.

Give me:

- 4 items in section 1, 3 in section 2, 2 in section 3
- The answer key
- What it means if a student is fine in section 1 and stuck in section 3
- A single reasoning item I could put on the board for the whole class

Keep section 3 accessible to a student who found section 1 hard – it should demand different thinking, not more of the same.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Could a student who struggled in section 1 still attempt section 3?
- Do the sections test different things, or the same thing three times?

WA-013**Audit and repair a worksheet whose questions are repetitive or unclear**

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

The sheet exists. It is not working and you are not sure why.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Audit this [GRADE] [SUBJECT] worksheet.

For each item tell me:

- What it actually asks the student to do
- Whether it adds anything the previous items did not already test
- Any wording open to more than one reading, quoted exactly
- Whether the reading demand is higher than the subject demand

Then:

- Name the items I could delete without losing anything
- Rewrite the two worst-worded items
- Tell me what the sheet never tests but should

Be direct. If the sheet is ten versions of the same question, say so.

WORKSHEET:

[PASTE IT]

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Do you agree the flagged items are genuinely redundant?
- Do the rewrites still test what you wanted?

WA-002**Design four learning stations**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

One topic, four ways in, one period.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Design 4 stations on [TOPIC] for [GRADE] [SUBJECT], [MINUTES] minutes each.

Class size: [NUMBER]. Materials available: [LIST].

Each station uses a different mode – one hands-on, one reading, one talking, one writing – and must run without me standing at it.

For each station give me:

- The instruction card exactly as students read it, under 40 words
- Materials, using only what I listed
- What students leave behind as evidence
- What I check in the three seconds I walk past
- What the group does if they finish early

Then give me the rotation table and what I say to start each rotation.

Flag anything needing materials I have not listed.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Can a group genuinely run each station without you?
- Do the four stations fit the materials you actually have?

LEARNING STATIONS

WA-014**Create hands-on, reading, discussion and writing stations**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

You want four genuinely different kinds of thinking, not four worksheets.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Build 4 stations on [TOPIC] for [GRADE] [SUBJECT] where each demands a different kind of thinking, not just a different activity.

- Hands-on: students manipulate something and notice a pattern
- Reading: students extract specific information from a short text
- Discussion: students must disagree productively about something
- Writing: students explain or justify in their own words

For each: the instruction card, materials, the evidence left behind, and the one thing that usually goes wrong there.

Then tell me which station is the hardest to run well, and what to do about it.

The four should build on each other in any order – a student should not need to do the reading station before the hands-on one.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Do the four genuinely demand different thinking?
- Does any station secretly depend on doing another one first?

WA-015**Plan station rotations for a large class and small room**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Thirty-two students, a room built for twenty-four, and you still want stations.

COPY THIS PROMPT

I have [NUMBER] students in a room that is [DESCRIBE THE SPACE – desks fixed or movable, floor space, how many can stand at once].

Plan station rotations for [NUMBER OF STATIONS] stations in [MINUTES] minutes.

Give me:

- Group sizes and how many groups
- The physical layout, described so I could sketch it
- The rotation order, and the route each group walks so paths do not cross
- What I say to move them, under 15 seconds
- The realistic transition time, counted into the total
- What changes if two students are absent, or two extra arrive

Do not assume I can move furniture. If the plan needs a bigger room, say so and give me the best version that fits this one.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Do the walking routes actually work in your room?
- Is transition time counted in, or bolted on at the end?

WA-016**Build self-checking stations that do not depend on the teacher**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

You want to be at one station, not answering "is this right?" from four.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Design [NUMBER] stations on [TOPIC] for [GRADE] [SUBJECT] where students can check their own work.

Each station needs a self-check that does not simply hand over the answer – for example a total that must match, a pattern that only appears if the work is right, or a card that gives the answer only after a written attempt.

For each station:

- The task
- The self-check mechanism, described so I can build it from paper
- What students do when the check fails
- What stops a student skipping to the answer

Then tell me which station will still generate questions for me, and what those questions will be.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Can a student get the answer without doing the work?
- Can you build every check from paper this week?

WA-017**Create one quiet station and three collaborative stations**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Some students need to work in silence, and that should not be a punishment.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Design 4 stations on [TOPIC] for [GRADE] [SUBJECT]: three collaborative and one where students work alone in silence.

The quiet station must be as interesting as the others – not the leftover worksheet. A student choosing quiet should not be choosing less.

Give me:

- All four station cards
- What makes the quiet station genuinely worth doing
- How a student ends up at the quiet station without announcing anything about themselves
- How I keep the noise from the other three from reaching it

Do not label it as being for anyone in particular.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Would a student see the quiet station as a downgrade?
- Can a student choose it without drawing attention?

WA-018**Differentiate station access while preserving one shared objective**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Same destination, different entry points, one discussion at the end.

COPY THIS PROMPT

For these [GRADE] [SUBJECT] stations on [TOPIC], build in different entry points while keeping one shared objective.

For each station give me:

- The core task
- A supported version – more scaffolding, same thinking
- An extended version – same topic, harder thinking, not more questions
- What every version produces, so they all feed one closing discussion

The versions must not be labelled by ability, and a student should be able to move between them without asking permission.

Tell me how the closing discussion works when different students did different versions.

STATIONS:

[PASTE THEM, or describe the topic and I will design them]

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Could the class decode which version is "the easy one"?
- Does the closing discussion genuinely include all three?

WA-019**Design a teacher-led reteaching station from exit-ticket evidence**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

You have ten minutes with the group that needs you, while the rest run stations.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Last lesson's exit ticket on [TOPIC] showed this pattern in [GRADE] [SUBJECT]:

[DESCRIBE WHAT YOU SAW – no student names]

Design a 10-minute teacher-led station that addresses it, to run while other groups work independently.

Give me:

- What I do in the first two minutes to find out where each student actually is
- The reteach, aimed at the thinking rather than the procedure
- Two questions I ask that reveal whether it has landed
- What each student takes away to try alone
- How I keep it to 10 minutes when it wants to run to 20

Assume I cannot see the rest of the room properly while I am doing this – tell me what to set up beforehand so it survives my not looking.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Is ten minutes realistic for this reteach?
- Is the rest of the room genuinely self-sufficient for that long?

WA-020**Audit station directions, timing, materials and accountability**

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Before you laminate eight cards and find out on the day.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Audit these [GRADE] [SUBJECT] stations.

Check each one for:

- Instructions a student could misread, quoted exactly
- Whether the task fits the time given, honestly
- Materials assumed but never listed
- Whether anything is produced that I could actually look at afterwards
- Whether a student could sit through the whole rotation doing nothing

Then tell me:

- Which station will fail first, and why
- The smallest fix for it
- Which station is doing the least work for the time it takes

Be blunt about the weak one.

STATIONS:

[PASTE THEM]

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Do you agree with which station it called weakest?
- Is the timing judgement based on your class, or an ideal one?

COLLABORATIVE TASKS

WA-003**Create an accountable group task**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Group work where one student cannot carry the other three.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Design a [MINUTES]-minute group task on [TOPIC] for [GRADE] [SUBJECT], groups of [NUMBER].

Build the accountability into the task itself, not into a peer-rating form.

Give me:

- A task that genuinely needs more than one person – not one job split up
- What each student personally produces, identifiable as theirs
- A group product that cannot be completed unless every part arrives
- One question I ask any individual at the end to check they understood the whole thing, not only their piece
- What I do about the group where one student did most of it

Tell me plainly whether a passenger could still get through this task. If yes, fix it before giving me the final version.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Could one strong student do the whole thing alone? Redesign if so.
- Does every student leave something with their own name on it?

WA-021**Design a jigsaw task where every learner holds essential information**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Everyone is necessary, and the task proves it.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Design a jigsaw task on [TOPIC] for [GRADE] [SUBJECT].

Groups of [NUMBER]. Each student gets a different piece, and the final task is impossible without all of them.

Give me:

- The [NUMBER] information pieces, written out in full and roughly equal in difficulty and length
- The final task, which cannot be done from any one piece
- The expert-group step: what students with the same piece do together first
- The exact instruction for teaching your piece to your group
- What I check to know a piece was genuinely taught rather than handed over
- What happens when a student is absent and their piece is missing

No piece should be obviously the easy one or obviously the important one.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Are the pieces genuinely equal in difficulty?
- Is the final task truly impossible from one piece? Try it.

WA-022**Build a group investigation with rotating cognitive roles**

Grades 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Roles that mean thinking, not roles that mean stationery.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Design a group investigation into [QUESTION] for [GRADE] [SUBJECT], groups of [NUMBER], over [MINUTES] minutes.

Give each student a role defined by the thinking it demands – for example the one who challenges every claim, the one who checks the evidence, the one who tracks what is still unknown. No timekeepers, no material-fetchers, no scribes-as-a-role.

For each role give me:

- What that student is responsible for thinking about
- Two sentences they can say to do their job when they get stuck
- What goes wrong in the group when nobody does it

Then tell me when roles rotate, and what students carry over when they change.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Is every role about thinking, or is one just admin?
- Would a shy student be able to perform their role?

WA-023**Create a consensus task that requires evidence and disagreement**

Grades 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

You want them to argue about the content, properly.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Design a consensus task on [TOPIC] for [GRADE] [SUBJECT] where groups must reach agreement they can defend.

Requirements:

- A genuinely arguable question with more than one defensible answer
- Evidence provided in the task, so students argue from something rather than from opinion
- A rule that a group cannot agree until they can state the strongest case against their own answer
- What a group records, including where they disagreed and how it resolved

Give me the task, the evidence, sentence starters for disagreeing without it becoming personal, and what I look for while circulating.

Do not choose a question where one answer is obviously right.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Is the question genuinely arguable, or is there a right answer?
- Is the supplied evidence enough to argue from?

WA-024**Turn an individual worksheet into meaningful collaborative reasoning**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

The worksheet is fine. Doing it in pairs would be better than doing it twice.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Convert this [GRADE] [SUBJECT] worksheet into a task worth doing in pairs.

The point is not to halve the work. Restructure it so two people thinking produce something one person could not.

Options to consider: each student gets different items and must explain theirs;
one solves while the other predicts and they compare; both attempt separately then reconcile differences.

Give me:

- The restructured task
- The exact instruction pairs receive
- What each student still produces individually
- The one moment in the task where they genuinely have to talk

If this worksheet is better done alone, say so rather than forcing it.

WORKSHEET:

[PASTE IT]

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Is the pair version better, or just louder?
- Does each student still leave individual evidence?

WA-025**Audit a group task for participation, access and individual evidence**

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

It looked collaborative. You are not sure it was.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Audit this [GRADE] [SUBJECT] group task.

Tell me:

- Whether one student could complete it alone while the others watch
- Where a quiet student can contribute without having to compete for airtime
- What evidence I get about each individual, and what I only get about the group
- Anything that assumes a skill unrelated to the objective – presenting, drawing, reading quickly – and whether that is fair here
- Whether the task actually needs a group

End with the single change that would most improve it. If the honest answer is that this should be individual work, say that.

TASK:

[PASTE IT]

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Do you agree with what it said about passengers?
- Are you comfortable with how little individual evidence there is?

REVIEW GAMES

WA-004**Build a review game that measures learning**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

A game that also tells you who is ready for the test.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Design a [MINUTES]-minute review game on [TOPIC] for [GRADE] [SUBJECT], [NUMBER] students.

It must give me usable information about who knows what – not just a winner.

Give me:

- The rules, in under 60 words, as I would say them
- [NUMBER] questions covering the whole topic, with answers
- How every student answers every question, so I am not sampling the confident
- What I record while it runs, without stopping the game
- How points work so a team that is behind can still catch up, and nobody is eliminated
- What I do with what I learned, next lesson

No speed-based scoring – it rewards the fast, not the correct.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Does every student answer every question, or only the loud ones?
- Can you actually record anything while running it?

WA-026**Create a no-speed review game using mini-whiteboards**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Everyone answers, you see all thirty at once, nobody is racing.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Design a mini-whiteboard review game on [TOPIC] for [GRADE] [SUBJECT].

All students answer every question and hold up on a signal, so nobody is rewarded for being fast.

Give me:

- The signal routine, in the words I use
- 12 questions with short answers I can read across a room at a glance
- The answers
- What I do when I see a wrong answer held up – the exact words, not shaming
- Two questions designed so the wrong answers tell me something specific
- How I keep score without making a slower student the reason a team lost

Tell me which questions to keep if I only get through half.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Are the answers short enough to read at a distance?
- Does your response to a wrong board avoid singling anyone out?

WA-027**Design a team review game with individual accountability**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Teams, but the strong student cannot answer for everyone.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Design a team review game on [TOPIC] for [GRADE] [SUBJECT], teams of [NUMBER].

Build in a rule that means any team member might have to answer, so the whole team has to make sure everyone understands.

Give me:

- The rules, in under 60 words
- How the answering student is chosen so it is unpredictable but not frightening
- [NUMBER] questions with answers, mixed in difficulty
- Team discussion time before answering, and how long
- What stops one student from simply telling the others the answer
- How I handle a team that leaves a member behind

Nobody is eliminated and no team is out of the running before the end.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Would a struggling student find the selection method frightening?
- Is there real reason for teams to teach each other?

WA-028**Build a misconception challenge using diagnostic distractors**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

A game where the wrong answers are the whole point.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Design a review activity on [TOPIC] for [GRADE] [SUBJECT] built from multiple-choice questions where every wrong option is a real misconception.

Give me 10 questions. For each:

- The question and four options
- The correct answer
- What a student choosing each wrong option is thinking
- Whether that misconception is common enough to be worth teaching into

No throwaway distractors. If I cannot name the thinking behind an option, it should not be there.

Then tell me the three misconceptions most worth a follow-up lesson, and what that lesson would open with.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Can you name the thinking behind every wrong option?
- Are these misconceptions your class actually has?

WA-029**Create a low-prep review game with paper question cards**

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Tomorrow morning, scissors, and nothing else.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Design a review game on [TOPIC] for [GRADE] [SUBJECT] needing nothing but paper I print and cut tonight.

No devices, no board, no buying anything, no laminating.

Give me:

- The cards, laid out so I can print and cut them in one pass
- How many sets I need for [NUMBER] students, and how many students per set
- The rules, under 50 words, printable on a card students keep
- How students check answers without me
- What I do with the sets afterwards so they are reusable

Tell me exactly how long the printing and cutting will take. If it is more than fifteen minutes, simplify it.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Is the prep honestly under fifteen minutes?
- Can students check answers without you?

WA-030**Audit a review game for fairness, accuracy and useful teacher data**

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

It was fun. You are not sure it taught or told you anything.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Audit this [GRADE] [SUBJECT] review game.

Tell me:

- Whether every student participates, or only the confident ones
- Whether it rewards speed, luck or volume over knowing the answer
- Whether a student can be eliminated or publicly wrong, and what that costs
- What information I actually get about who knows what
- Whether any question is wrong, ambiguous, or tests something else

Then give me the single change that would make it most useful to me as assessment, without making it less enjoyable.

GAME:

[PASTE THE RULES AND QUESTIONS]

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Check any question it flagged as wrong, yourself.
- Are you willing to lose some of the fun for the information?

HOMEWORK SETS

WA-031**Create a short homework set with a clear purpose**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Homework that is worth the argument it causes at home.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Create a homework set on [TOPIC] for [GRADE] [SUBJECT], designed to take [MINUTES] minutes.

State the purpose first – practice, retrieval, or preparation for next lesson –
and build only for that.

Give me:

- The purpose in one sentence, printed at the top for the family to read
- The items, no more than the time allows
- The answer key
- The one item I mark first to learn the most
- What a student does if they get stuck and nobody at home can help

Nothing that needs the internet, a printer, an adult who knows the subject, or materials a household may not have.

If [MINUTES] is not enough for the purpose, tell me rather than overfilling it.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Time it honestly. Homework always takes longer than planned.
- Could a student with no help at home complete this?

WA-032**Build homework that mixes retrieval and current learning**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Keeping the old alive while practising the new.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Create a homework set for [GRADE] [SUBJECT] mixing:

- Today's learning: [TOPIC]
- Something from last month: [TOPIC]
- Something from last term: [TOPIC]

Roughly half on today's work, half on the older material, interleaved rather than in sections.

Give me:

- The items and answer key
- Why each older item is worth keeping alive
- What it tells me if a student gets today's work right and last term's wrong
- A version for next week with the same structure, so I can see the pattern

Total time: [MINUTES]. Do not exceed it.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Is the older material genuinely taught to this class?
- Does the mix fit the time?

WA-033**Design homework with a meaningful no-internet option**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Not every student has a device or a connection, and that is not their fault.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Create a homework task on [TOPIC] for [GRADE] [SUBJECT] in two versions of equal value: one using a device, one entirely on paper.

The paper version must not be the lesser option. Same learning, same effort, same standing.

Give me:

- Both versions
- What each produces, so I can mark them the same way
- How a student chooses without announcing anything about their home
- The answer key for both

Do not put the paper version in brackets as an alternative. Print both as equal choices.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Would a student feel marked out by choosing paper?
- Are the two genuinely equal in demand?

WA-034**Create a family-readable homework guide without requiring family teaching**

Grades K-2, 3-5

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Families want to help, and should not have to teach the method.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Write a short note to families explaining tonight's [GRADE] [SUBJECT] homework on [TOPIC].

It must help without asking the family to teach anything.

Include:

- What the homework is for, in two sentences and no jargon
- What "helping" looks like here – the questions to ask rather than the answers to give
- What to do if the student is stuck for more than [MINUTES] minutes: stop, write a note, and it is fine
- One line making clear that not finishing is information for me, not a failure

Under 150 words. Written for any adult, at any reading level, in any home situation. Do not assume a parent, a quiet room, or subject knowledge.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Does it assume a parent rather than any adult?
- Is "stop after X minutes" permission clear enough to be believed?

WA-035**Audit a homework set for workload, access and answer-key accuracy**

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Before thirty families spend an evening on it.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Audit this [GRADE] [SUBJECT] homework set.

Tell me:

- How long it will realistically take a middling student, versus what I claimed
- Anything needing internet, a printer, materials, or adult subject knowledge
- Anything a student who was absent could not do
- Any item where the answer key is wrong or the question is ambiguous – quote it
- Whether the whole set has a purpose, or is just volume

Then tell me what to cut so it fits [MINUTES] minutes, and what is lost.

Check every answer.

HOMEWORK:

[PASTE IT WITH THE KEY]

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Verify any answer it flagged, yourself.
- Is the realistic timing closer to the truth than yours was?

PROJECT BRIEFS

WA-036**Write a student-ready project brief from a supplied objective**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

A brief students can follow without asking you what it means.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Write a project brief for [GRADE] [SUBJECT], to run over [TIME].

Objective: [WHAT STUDENTS SHOULD BE ABLE TO DO]

Write it for students, not for me. Include:

- What they are making, in one sentence
- Why it is worth making
- What it must contain – the parts that are about the learning, listed first
- What is up to them
- Deadlines, with what is due at each
- How it will be judged, in the words I will actually use
- The three questions students will ask on day one, answered in advance

Keep it to one page. If the objective is too large for [TIME], say so.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Could a student start without asking you a question?
- Is the learning listed before the presentation?

WA-037**Create project milestones, checkpoints and submission requirements**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

So you find out in week two, not the night before it is due.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Break this [TIME] [GRADE] [SUBJECT] project into milestones.

Give me:

- A milestone per [WEEK/LESSON], each producing something I can look at
- What "on track" and "behind" look like at each
- The specific intervention for a group behind at each point
- The checkpoint that catches a project heading for failure earliest
- What students see, so they can self-monitor without me chasing them
- The final submission requirements, listed as a checklist students tick

Each checkpoint must be checkable in under two minutes per student or group.

PROJECT:

[PASTE THE BRIEF]

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Two minutes per group — is that honest for your class size?
- Is the first checkpoint early enough to rescue a bad start?

WA-038**Design a choice-based project with equivalent learning demands**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Real choice, without one option being obviously the easy one.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Design [NUMBER] project options on [TOPIC] for [GRADE] [SUBJECT], all evidencing the same objective: [OBJECTIVE]

They must be genuinely equivalent in demand. Not one written, one poster, one video where the poster is clearly least work.

For each option give me:

- What the student produces
- How the objective is evidenced through it
- The time it honestly takes
- What makes it hard – the thinking, not the format

Then tell me which option students will pick expecting it to be easier, and whether they are right. If they are, fix that option.

None should need resources a student may not have at home.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Which would you pick if you wanted to do least? Fix that one.
- Does any option need equipment from home?

WA-039**Build a group-project brief with individual evidence of mastery**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

A group grade that does not hide who learned what.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Write a group project brief for [GRADE] [SUBJECT] on [TOPIC], groups of [NUMBER], over [TIME].

Every student must leave individual evidence of the objective, separate from the group product.

Give me:

- The brief as students receive it
- The group product
- The individual component each student produces, which cannot be done by someone else on their behalf
- How the two are marked separately
- What I do about a group where one student did most of the work
- What happens when a group member is absent for a week

Tell me honestly whether a passenger could pass. If yes, change the design.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Could a passenger pass? That is the whole test of this brief.
- Is the individual component quick enough to mark for every student?

WA-040**Audit a project brief for clarity, feasibility and privacy**

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Before you hand it out and spend three weeks answering questions.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Audit this [GRADE] [SUBJECT] project brief.

Tell me:

- Anything a student could reasonably misread, quoted exactly
- Whether it fits the time given, honestly
- Anything requiring money, internet, transport, adult help, or equipment a household may not have
- Whether the marking rewards the learning or the presentation
- Anything that would put a student's name, image, work or personal details in front of an audience, and what needs consent first
- The three questions students will ask on day one that the brief does not answer

Give me the single change that would help most.

I will check anything involving consent or sharing against my school's policy.

BRIEF:

[PASTE IT]

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Check consent and sharing against your school's policy, not this draft.
- Are the day-one questions ones you can answer now?

Chapter 3 — Assessment, Rubrics and Quizzes

40 PROMPTS

A good question does more than sort right from wrong — it tells you **what** the student misunderstood. That is the idea running through this whole chapter: distractors that mean something, rubrics a student can act on, and checks that separate real understanding from having copied the method.

WHAT'S IN HERE

GROUP	PROMPTS	USE WHEN
Quizzes and tests	13	A full assessment with a key
Formative checks and exit tickets	7	Finding out today, not next week
Rubrics	7	Marking that is fair and fast
Diagnosis and misconceptions	5	You know they are stuck; where exactly
Answer keys and feedback	4	Comments that change what they do next
Standards-based grading	4	Reporting against standards

WORTH KNOWING BEFORE YOU START

Check the maths and the facts yourself. This is the chapter where an unverified error reaches a student's grade. The model will produce a wrong answer key with complete confidence.

Ask what each wrong option reveals. That turns marking into diagnosis and costs you nothing extra.

Single-point rubrics — one column describing proficient — are faster to write and far faster to mark than a full grid. Several prompts here use them.

QUIZZES AND TESTS

AS-001

Create a balanced classroom assessment

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

An end-of-unit test that covers the unit rather than the last two lessons.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Create an assessment on [TOPIC] for [GRADE] [SUBJECT], to be sat in [MINUTES] minutes.

What was taught: [LIST THE OBJECTIVES OR LESSONS]

Balance it: roughly 40% recall and procedure, 40% application, 20% reasoning. Do not let the last thing taught dominate simply because it is freshest.

Give me:

- The paper as students receive it, with marks shown per question
- The full answer key with working
- A blueprint table: each question against which objective it tests
- Any objective the paper never assesses
- The two questions I mark first to learn the most
- An honest estimate of how long a middling student needs, versus the time given

Check every calculation and factual claim. Flag anything you are unsure of rather than presenting it as verified.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Work the whole key yourself before printing.
- Does the blueprint match what you actually taught?
- Sit the paper against a clock. Papers always run long.

AS-005**Build a short quiz across recall, application and reasoning**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Ten minutes, and you want to know more than whether they revised.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Write a [MINUTES]-minute quiz on [TOPIC] for [GRADE] [SUBJECT].

Three sections, clearly different in what they demand:

- Recall: can they retrieve it
- Application: can they use it in a familiar context
- Reasoning: can they explain, justify, or spot where it does not apply

A student who revised by memorising should do well in the first section and struggle in the third. That contrast is the point.

Give me the quiz, the answer key, and one line per section on what a strong or weak performance there tells me.

Keep it to one side of paper.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Could a memoriser pass the reasoning section? Redesign if so.
- Does it fit on one side at a readable size?

AS-006**Write diagnostic multiple-choice questions with purposeful distractors**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Multiple choice where the wrong answers do the teaching.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Write [NUMBER] multiple-choice questions on [TOPIC] for [GRADE] [SUBJECT].

Every wrong option must be a specific misconception a real student holds. No filler options, nothing obviously absurd, and no "all of the above".

For each question give me:

- The stem and four options
- The correct answer
- For each wrong option, the exact thinking that leads there
- Whether a student holding that misconception could reach the right answer by elimination – if yes, fix the question

Then tell me which two questions would be most worth putting on the board for a whole-class discussion, and what I would ask about them.

If you cannot name the thinking behind an option, do not include it.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Can you name the thinking behind every wrong option?
- Could a confused student eliminate their way to the answer?

AS-007**Create a constructed-response assessment with a scoring guide**

Grades 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Extended answers, marked consistently, without three hours of agonising.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Create [NUMBER] constructed-response questions on [TOPIC] for [GRADE] [SUBJECT].

For each question give me:

- The question, with the command word doing real work
- What a full-credit response contains, as a list of the things I look for
- A response that has the knowledge but not the structure
- A response that has the structure but thin content
- The scoring guide: what earns each mark, in language I could defend to a parent

Do not award marks for length, neatness, or restating the question. If a criterion cannot be pointed at in the writing, take it out.

Then tell me the fastest order to mark these in, and why.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Could two teachers apply this guide and agree?
- Is anything being marked that is not the learning?

AS-008**Design a pre-assessment that separates prerequisite and grade-level skills**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Before a unit, to find out what is actually missing.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Design a [MINUTES]-minute pre-assessment before a [GRADE] [SUBJECT] unit on [TOPIC].

Two clearly separated parts:

- Prerequisites: the earlier skills this unit assumes
- Grade-level: a small sample of what the unit will teach, so I can see who already knows some of it

Give me:

- Both parts and the answer key
- What each prerequisite item tells me if it is missed
- How to read the four combinations: strong or weak on prerequisites, crossed with strong or weak on grade-level content
- What I do differently for each combination

Students should not be able to tell which part is which from looking at it. Do not make the prerequisite section feel like a test of last year.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Are the prerequisites genuinely required by this unit?
- Would a student feel judged on last year's teaching?

AS-009**Build a cumulative assessment without over-weighting recent lessons**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

A term test, where the first half of term deserves to appear.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Build a cumulative assessment for [GRADE] [SUBJECT] covering:

[LIST THE TOPICS, WITH ROUGHLY WHEN EACH WAS TAUGHT]

Weight the paper by how much the learning matters, not by how recently it was taught. Tell me the weighting you chose and why.

Give me:

- The paper and full answer key
- A table showing marks per topic against teaching time and importance
- Which older topic students will have forgotten most, and one question that distinguishes forgotten from never learned
- Where topics are combined in a single question, so the paper tests connections rather than isolated recall

Total time: [MINUTES]. Say if the coverage cannot fit honestly.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Do you agree with the weighting it chose?
- Is any older topic represented by only one question it could fluke?

AS-010**Adapt an assessment for a shorter testing period**

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

The period got cut and the test still has to happen.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Cut this [GRADE] [SUBJECT] assessment from [ORIGINAL] to [NEW] minutes.

Do not simply delete the last questions. Decide what the assessment is really for and protect the coverage.

Tell me:

- What you cut and what evidence is lost
- Any objective now untested, so I know what I am no longer measuring
- Where two questions can merge into one that tests both
- The revised paper and key
- Whether the shortened version still supports the decision I need to make

If the cut leaves the assessment unable to do its job, say so and tell me what to do instead.

ASSESSMENT:
[PASTE IT]

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Are you comfortable with the objectives it dropped?
- Does the merged question actually test both things?

AS-011**Create parallel assessment forms with equivalent demand**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Two versions, and neither class should be able to claim theirs was harder.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Create two parallel forms of an assessment on [TOPIC] for [GRADE] [SUBJECT].

Each question on Form B must match its counterpart on Form A in what it tests and in difficulty – not just have different numbers.

Give me:

- Both forms, question by question, side by side
- Both answer keys
- For each pair, a note on why the difficulty is genuinely equivalent
- Any pair where you are not confident they match, flagged honestly
- Which pair is most at risk of drifting harder or easier

Do not change the numbers in a way that changes the method needed. If a substitution makes one version harder, say so.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Work both keys. Substitutions often change the method needed.
- Do you agree the flagged pair is the risky one?

AS-012**Audit a test for alignment, ambiguity and answer-key errors**

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Before thirty students sit it and one of them is right and marked wrong.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Audit this [GRADE] [SUBJECT] assessment against its objectives.

For each question tell me:

- Which objective it tests, or that it tests none
- Whether a correct answer proves the objective
- Any wording open to a second reading, quoted exactly
- Whether the reading demand exceeds the subject demand
- Whether the answer key is correct – check every one, show your working

Then tell me:

- The question most likely to be challenged by a student, and whether they would be right
- Any objective the paper never tests
- The single change that would most improve the paper

OBJECTIVES: [PASTE THEM]

ASSESSMENT AND KEY: [PASTE THEM]

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Verify every key error it claims, yourself. It can be wrong about being right.
- Would you concede the challengeable question?

AS-013**Turn a supplied objective list into a complete assessment blueprint**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Planning what to assess before writing a single question.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Build an assessment blueprint for [GRADE] [SUBJECT] from these objectives:

[PASTE THE OBJECTIVES]

Total time: [MINUTES]. Total marks: [NUMBER].

Give me a table with, for each objective:

- Marks allocated, and the reason for that weighting
- The type of question that suits it – some objectives cannot be tested by multiple choice, and you should say which
- How many questions
- The cognitive level being targeted

Then tell me:

- Which objective is hardest to assess in writing, and the closest workable proxy
- Any objective I should assess another way instead
- Whether the marks and the time are consistent with each other

Do not write the questions yet. This is the plan.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Does the weighting match what you actually value?
- Is the "assess another way" suggestion practical for you?

AS-003**Build a student-readable analytic rubric**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

A rubric students read before they start, not after they are marked.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Build an analytic rubric for [TASK] in [GRADE] [SUBJECT], assessing [OBJECTIVE].

Write every descriptor for the student, in words a [GRADE] student uses.

Requirements:

- 4-5 criteria maximum, each about the learning
- Four levels, each described by what is present rather than what is missing
- No word that requires my judgement of effort, attitude or neatness
- Nothing that penalises the same weakness in two criteria

Give me the rubric, plus one sentence per criterion a student could use to self-check before submitting.

Then tell me which criterion two teachers would be most likely to score differently, and how to tighten it.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Could a student read this and know what to do?
- Is the same weakness costing marks twice anywhere?

FORMATIVE CHECKS AND EXIT TICKETS

AS-002**Create hinge questions for live teaching**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

The moment mid-lesson when you decide whether to move on.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Write [NUMBER] hinge questions for a [GRADE] [SUBJECT] lesson on [TOPIC], to use at the point where I decide whether to continue.

Each must be answerable in under a minute, by the whole class at once.

For each give me:

- The question and its options
- The correct answer
- What each wrong option means the student is thinking
- What I do if most of the class chooses each option – a specific next move, not "review the concept"

A student holding a misconception must not be able to reach the right answer by guessing or eliminating. If that is possible, rewrite the question.

Do not give me a mastery percentage. Describe what the responses show; the decision is mine.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Is each next move concrete enough to do immediately?
- Could a confused student guess right?

AS-014**Build a five-minute check for understanding during instruction**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Halfway through, before you build anything else on top.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Design a 5-minute check to run midway through a [GRADE] [SUBJECT] lesson on [TOPIC].

It must be quick to give, quick to read across a room, and tell me something I can act on in the same lesson.

Give me:

- The check itself
- How every student responds, so I am not sampling the confident
- What I look for as I scan the room, in one sentence
- Three things I might see, and the immediate next move for each
- How long it honestly takes including handing anything out

If the check needs more than five minutes to be useful, say so and tell me what a five-minute version can and cannot tell me.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Can you genuinely read thirty responses at a glance?
- Is each next move something you can do in the same lesson?

AS-015**Write an exit ticket that distinguishes three levels of understanding**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Three piles by the time you reach the staffroom.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Write an exit ticket for a [GRADE] [SUBJECT] lesson on [OBJECTIVE].

Design it so responses sort into three visibly different groups in under five minutes of looking.

Give me:

- The question, answerable in three minutes
- A model secure response
- A realistic developing response – right idea, incomplete
- A realistic not-yet response – the most common wrong route
- The single feature I look for to sort each pile fast
- What I do tomorrow with each group

No marks and no percentages. I am sorting, not scoring.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Are the three sample responses realistically distinct?
- Is the sorting feature visible without reading every word?

AS-016**Create a misconception poll with actionable response options**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

A show of hands that actually tells you something.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Write a quick poll on [TOPIC] for [GRADE] [SUBJECT] that I can run with a show of hands, fingers, or coloured cards.

Give me:

- The question, said aloud in under 20 seconds
- Four options, each corresponding to a distinct way of thinking
- What a room split between options A and C tells me, versus a room split between A and B
- The follow-up question I ask a student who chose each option, without revealing whether they were right
- What I do if the room is evenly split four ways

Students must not be able to read the right answer off my face or off which option I said last.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Do the follow-up questions avoid giving the answer away?
- Would students be honest, or copy the hands going up first?

AS-017**Design a show-me task using mini-whiteboards or paper**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Every student answers, and you see all of it at once.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Design a show-me task on [TOPIC] for [GRADE] [SUBJECT] using mini-whiteboards or scrap paper.

Give me:

- The prompt, short enough that the answer fits on a board and is readable across a room
- The signal routine, in my words, so everyone reveals at the same moment
- What a correct board looks like at a glance
- Three wrong boards I should expect, and what each means
- Exactly what I say when I see a wrong board – no shaming, no singling out
- The follow-up prompt for the whole class based on what I see

Answers must be short. If the task needs a paragraph, it is the wrong task for this format – say so.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Is the answer readable from four metres away?
- Would your response to a wrong board embarrass anyone?

AS-019**Create a transfer question that reveals reasoning rather than recall**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

They can do the board examples. You want to know what that is worth.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Write a transfer question on [TOPIC] for [GRADE] [SUBJECT] that cannot be answered by copying the pattern from today's examples.

Today's examples were: [DESCRIBE OR PASTE THEM]

The question must need the same thinking in a different shape – a new context, or the unknown in a different place.

Give me:

- The question and the answer
- Exactly what a pattern-copier will write, and why it fails
- One feedback sentence for that student aimed at the thinking, not the answer
- Whether the question is still fair – solvable from today's lesson alone

It must not require anything I have not taught. Tell me if it does.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Is it a different shape, or the same question with new numbers?
- Is everything needed to answer it actually taught?

AS-020**Audit a formative check for speed, reading load and decision usefulness**

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

The check took ten minutes and told you nothing.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Audit this [GRADE] [SUBJECT] formative check.

Tell me:

- How long it honestly takes to give and to read, versus what I assumed
- Whether a weak reader who understood the content would still get it wrong
- What decision the results actually let me make, stated plainly
- Whether any student can complete it without revealing what they understand
- Whether it samples the whole class or only those who volunteer

Then tell me the smallest change that would make the results more useful, and whether this check is worth the lesson time at all.

CHECK:

[PASTE IT]

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- If it says the check is not worth the time, do you agree?
- Is the reading demand fair for your weakest reader?

AS-018**Turn anonymous responses into a next-day formative check**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Yesterday's responses are in front of you and tomorrow needs planning.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Yesterday's [GRADE] [SUBJECT] check on [TOPIC] produced these patterns:

[DESCRIBE WHAT YOU SAW – how many did what. No names.]

Design tomorrow's opening check that follows up on this.

Give me:

- A 5-minute check aimed at the main pattern
- What students who were already secure do during it, that is not waiting
- One sentence framing it that does not reveal who got what wrong
- What I compare against yesterday to know whether anything changed
- What it means if the same pattern appears again

Do not build anything that lets the class work out who was in which group.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Could students decode who struggled? Redesign if so.
- Do the secure students have something real to do?

RUBRICS

AS-021**Create observable descriptors for four performance levels**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Four levels that mean something more than "good, quite good, not good".

COPY THIS PROMPT

Write four-level descriptors for this criterion in [GRADE] [SUBJECT]:

[CRITERION]

Task: [TASK]

Each level must describe what is present in the work, not what is missing. "Does not include evidence" is a marking note; "Uses one piece of evidence, stated without explanation" is a descriptor.

Give me:

- The four descriptors
- A concrete example of work at each level
- The boundary between levels 2 and 3, stated as the one thing that changes
- Any word in my criterion too vague to observe, and its replacement

Do not use "sometimes", "usually", "adequate", "appropriate" or "effective" without saying exactly what would count.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Is the 2/3 boundary something you could defend to a parent?
- Any vague words left?

AS-022**Turn an objective and task into aligned rubric criteria**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

The rubric should measure the objective, not the artefact.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Derive rubric criteria for this [GRADE] [SUBJECT] task.

Objective: [OBJECTIVE]

Task: [TASK]

Give me:

- 3-5 criteria that come from the objective, not from the format of the task
- For each, the evidence in the work that shows it
- Anything the task demands that the objective does not – presentation, handwriting, creativity – and whether it belongs in the rubric at all
- Anything in the objective the task cannot evidence

If the task cannot evidence the objective, say so plainly and tell me the smallest change to the task that would fix it.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Are you marking the learning or the artefact?
- Do you agree with what it said the task cannot evidence?

AS-023**Build a single-point rubric with feedback space**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Faster to write, far faster to mark, and the feedback is specific.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Build a single-point rubric for [TASK] in [GRADE] [SUBJECT].

Format: one centre column stating what proficient looks like for each criterion,
with blank columns either side for what is not yet there and what goes beyond.

Give me:

- 4-5 criteria maximum, in student-readable language
- The proficient descriptor for each
- Three reusable feedback sentences per criterion for the not-yet column
- Three for the beyond column
- The one criterion I should look at first when marking

The blank columns stay blank in the template – I fill them per student. Do not pre-fill them with generic levels.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Are the reusable sentences specific enough to be worth reusing?
- Could a student self-assess against the centre column?

AS-024**Create a rubric for collaborative work with individual evidence**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

A group mark that does not hide who learned what.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Build a rubric for this [GRADE] [SUBJECT] group task assessing [OBJECTIVE].

Two separate parts:

- Group criteria: what the group produced together
- Individual criteria: what each student personally demonstrated

The individual part must be markable from something the student produced alone.

It cannot rest on my impression of who talked most.

Give me:

- Both sets of criteria with descriptors
- What each student produces that carries the individual evidence
- How the two parts combine, and whether they should
- What I do when the group product is strong and one student's evidence is thin

Do not include peer-rating scores as a criterion. Tell me why if you disagree.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Can you mark the individual part without relying on memory?
- Is a quiet student penalised anywhere here?

AS-025**Rewrite vague rubric words as observable evidence**

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Your rubric says "shows good understanding" and nobody knows what that means.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Rewrite this [GRADE] [SUBJECT] rubric so every descriptor points at something observable in the work.

For each vague phrase:

- Quote it
- Say what it probably means here
- Replace it with what I would actually see

Pay particular attention to: good, appropriate, effective, adequate, clear, thorough, engaging, creative, sometimes, mostly, and consistently.

Then flag any criterion that is really about effort, personality or compliance rather than learning, and tell me whether it belongs in the rubric.

RUBRIC:

[PASTE IT]

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Could two teachers now agree on a borderline piece?
- Are you willing to drop the effort criteria it flagged?

AS-026**Calibrate a rubric using fictional work samples**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Testing the rubric before it meets real work.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Write fictional student work samples to test this [GRADE] [SUBJECT] rubric.

Give me four invented pieces – use "Student A", "Student B" and so on, and make

clear they are fabricated for calibration:

- One clearly at the top level
- One clearly at the bottom
- Two genuinely borderline between adjacent levels

For each: the sample, the score each criterion should receive, and the reasoning.

Then tell me:

- Which criterion was hardest to apply to the borderline samples
- What that reveals about the rubric's wording
- The change that would make the borderline cases decidable

Do not use real student work and do not present these as real.

RUBRIC:

[PASTE IT]

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Do you score the borderline samples the same way it did?
- Is the wording problem it found a real one?

AS-027**Audit a rubric for double penalties, bias and irrelevant criteria**

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Before it decides anyone's grade.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Audit this [GRADE] [SUBJECT] rubric.

Tell me:

- Where the same weakness costs marks under two criteria
- Any criterion that measures something other than the learning – presentation, handwriting, resources available at home, confidence in speaking
- Anywhere a student with weaker language would score lower despite equal understanding
- Any descriptor requiring me to judge effort or attitude
- Where two adjacent levels are not actually distinguishable

Then give me the single change that would make it fairest, and say which criterion I could delete entirely without losing anything.

RUBRIC:

[PASTE IT]

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Is the double penalty it found real? That one matters most.
- Would you defend every remaining criterion to a parent?

DIAGNOSIS AND MISCONCEPTIONS

AS-004**Diagnose errors from anonymous work**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

A pile of wrong answers, and you want the reason rather than the count.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Here are the errors from a [GRADE] [SUBJECT] task on [TOPIC]. No names.

[DESCRIBE OR LIST WHAT STUDENTS ACTUALLY WROTE]

For each distinct error tell me:

- The thinking that produces it – the reasoning, not the fault
- Whether it is a slip, a gap in prerequisite knowledge, or a wrong idea about the concept
- Roughly how many students it affects, from what I described
- Whether anything in a standard explanation of this topic encourages it

Then rank the errors by how much they will block what comes next, and tell me which one to address first.

Where my description is not enough to tell two causes apart, say so and tell me what to look for rather than guessing.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Does the explanation of their thinking match what you saw?
- Where it said it could not tell, do you know how to find out?

AS-028**Code anonymous responses by misconception rather than score alone**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Turning a stack of scripts into groups you can teach.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Help me sort a set of [GRADE] [SUBJECT] responses on [TOPIC] by what students were thinking, not by how many marks they got.

The question was: [PASTE IT]

The responses I am seeing: [DESCRIBE THE RANGE, no names]

Give me:

- 3-5 codes, each a distinct way of thinking
- The observable marker for each – what I look for to assign a script in seconds
- Which codes can appear in the same script
- Two scripts that would score the same but belong in different codes, and why that distinction matters more than the score

Keep the codes few enough to hold in my head while marking.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Can you assign a script in a few seconds using these markers?
- Is the same-score-different-code example one you recognise?

AS-030**Distinguish a careless slip from a conceptual misunderstanding**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Reteaching a concept someone already understands wastes everyone's time.

COPY THIS PROMPT

For this [GRADE] [SUBJECT] error on [TOPIC] – [DESCRIBE IT] – help me tell whether it is a slip or a misunderstanding.

Give me:

- What the error looks like when it is a slip
- What it looks like when the concept is wrong
- The signs that separate them in the written work itself
- One question I could ask the student that settles it in thirty seconds, without leading them to the answer
- What I do in each case

If my description does not contain enough to distinguish them, say so and tell me what else to look at in the work.

Do not assume it is a slip because the student is usually strong.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Does the thirty-second question avoid leading them?
- Are the written signs ones you can actually see in the work?

AS-029**Build flexible reteaching groups from response patterns**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Three groups, one lesson, and no permanent labels.

COPY THIS PROMPT

From these [GRADE] [SUBJECT] response patterns on [TOPIC], build reteaching groups.

Pattern A: [DESCRIBE] – about [NUMBER] students

Pattern B: [DESCRIBE] – about [NUMBER] students

Pattern C: [DESCRIBE] – about [NUMBER] students

Give me:

- What each group actually needs, in one line
- Which group I sit with first, and why
- What the other two do that is genuinely useful without me
- How groups are formed without the class reading them as ability
- The check at the end that tells me whether to regroup or move on

These groups exist for one lesson. Tell me what would make me dissolve them.

No student names anywhere in this.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Could the class decode the grouping? Change it if so.
- Does the group you leave alone have real work?

AS-031**Create targeted mini-tasks for three misconception groups**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Fifteen minutes, three different problems, one room.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Write three 15-minute mini-tasks, one for each of these [GRADE] [SUBJECT] misconceptions on [TOPIC]:

1. [DESCRIBE]
2. [DESCRIBE]
3. [DESCRIBE]

Each task must confront the specific wrong idea, not re-explain the correct method more slowly.

For each give me:

- The task
- The moment in it where the misconception visibly fails
- The answer
- What a student who has genuinely shifted will write differently
- What to do if they complete it and the misconception survives

All three should be startable without me explaining them, since I can only be in one place.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Does each task genuinely break the wrong idea?
- Can students start all three without you?

AS-032**Plan a reassessment that shows whether reteaching worked**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

You retaught it. Now you need to know if that changed anything.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Design a reassessment after reteaching [TOPIC] to [GRADE] [SUBJECT].

The original problem was: [DESCRIBE THE MISCONCEPTION OR GAP]

Give me:

- Questions that test the same thing in a different form, so a student who memorised my reteaching examples cannot pass on recall
- One question where the old misconception would still show, if it survived
- The answer key
- What it means if results improve on the familiar form but not the new one
- How soon after reteaching to run this, and why

Do not reuse the original questions. Tell me if the gap between the two assessments is too short for the result to mean anything.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Could a student pass by remembering your reteaching examples?
- Is the timing gap it recommended workable for you?

ANSWER KEYS AND FEEDBACK

AS-033**Create a complete worked answer key from verified questions**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

A key you could hand to a cover teacher or a student.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Write a full worked answer key for the [GRADE] [SUBJECT] questions below.

For each question:

- The answer
- The working, step by step, with the reasoning at each step
- The most likely wrong answer and where it comes from
- Where partial credit is defensible, and for what

Check every calculation. Where you are not fully certain of a factual claim or a result, say so explicitly rather than presenting it as verified – I would rather have a flag than a confident error.

At the end, list any question where the wording allows a second defensible answer.

QUESTIONS:
[PASTE THEM]

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Work every answer yourself. This is the highest-risk prompt in the chapter.
- Take the flagged uncertain items seriously.

AS-034**Write actionable feedback matched to common response patterns**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Thirty pieces of feedback that are specific without writing thirty essays.

COPY THIS PROMPT

For this [GRADE] [SUBJECT] task on [TOPIC], write reusable feedback matched to the response patterns I am seeing:

[DESCRIBE THE PATTERNS, no names]

For each pattern give me:

- One or two sentences of feedback naming what the student did and the single next step
- Written to the student, in [GRADE]-appropriate language
- A blank [SPECIFIC EXAMPLE] I fill from their actual work

Rules: no praise sandwiches, nothing about effort or attitude, one next step only, and never a comment a student cannot act on by themselves.

Then tell me which pattern needs a conversation rather than written feedback.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Could the student act on this alone?
- Is anything here about effort rather than the work?

AS-035**Audit an answer key for mathematical, factual and scoring errors**

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Before you mark thirty papers against it.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Check this [GRADE] [SUBJECT] answer key against its questions.

For each item:

- Recompute or re-derive the answer independently and show your working
- Say whether the key is right, wrong, or arguable
- Where wrong, give the correct answer and where the key went astray
- Where arguable, say what other answer a student could defend

Then tell me:

- Any question where the mark allocation does not match the work required
- Any place partial credit is unclear, so I would mark inconsistently

Where you cannot verify something independently, say so rather than agreeing with the key by default.

QUESTIONS AND KEY:

[PASTE THEM]

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Verify anything it calls an error, yourself. It can be wrong too.
- Decide the arguable answers before you start marking, not during.

AS-036**Create learner-friendly solution explanations without hiding reasoning**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Solutions a student can learn from, rather than copy.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Rewrite these [GRADE] [SUBJECT] solutions so a student can learn from them.

For each:

- Show every step, including the ones a teacher does in their head
- Say why each step, not only what
- Name the decision point – where a student has to choose an approach – and what tells them which to choose
- Add one line on what to check at the end

Do not skip steps to be concise, and do not use "clearly", "obviously" or "it follows that". If it were obvious the student would not need the solution.

Keep the language at [GRADE] level.

SOLUTIONS:

[PASTE THEM]

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Any "obviously" left in?
- Would a stuck student get unstuck from this, or just copy it?

STANDARDS-BASED GRADING

AS-037**Map assessment evidence to supplied standards and objectives**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Reporting against standards, from work you already have.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Map this [GRADE] [SUBJECT] assessment to the standards below.

Give me a table showing, for each standard:

- Which questions provide evidence for it
- How strong that evidence is – a single question is thin evidence, say so
- What part of the standard is never evidenced
- Whether a student could score well on those questions without meeting the standard

Then tell me which standards I cannot honestly report on from this assessment, and what additional evidence would be needed.

Use only the standard wording I paste. Do not fill gaps with what a standard like this usually says.

STANDARDS: [PASTE THE EXACT WORDING]

ASSESSMENT: [PASTE IT]

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Are you reporting on any standard it called thinly evidenced?
- Does the mapping use your standard's real wording?

AS-038**Create a standards-based proficiency scale with observable evidence**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

A scale that describes learning rather than counting marks.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Build a proficiency scale for this [GRADE] [SUBJECT] standard:

[PASTE THE EXACT WORDING]

Give me four levels, each describing what the student can do, with:

- An observable description
- An example task a student at that level completes successfully
- The specific thing that changes between each level and the next
- What evidence I would need to place a student there confidently

Do not attach percentages or mark ranges. The levels describe learning, not arithmetic.

Then tell me the level most often assigned too generously, and what to look for to avoid that.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Could you place a real student using only these descriptions?
- Is the over-generous level one you recognise in your own marking?

AS-039**Summarize class mastery without averaging unrelated skills**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

A single average hides everything that matters.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Summarise where my [GRADE] [SUBJECT] class stands on these standards, from this evidence:

STANDARDS: [LIST THEM]

EVIDENCE: [DESCRIBE PERFORMANCE PER STANDARD – no names]

Report each standard separately. Do not average across standards; a student secure in one and lost in another is not "middling".

Give me:

- A per-standard summary of where the class is
- Which standard the class is weakest on, and whether that is a teaching problem or an assessment problem
- Which standard I have the thinnest evidence for
- What a single overall average would have hidden here

Say plainly where the evidence is too thin to report on at all.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Do you agree with teaching problem versus assessment problem?
- Are you reporting anything it called too thin?

AS-040**Audit a standards-based grade summary for missing or weak evidence**

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Before the grades go out and someone asks how you decided.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Audit this [GRADE] [SUBJECT] standards-based summary.

Tell me:

- Which standards rest on a single piece of evidence
- Where the evidence is all of one type, so I am measuring one format rather than the learning
- Any standard where recent work outweighs everything else without a reason
- Anywhere a behaviour or effort judgement has crept into an academic standard
- Which judgement I would find hardest to defend if a family questioned it

Then tell me the one standard I should gather more evidence on before reporting.

SUMMARY:

[PASTE IT]

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Could you defend the judgement it flagged as weakest?
- Has effort crept into an academic standard anywhere?

Chapter 4 — Differentiation and Mixed Ability

35 PROMPTS

Differentiation fails when it quietly becomes three separate lessons running in one room, or when "support" turns into a permanently lower expectation. These prompts keep one destination and change the route: same objective, same closing discussion, different ways in.

WHAT'S IN HERE

GROUP	PROMPTS	USE WHEN
Scaffolds	8	Same task, more support
Tiered tasks	6	Three versions, one objective
Multilingual support	6	Language load down, expectation unchanged
Reading and accessibility	6	The text is the barrier, not the idea
Extensions	4	Real work for those who finish early
Flexible grouping	4	Who works with whom, and for how long

WORTH KNOWING BEFORE YOU START

Never name a student. Describe the need — "students reading about two years below grade level" — not the person.

Ask for neutral names for the routes. Anything that reads as a ranking will be decoded by the class within one lesson.

Push back if an extension is just more questions. Extension means harder thinking, not extra volume, and several prompts here say so outright.

Whatever accommodation you supply must survive into the draft. Check that it did.

SCAFFOLDS

DF-001

Add temporary scaffolds without lowering the goal

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Some of the class cannot start, and the target is not moving.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Add scaffolds to this [GRADE] [SUBJECT] task so more students can access it, without changing what the task demands.

Task: [PASTE IT]

Objective: [OBJECTIVE]

The barrier I am seeing: [DESCRIBE IT – not who has it]

Give me:

- Three scaffolds, each addressing a different barrier
- For each, exactly what changes on the page or in what I say
- For each, what the student still has to do themselves – the thinking the scaffold must not take over
- When and how each scaffold comes off

Do not simplify the content, reduce the number of steps in the reasoning, or turn an open question into a closed one. If a scaffold cannot be added without doing that, say so.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Does the student still do the thinking, or has the scaffold done it?
- Is the removal plan real, or "eventually"?

DF-005**Turn an observed barrier into a targeted support plan**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

You have watched them struggle and want to name what is actually in the way.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Here is what I observed in [GRADE] [SUBJECT] on [TOPIC]:

[DESCRIBE WHAT STUDENTS DID AND SAID. No names.]

Help me work out what the barrier actually is.

Give me:

- Three possible barriers consistent with what I described – for example prerequisite knowledge, reading demand, working memory load, unfamiliar format, or the task being unclear
- What I would see in each case that I am not seeing in the others
- A five-minute check that tells them apart
- The support that follows from each, and the support that would waste time if I picked the wrong one

Do not infer anything about a student's ability, home life, motivation or attention. Stay with what the work shows.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Does the check genuinely separate the three?
- Has it stayed with the work rather than the student?

DF-006**Create a graphic organizer that preserves essential reasoning**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Organisers often organise the thinking away.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Design a graphic organiser for this [GRADE] [SUBJECT] task: [TASK]

The organiser must hold the structure while leaving the reasoning to the student. Boxes that only need copying are not helping.

Give me:

- The organiser, described so I could draw it on a board
- What goes in each section, as the student sees it
- The one section where the actual thinking happens, and why it stays blank
- What a completed one looks like when it is done well
- What a completed one looks like when the student filled boxes without thinking

Then tell me what this organiser makes harder, since every structure closes something off.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Could a student fill this in correctly without understanding?
- Is the thinking still theirs to do?

DF-007**Write sentence frames at three levels of language support**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

They know the answer and cannot get it into a sentence.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Write sentence frames for [GRADE] [SUBJECT] students explaining [WHAT THEY MUST EXPLAIN].

Three levels of support:

- Heavy: most of the sentence given, student supplies the content words
- Medium: the structure given, student supplies the substance
- Light: a starter only

At every level the student must supply the reasoning. A frame that can be completed correctly without understanding is not a frame, it is a fill-in.

Give me 3-4 frames per level, plus one completed example each.

Then tell me how a student moves from heavy to light, and what tells me they are ready.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Could a student complete the heavy frames without understanding?
- Is there a route off the frames, or do they become permanent?

DF-008**Break a complex task into checkpoints without doing the thinking**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

The task is right; its size is what defeats them.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Break this [GRADE] [SUBJECT] task into checkpoints: [PASTE THE TASK]

Chunk it by natural decision points, not into equal-sized pieces. Each checkpoint should be somewhere a student could go wrong and not know it.

Give me:

- The checkpoints, with what the student has at each
- The self-check at each: how they know to continue rather than asking me
- What I look at if a student is stuck, to see which checkpoint they lost it at
- What the student still decides – the chunking must not remove the choices

Do not turn the task into a set of instructions to follow. If splitting it would do that, tell me and suggest a different support.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Has it become a recipe? Then the thinking is gone.
- Can a student self-check without you?

DF-009**Add worked examples and prompts with a clear fade plan**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Worked examples help, until they become the only thing students can do.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Build a faded sequence for [SKILL] in [GRADE] [SUBJECT].

Four stages:

1. Fully worked example, with the reasoning at each step
2. Same difficulty, last two steps blank
3. Same difficulty, only the first step given
4. Nothing given

The content difficulty must stay constant across all four. The only variable is support.

Give me the four stages, the answers, and:

- What tells me a student is ready to move on
- What it means if they can do stage 2 but not stage 4
- The point in this sequence students most often get stuck, and why

Do not make the later stages harder to compensate for having less support.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Is the difficulty genuinely constant across the four?
- Does the worked example show the thinking, or just the steps?

DF-010**Create a scaffold menu learners can choose from responsibly**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Students choosing their own support, without it becoming a way to avoid work.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Design a scaffold menu for this [GRADE] [SUBJECT] task: [TASK]

Students choose what support to take. Give me:

- 4-5 supports, each addressing a different difficulty
- The one-line description a student reads to decide
- What each support does not do, so nobody expects it to give the answer
- How a student takes one without announcing anything about themselves
- The prompt I use to get them to try without a support first

No support should be so complete that taking it removes the learning. Tell me which of yours comes closest to that line.

Do not label supports by level, ability, or in any order that reads as a ranking.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Which support would a student take to avoid thinking? Trim it.
- Can students take one privately?

DF-011**Audit classroom supports for dependence and hidden lower expectations**

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

The supports have been in place a while and nobody has asked whether they should be.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Audit the supports I am using in [GRADE] [SUBJECT]:

[DESCRIBE THEM – what they are, who tends to use them, how long they have been in place. No names.]

Tell me:

- Which supports are doing the thinking rather than enabling it
- Which have quietly become permanent, and what that costs
- Where a support is really a lower expectation with a friendlier name
- Which students would now succeed without a support, and what evidence would confirm that
- Any support that marks out who receives it

Then tell me which one to remove first, how to remove it, and what to watch for afterwards.

Be blunt. A support that has been in place all year with no plan to remove it is the thing I most need to hear about.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Which support have you never questioned? Start there.
- Is any support visibly marking out who gets it?

TIERED TASKS

DF-002**Create three routes to the same objective**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Same destination, three ways in, one discussion at the end.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Build three routes to this [GRADE] [SUBJECT] objective: [OBJECTIVE]

Base task: [PASTE IT]

All three end at the same mastery check and feed the same closing discussion.

For each route give me:

- The task as students receive it
- What thinking it demands – this must be the same across all three
- What differs: the support, the representation, or the entry point
- What it produces for the closing discussion

Rules:

- Name them neutrally, in no order that reads as a ranking
- A student can move between routes without asking permission
- The extension route is harder thinking, not more questions

Then tell me how the closing discussion works when different students took different routes.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Could the class decode which route is "the easy one"?
- Does the closing discussion genuinely include all three?

DF-012**Build scaffolded, on-level and extension versions of one task**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

One task, three versions, running at the same time in one room.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Take this [GRADE] [SUBJECT] task and give me three versions: [PASTE IT]

- Scaffolded: same thinking, more support
- On-level: as written, tightened if it needs it
- Extension: same topic, genuinely harder thinking – not more items

All three must run in the same room at the same time, need the same materials, and finish in the same time.

Give me the three versions, and:

- What is identical across all three, and what changes
- Where I spend my time, and in what order
- The common check all three students complete
- What each version tells me that the others do not

If the extension is just more of the same, rewrite it before giving it to me.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Is the extension harder thinking, or more work?
- Do all three genuinely finish in the same time?

DF-013**Tier a task by representation rather than by easier content**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Changing how the idea is presented, not how demanding it is.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Tier this [GRADE] [SUBJECT] task by changing the representation, keeping the content demand identical.

Task: [PASTE IT]

Give me the same task presented:

- Concretely, with physical or visual materials
- Pictorially or diagrammatically
- Abstractly or symbolically

For each:

- The task as the student sees it
- What is genuinely the same about the thinking required
- Which students this representation helps, described by need, not by label
- How a student moves toward the abstract version

None of these is the easy version. If one has ended up less demanding, tell me and fix it.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Is the demand truly equal, or is the concrete one easier?
- Is there a path toward the abstract, or does it stop at concrete?

DF-014**Create three entry points with one common mastery product**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Different starts, identical evidence at the end.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Design three entry points into [TOPIC] for [GRADE] [SUBJECT], all producing the same final piece of evidence.

Objective: [OBJECTIVE]

Give me:

- Three openings, differing in how much prior knowledge they assume
- The point where all three converge
- The single mastery product every student produces, identical across entries
- What the product shows, and what it cannot show about the route taken
- How I mark it the same way regardless of entry point

A student's entry point must not be readable from their final product. If it would be, change the product.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Could you tell from the product which entry a student used?
- Do the three genuinely converge, or run in parallel to the end?

DF-015**Design tiered questions that move from access to transfer**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

A question set where everyone starts and the ceiling stays high.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Write a tiered question set on [TOPIC] for [GRADE] [SUBJECT].

Structure:

- 2 access questions anyone who attended the lesson can begin
- 3 core questions on the objective
- 2 transfer questions in a context we have not used

Every student attempts every tier. These are not ability groups and must not be labelled as such.

Give me the questions, the answers, and:

- What it means if a student is fine on core and stuck on transfer
- One transfer question a student who found the access questions hard could still attempt
- The question I would put on the board for the whole class

Do not make the transfer questions inaccessible to a struggling student. They should demand different thinking, not more prior knowledge.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Could a struggling student attempt at least one transfer question?
- Do the tiers demand different thinking, or the same thing harder?

DF-016**Check that every tier carries equal curricular dignity**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Before students work out which version is the one for "the bottom group".

COPY THIS PROMPT

Audit these tiered [GRADE] [SUBJECT] tasks for equal dignity.

Tell me:

- Whether any version is visibly the lesser one – in length, appearance, interest, or what students get to talk about afterwards
- Whether any version reduces the actual learning rather than the support
- What a student on each version would say if asked which group they were in
- Whether the naming, ordering or layout signals a ranking
- Whether every version has something worth sharing in the closing discussion

Then tell me the single change that would most equalise them, and whether any version should simply be removed.

TASKS:

[PASTE THEM]

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Which version would you least want to be given? That is the answer.
- Does every version get airtime at the end?

DF-017**Create a whole-class debrief that reconnects three task versions**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Three versions, and now everyone has to be in one conversation.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Design a [MINUTES]-minute closing discussion for a [GRADE] [SUBJECT] lesson where students worked on three versions of [TASK].

The discussion must work for all three without anyone having to announce which version they did.

Give me:

- An opening question every student can answer from their own version
- The order I take contributions in, so no version is heard as the authority
- Two questions that make the versions illuminate each other
- The shared conclusion everyone leaves with
- What I say if a student reveals which version they did, so it passes without weight

Do not structure it as the extension group reporting back to the others.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Does any version get positioned as the correct one?
- Can everyone answer the opening question?

MULTILINGUAL SUPPORT

DF-003**Make a task accessible to multilingual learners**

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

The idea is within reach. The English wrapped around it is not.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Make this [GRADE] [SUBJECT] task accessible to students still developing English, without lowering what it demands.

Task: [PASTE IT]

Give me:

- The 5-6 words that will block comprehension, each with a plain definition and a visual I could sketch in ten seconds
- Sentence frames for the discussion
- A way to show understanding that does not require writing a paragraph
- One thing I should say differently while teaching
- The subject vocabulary that must stay, defined in place rather than removed

Reduce the language load only. Do not simplify the content, cut a step from the reasoning, or lower the expectation.

Do not assume anything about which language a student speaks at home.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Has content been simplified, or only language?
- Is the subject vocabulary still there?

DF-018**Identify the language demands hidden inside a subject task**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

The task is not about language, and language is why it is failing.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Analyse the language demands in this [GRADE] [SUBJECT] task: [PASTE IT]

Tell me:

- Command words, and what each actually asks for – students often lose marks on "explain" versus "describe" rather than on the content
- Subject vocabulary that must be understood versus general academic vocabulary that could be simplified
- Grammatical structures that carry meaning here – conditionals, passives, comparatives – and where a misreading changes the answer
- Any sentence a student could parse correctly and still misunderstand
- Cultural or contextual knowledge the task assumes without stating

Then tell me which single demand, if removed, would help most without changing what is assessed.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Does the task assume context knowledge you had not noticed?
- Are the command words used consistently across your papers?

DF-019**Build an essential vocabulary preview with visuals and examples**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Front-loading the words that would otherwise stop the lesson.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Build a vocabulary preview for a [GRADE] [SUBJECT] lesson on [TOPIC].

Keep it to the words that genuinely block understanding. A long list is a worse preview than a short one.

For each word give me:

- A student-friendly definition, using words simpler than the word itself
- An example and a non-example
- A visual I could sketch on the board in ten seconds
- The everyday meaning it might be confused with, if there is one

Then give me:

- The 5-minute routine for introducing them
- Which words students will still need in the moment, and how I support that
- Which of these words are worth keeping for the rest of the year

Do not include words students can work out from context. Say which ones those are.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Are the definitions genuinely simpler than the words?
- Is the list short enough to actually teach in five minutes?

DF-020**Create structured partner rehearsal before independent writing**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Saying it before writing it makes the writing possible.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Design a partner rehearsal step before [GRADE] [SUBJECT] students write about [TOPIC].

Give me:

- The exact instruction pairs hear, under 30 seconds
- What each partner does – both must speak, not one talking and one listening
- The frames a student uses if they cannot start
- How long each turn gets, and the signal to swap
- What the listening partner is responsible for noticing
- How the rehearsal connects to what they then write alone

The rehearsal must not become the answer being dictated. Tell me how to stop one partner writing the other's paragraph for them.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Does both students speaking actually happen, or does one dominate?
- Is the writing still their own after this?

DF-021**Plan purposeful home-language use without assuming proficiency**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Thinking in a first language is an asset, and should not be an assignment.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Plan how students might use a home language during this [GRADE] [SUBJECT] lesson on [TOPIC].

Constraints:

- Do not assume any student is literate in their home language, or wants to use it, or has anyone to use it with
- Do not assume which language any student speaks
- Everything must remain optional and unremarkable

Give me:

- Where in the lesson thinking in another language genuinely helps
- How I offer that without singling anyone out or making it an instruction
- What is produced in English regardless, so the assessment stays consistent
- What I do if a student declines

Then tell me where this would be a bad idea in this lesson, and why.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Could a student decline without it being noticed?
- Have you assumed anything about who speaks what?

DF-022**Separate content evidence from English-language evidence**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Marking science, and accidentally marking English.

COPY THIS PROMPT

For this [GRADE] [SUBJECT] task, separate what shows subject understanding from what shows English proficiency.

Task: [PASTE IT]

Objective: [OBJECTIVE]

Tell me:

- Which parts of a response evidence the subject learning
- Which evidence language ability rather than the objective
- Where a student with strong understanding and developing English would lose marks, and whether that is defensible here
- An alternative way to evidence the same objective with a lower language load
- What I should not correct, because it is not what I am assessing

Then give me a marking note I could write for myself so I stay consistent across thirty scripts.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Would a strong thinker with weak English pass this?
- Is your marking note specific enough to hold you to it?

READING AND ACCESSIBILITY

DF-004**Adapt text access while preserving meaning**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Keep the ideas. Lose the barrier.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Adapt the text below for [GRADE] students reading roughly [NUMBER] years below grade level.

Keep every key idea and all subject vocabulary – define the vocabulary in place rather than removing it. Shorten sentences, make the structure explicit, and add a heading every few paragraphs.

Give me:

- The adapted text
- What you changed, and anything nuanced that was lost in simplifying
- The 5 words a student may still get stuck on, with a student-friendly gloss
- Anywhere the original's meaning is genuinely ambiguous, so I know the simplification made a choice

Do not remove complexity that is the point of the text. If a passage cannot be simplified without losing its argument, say so and leave it.

TEXT:

[PASTE IT]

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Read both versions. Is the argument intact?
- Did it flag any choice it made on your behalf?

DF-023**Chunk a demanding source without rewriting its claims**

Grades 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

A primary source or original text that must stay in its own words.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Chunk this [GRADE] [SUBJECT] source for students, without altering its wording.

Give me:

- The natural chunk boundaries, quoting the first few words of each
- A one-line purpose for each chunk – what students are reading for
- A question after each chunk, answerable from that chunk alone
- The chunk students will find hardest, and the support that goes there
- The vocabulary gloss for each chunk, alongside rather than replacing the text

Do not paraphrase, modernise or simplify the source itself. The whole point is that students meet the original.

SOURCE:

[PASTE IT]

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Is the original wording untouched?
- Is each question answerable from its own chunk?

DF-024**Create a plain-language companion beside the original text**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Both versions on the desk, so students can move between them.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Write a plain-language companion for this [GRADE] [SUBJECT] text, to sit alongside the original rather than replace it.

Give me:

- A plain-language version, paragraph by paragraph, aligned to the original so students can match them
- Anything the plain version loses – nuance, tone, hedging, ambiguity
- Three places where the original says something more precisely than the plain version can
- A task that requires using both, so students have a reason to go back

Do not present the plain version as equivalent. It is a way in, not a replacement.

TEXT:

[PASTE IT]

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Does the task genuinely require the original?
- Are the losses it named ones you care about?

DF-025**Add glossary, guiding questions and audio-access suggestions**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Three supports around one text, without rewriting it.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Build a support pack around this [GRADE] [SUBJECT] text: [PASTE IT]

Give me:

- A glossary of the words that block meaning, in the order they appear, with student-friendly definitions
- 4 guiding questions placed at the points where a reader typically loses the thread
- Suggestions for making this available as audio, using what a school normally has – do not recommend paid tools or anything requiring a personal account
- What a student does before reading, during, and after

Then tell me which single support would help most if I only had time for one.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Do the audio suggestions work with what your school actually has?
- Are the guiding questions at the right points for your class?

DF-026**Reduce unnecessary reading load in a non-reading assessment**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

A maths test that is secretly a reading test.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Reduce the reading load in this [GRADE] [SUBJECT] assessment without changing what it assesses.

Assessment: [PASTE IT]

What it is meant to assess: [OBJECTIVE]

For each question:

- Say whether the reading demand is part of what is being assessed or is incidental
- Where incidental, rewrite it with lower reading demand and identical subject demand
- Flag anything where cutting the words would change the question

Then tell me:

- Which question currently disadvantages a weak reader most
- Whether the paper as a whole tests the objective or tests reading

Do not shorten questions by removing information students need.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Do the rewrites still test the same thing? Check each one.
- Is any information needed to answer now missing?

DF-027**Audit adapted materials for lost meaning or unsupported simplification**

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Someone simplified it. You want to know what went with the difficulty.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Compare this adapted [GRADE] [SUBJECT] material against the original.

Tell me:

- What ideas are missing from the adapted version
- Where simplifying has changed a claim rather than its wording – a hedged statement made absolute, a cause implied where the original said correlation
- Where subject vocabulary was removed that students actually need
- Whether the adapted version now says something the original does not
- Whether it is still demanding enough to be worth the lesson

Quote the specific places. Then tell me the single change that would restore the most meaning.

ORIGINAL: [PASTE IT]

ADAPTED: [PASTE IT]

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Check any changed claim yourself. That is the one that matters.
- Is the adapted version still worth a lesson?

EXTENSIONS

DF-028**Create an extension that deepens reasoning instead of adding more work**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

They finished in half the time and deserve better than more questions.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Design an extension for students who finish this [GRADE] [SUBJECT] task early:
[PASTE THE TASK]

It must demand harder thinking, not more of the same. Adding items, longer numbers or extra examples is not an extension.

Give me:

- The extension task
- What deeper thinking it demands, in one line
- Why a student who found the original easy will not find this trivial
- What it produces that is worth sharing with the class
- Something they can do with it if they finish that too

It should need no explanation from me, use only what is on their desk, and take
10-15 minutes.

If a student would experience this as punishment for working quickly, redesign it.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Would a fast finisher see this as reward or punishment?
- Does it genuinely need no explanation?

DF-029**Build a transfer challenge using a new context**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Testing whether the learning travels.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Write a transfer challenge on [TOPIC] for [GRADE] [SUBJECT].

We worked in this context: [DESCRIBE IT]

Give me a task using the same thinking in a context we have never used.

Include:

- The task
- What makes the context genuinely different, not cosmetically different
- What a student who learned the surface pattern will do, and where it fails
- The answer or range of acceptable answers
- What the response tells me about whether the learning transferred

The challenge must not require knowledge from the new context that students do not have. If it does, say so and change it.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Is the context genuinely new, or the same with new nouns?
- Does it need outside knowledge students lack?

DF-030**Design an open-ended investigation with clear evidence expectations**

Grades 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Open enough to be interesting, defined enough to be markable.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Design an open-ended investigation on [TOPIC] for [GRADE] [SUBJECT], taking [TIME].

It should have several defensible answers, and still be markable.

Give me:

- The question, open but bounded
- What students must produce regardless of the direction they take
- What counts as evidence here, and what does not
- Three directions a student might reasonably go, and whether each is productive
- The checkpoint that stops someone spending the whole time on a dead end
- What I look for to distinguish genuine investigation from wandering

Do not make it so open that a student cannot tell whether they have finished.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Could a student tell when they are done?
- Would you accept all three directions it named?

DF-031**Audit an extension for novelty, rigor and connection to the objective**

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Before it goes into the folder for fast finishers.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Audit this [GRADE] [SUBJECT] extension task: [PASTE IT]

Original task and objective: [PASTE THEM]

Tell me:

- Whether it demands different thinking or just more of the same
- Whether it connects to the objective or has drifted to a different topic
- Whether a student who found the original hard could attempt any part of it
- Whether it needs explanation from me – if so, it fails as an extension
- Whether a student would read it as reward or punishment

Then tell me the single change that would most improve it, and whether it is worth keeping at all.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- If it says the extension is just more work, do you agree?
- Would you want to be given this task?

FLEXIBLE GROUPING

DF-032**Build temporary groups from anonymous learning evidence**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Groups for this lesson, from what the work showed.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Build groups for a [GRADE] [SUBJECT] lesson on [TOPIC] from these response patterns:

[DESCRIBE THE PATTERNS AND ROUGHLY HOW MANY STUDENTS. No names.]

Give me:

- The groups, defined by what each needs rather than by level
- What each group does, all of it worth doing
- How groups are formed so the class does not read them as ability
- Where I go first, and for how long
- The check at the end that tells me whether to keep or dissolve these groups

These groups last one lesson. Tell me what would make me change them tomorrow.

Do not name students, and do not create a group that is visibly the bottom one.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Could students decode the grouping?
- Does every group have work worth doing?

DF-033**Create a rotation plan for three changing instructional needs**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Three needs, one of you, one period.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Plan a rotation for a [MINUTES]-minute [GRADE] [SUBJECT] lesson with three groups needing different things:

Group 1 needs: [DESCRIBE]

Group 2 needs: [DESCRIBE]

Group 3 needs: [DESCRIBE]

Give me:

- The timing, with transitions counted in
- Which group I take first and why
- What the other two do that genuinely does not need me
- What each group leaves behind as evidence
- What I do if my group runs over, since it will
- The two-minute closing that brings all three together

Assume I cannot properly supervise the other two while teaching one. Tell me what to set up beforehand so that survives.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Can the unsupervised groups really work without you?
- Is the transition time honest?

DF-034**Plan mixed-readiness groups with meaningful roles and accountability**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Mixed groups, where the strongest student is not just the answer key.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Plan mixed-readiness groups for this [GRADE] [SUBJECT] task: [PASTE IT]

Groups of [NUMBER].

The task must need everyone. A stronger student explaining to weaker ones is not collaboration, and it is not their job.

Give me:

- How the task is structured so different contributions are genuinely needed
- Roles defined by the thinking they demand, not by clerical jobs
- What each student produces individually
- How I stop one student doing the work for the group
- What each student can answer at the end, whatever their role

Then tell me honestly whether a stronger student gains anything here. If not, say so.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Does the strongest student gain anything, or just teach?
- Could one student do it all?

DF-035**Audit a grouping plan for labels, access, movement and regrouping triggers**

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Before the groups quietly become permanent.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Audit this [GRADE] [SUBJECT] grouping plan: [PASTE IT]

Tell me:

- Whether any group is identifiable as the low group – by name, task, seating, or what they get to talk about
- Whether a student could move between groups, and what would trigger that
- Whether every group's work is worth doing, or one is waiting
- Whether the physical arrangement works in a normal room
- What happens when a group member is absent
- Whether there is any plan to dissolve these groups, or they are now fixed

Then tell me the single change that would most reduce the risk of these becoming permanent ability groups.

Be direct. Groups that were formed once and never revisited are the thing I most need told.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- When did you last change these groups? That is the real question.
- Is any group waiting rather than working?

Chapter 5 — Parent Communication

30 PROMPTS

The email you have been putting off is usually the one where the facts are clear but the tone is not. These prompts separate the two: state what happened, describe what you have already tried, make one specific ask — and leave out everything you cannot actually know.

WHAT'S IN HERE

GROUP	PROMPTS	USE WHEN
Positive notes	6	The highest-return five minutes in teaching
Concern emails	5	Something needs saying, carefully
Conference preparation	4	Ten minutes each, twenty-four families
Newsletters	3	Rough notes into something readable
Permissions and logistics	4	Trips, forms, deadlines
Clear and accessible language	3	Plain wording, any reading level
Difficult conversations	2	When it is already tense

WORTH KNOWING BEFORE YOU START

Describe behaviour, never character. "Three tasks are not recorded as submitted" is a fact. "He is unmotivated" is a guess about a child you are writing to their family about.

Do not let it infer a home cause. If a draft says "with support at home this will improve", cut that line — you do not know what home looks like.

Read the draft as the parent, at 8am, on a phone. Anything that reads as blame will be answered as blame.

Ask for a shorter version too. Many families will not read past four lines.

Use initials or "your child". These messages leave your classroom.

POSITIVE NOTES

PC-001**Write a specific positive family message**All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Five minutes that change how a family hears everything you send afterwards.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Write a short positive message to a family about their child in [GRADE]
[SUBJECT].

What I actually observed: [DESCRIBE THE SPECIFIC MOMENT OR WORK. Use "your
child" – no names.]

When: [DATE OR LESSON]

Rules:

- Name the specific thing. "A pleasure to teach" tells a family nothing.
- Describe what the student did, not what kind of person they are
- Two to four sentences, readable on a phone
- No "but", no concern attached, nothing asked of the family
- Do not generalise one observation into a pattern

Give me the message, and a shorter two-sentence version.

If what I described is too vague to write from, ask me what happened rather
than inventing a detail.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Is the specific detail genuinely yours, or has it been filled in?
- Any hidden "but" at the end?

PC-005**Share academic growth using one concrete classroom example**

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Progress a family can picture, not a grade they cannot interpret.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Write a message to a family about academic growth in [GRADE] [SUBJECT].

Where they were: [DESCRIBE, with the evidence and roughly when]

Where they are now: [DESCRIBE, with the evidence]

Build it around one concrete before-and-after that a family can picture. Not "improved in fractions" – the actual thing that changed in the work.

Give me:

- The message, under 120 words
- One sentence the family could say to their child about it
- The shorter version for a family that reads four lines

Use only what I gave you. Do not attribute the growth to effort, attitude, or anything happening at home – you do not know what caused it, and neither do I.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Would a family picture the change from this?
- Has it credited a cause you cannot actually know?

PC-006**Recognize a learner's helpful contribution without using labels**

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Praising what they did, not who you have decided they are.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Write a short message about something helpful a [GRADE] student did:

[DESCRIBE WHAT HAPPENED. No names.]

Describe the action and its effect. Do not use character labels – not "kind", "a leader", "mature", "a role model", "responsible" or "well-behaved". A child who is told they are kind has been given something to live up to or fall short of; a child told what they did has been given something to repeat.

Give me:

- The message, three sentences
- The one line naming the effect their action had on someone else
- A version I could say aloud to the student

If my description does not contain an actual action, ask me what they did.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Any character labels left?
- Does it name a real effect, or a vague good?

PC-007**Write a brief celebration message suitable for a mobile screen**

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

It will be read while walking, on a phone, in about six seconds.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Write a message for a family about [WHAT HAPPENED] in [GRADE] [SUBJECT], designed to be read on a phone.

Constraints:

- Under 50 words
- First line carries the whole message, in case they read nothing else
- No greeting longer than two words, no sign-off longer than my name
- One idea only
- No attachment, no link, nothing to click

Give me the message, plus the subject line – under 8 words, saying what it is so nobody opens it braced for bad news.

Then give me a version with one extra sentence, for the family who will read more.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Does the first line stand alone?
- Does the subject line look like good news?

PC-008**Create a positive note that invites the learner's own reflection**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

The student should be in this conversation, not the subject of it.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Write a positive message about [WHAT HAPPENED] in [GRADE] [SUBJECT] that includes the student rather than talking over them.

Give me:

- A short note to the family
- One question the family could ask their child about it, that has more than a yes or no answer
- One question I could ask the student directly
- A line the student could write themselves about what they did

The questions must be answerable by a student who is not sure what they did differently – many are not. Do not assume they can articulate it.

Keep the whole thing under 100 words.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Could a student who does not know why it went well still answer?
- Does it talk to the student, or about them?

PC-009**Build a reusable strength-note template with visible evidence fields**

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

So sending ten of these takes twenty minutes, not an evening.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Build a reusable template for positive notes home in [GRADE] [SUBJECT].

It must have blanks I fill with something real, so the note cannot be sent generic:

- [WHAT THEY DID] – a specific observed action
- [WHEN]
- [WHY IT MATTERED]

Give me:

- The template
- Four openings and four closings I can rotate, so ten notes do not read as one note sent ten times
- A worked example, filled in
- The rule for what goes in each blank, so I do not slip into vagueness at 9pm

Then tell me what makes these stop working if I send too many, and how often is too often.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Could the template be sent without filling a real detail? Tighten it.
- Do ten of these read as ten different notes?

CONCERN EMAILS

PC-002**Communicate an academic concern with a next step**

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

The email you have been putting off since Tuesday.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Write an email to a family about an academic concern in [GRADE] [SUBJECT].

The concern, factually: [WHAT IS HAPPENING – observable, with dates or counts]

What I have already tried: [LIST IT]

What I want from this email: [A MEETING / AWARENESS / A SPECIFIC NEXT STEP]

Rules:

- Open with something genuine and specific about the child
- State the concern as observable fact, not interpretation
- Describe behaviour, never character
- Do not name a cause. Do not suggest anything about home, motivation, effort, attention or ability
- Do not promise improvement
- End with one clear ask
- Under 200 words, no jargon, no emoji

Give me the email, then a four-line version for a family that will not read further.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Has it inferred a cause anywhere? Cut that line.
- Read it as the parent at 8am. Does it read as blame?
- Is there exactly one ask?

PC-010**Write a missing-work message using dates and verified counts**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Facts, not a feeling that they are behind.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Write a message to a family about missing work in [GRADE] [SUBJECT].

The record: [LIST WHAT IS MISSING AND THE DATES – only what I have verified]
What I have already done: [LIST IT]

Rules:

- Use only the dates and counts I gave you. Do not round, estimate, or add anything I did not state
- Do not describe the pattern as a habit, an attitude, or a choice
- Say plainly what happens next and by when
- Include how the work can be caught up, specifically
- Ask whether there is something I should know, without speculating about what

Give me the message and a short version.

Before I send this, tell me which of my stated facts I should double-check against the record – this is the kind of message where being wrong on one date loses the family's trust entirely.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Verify every date and count against your actual record.
- Has it added a number you did not give it?

PC-011**Explain a recurring learning difficulty without diagnosing its cause**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Something keeps happening, and it is not yours to name.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Write a message to a family about a recurring difficulty in [GRADE] [SUBJECT].

What I observe, repeatedly: [DESCRIBE THE PATTERN IN THE WORK – what happens, how often, in what situations]

Rules – these matter more than the wording:

- Describe only what I have observed in the classroom
- Name no cause. Do not suggest a diagnosis, a condition, a difficulty by name,
 - or anything about attention, processing, ability or home
- Do not recommend an assessment or referral – that is not mine to initiate in an email
- Ask what the family notices, rather than telling them what to look for
- Say what I am doing about it in the classroom already

Give me the message under 180 words.

If anything in my description is already a diagnosis in disguise, tell me and rewrite it as an observation.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Any language that hints at a diagnosis? Cut it.
- Follow your school's process for anything beyond an observation.

PC-012**Request a brief family check-in with two exact scheduling options**

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Making it easy to say yes.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Write a short message asking a family for a brief conversation about [TOPIC].

My availability: [TWO SPECIFIC OPTIONS – day, date, time, duration]

How: [PHONE / IN PERSON / VIDEO]

Rules:

- Say why in one sentence, without loading it
- Offer exactly the two options I gave, plus an invitation to suggest another
- Say how long it will take
- Make clear this is not an emergency, if it is not
- Do not make attendance sound compulsory unless it is

Under 100 words.

Then give me a second version for a family who has not responded to two previous messages – same content, different approach, no reproach about the silence.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Does it read as urgent when it is not?
- Is the non-response version free of any hint of blame?

PC-013**Revise a blaming concern email into factual collaborative language**

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

You wrote it angry. Do not send that one.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Rewrite this message so it is factual and collaborative, keeping every fact intact.

Do not soften it into meaninglessness – the family must still understand there is a problem and what happens next.

Show me:

- Each sentence carrying blame, judgement, or an inference about home, character or motivation – quoted
- What is factually true in it, and what is my interpretation presented as fact
- The rewritten message
- Anything I claimed that I should verify before sending

Give me three versions: gentle, direct, and firm. Tell me which fits what I described, and when I would use each of the others.

DRAFT:

[PASTE IT]

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Are all the facts still there, or did softening remove one?
- Verify anything it flagged as unchecked.

PC-014**Audit a concern message for evidence, tone and unsupported claims**

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Before it becomes the email that gets forwarded to the head.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Audit this message to a family.

Tell me:

- Every claim not supported by something I could show – quoted
- Anywhere I describe character rather than behaviour
- Anywhere I imply a cause: home, effort, attitude, ability, attention
- Anywhere a family could reasonably read blame
- Whether the ask is clear, single, and actually answerable
- What a defensive family would seize on first
- Anything a family might reasonably ask that the message does not answer

Then give me the one sentence I should cut, and why.

MESSAGE:

[PASTE IT]

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Cut the sentence it named. That is the one.
- Could you evidence every remaining claim if asked?

CONFERENCE PREPARATION

PC-003**Prepare a balanced family conference**

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Ten minutes, and you want them to leave knowing three things.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Prepare me for a [MINUTES]-minute conference with a family in [GRADE] [SUBJECT].

What I know: [STRENGTHS WITH EVIDENCE, GROWTH AREA WITH EVIDENCE, ANYTHING ELSE – no names]

Give me a single card I can glance at:

- One strength, with the evidence in a phrase
- One growth area, with the evidence in a phrase
- One question to ask the family, that is genuinely open
- One thing they could do at home that costs under ten minutes and does not require them to teach anything
- The sentence I open with, and the sentence I close with

Keep it to what fits on half a page. I will be reading it while they sit down.

Do not include anything I did not give you, and do not invent an evidence detail
to make a point land better.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Is every piece of evidence something you actually have?
- Could you deliver this in ten minutes with the family talking too?

PC-015**Build a 15-minute conference agenda around learning evidence**

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Structure, so the ten minutes do not disappear into small talk.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Build a [MINUTES]-minute conference agenda for [GRADE] [SUBJECT].

Give me the agenda with minutes allocated to each part, including:

- Time for the family to talk, which is the part that always gets squeezed
- Where I show actual work rather than describe it
- Where the student's own view comes in, if they are present
- The point at which I stop and check whether we agree on what we are seeing
- What I do when we reach the last two minutes and nothing is settled

Then tell me:

- Which part to cut first if we are running over
- The conversation this agenda does not handle – the one that needs a separate meeting – and how I recognise it early and say so

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Does the family get real time, or a token minute?
- Could you say "this needs a longer conversation" comfortably?

PC-016**Prepare questions that invite family and student perspective**

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

You do most of the talking. That is the wrong way round.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Write questions for a [GRADE] conference that get the family and the student talking.

Give me:

- Three questions for the family, open, none of which can be answered "fine"
- Three for the student, answerable by a student who is nervous or monosyllabic
- One question I ask when the family disagrees with something I have said
- One I ask when the family says nothing at all

Rules:

- No question assuming a particular home setup, language, work schedule, resources or family structure
- Nothing that reads as checking whether they are doing enough at home
- Nothing that puts a child on the spot in front of an adult

Then tell me which question is most likely to open something I am not prepared for, and how to hold that well.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Does any question assume a kind of household?
- Would a nervous 9-year-old manage the student questions?

PC-017**Turn classroom evidence into a shared action-plan table**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

So the meeting produces something rather than just happening.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Turn this into a shared action plan after a conference in [GRADE] [SUBJECT]:

What we discussed: [SUMMARISE – no names]

What was agreed: [LIST IT]

Give me a table with: what will happen, who does it, by when, and how we will know it worked.

Rules:

- Every row has a named owner – me, the family, or the student. No unowned rows
- Nothing asks a family to teach subject content
- Nothing requires resources, internet, or an adult free at a fixed time, unless the family offered it
- The student owns at least one row
- Include a date to check back, and who initiates that

Only include what was actually agreed. If something was discussed but not agreed, list it separately as open.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Does every row have an owner?
- Is anything here the family did not actually agree to?

PC-018**Write a factual post-conference summary with owners and dates**

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

A record, sent the same day, that both sides recognise.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Write a summary email after a family conference in [GRADE] [SUBJECT].

What was discussed: [YOUR NOTES – no names]

What was agreed: [LIST IT]

Rules:

- Record only what was said and agreed. Do not smooth over a disagreement, and do not record agreement that was not given
- Where the family and I saw it differently, record both views neutrally
- Every action has an owner and a date
- No new information, no new concerns – this is a record, not a second email
- Invite correction: they may remember it differently, and that is fine

Under 200 words.

Then tell me what to do if the family replies disputing the summary.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Send it the same day. Memory diverges fast.
- Have you recorded agreement that was not actually given?

NEWSLETTERS

PC-004**Draft a useful class newsletter**

Grades K-2, 3-5

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Bullet points in, something families actually read out.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Turn these notes into a class newsletter for [GRADE] families, week of [DATE]:

[PASTE YOUR ROUGH NOTES]

Sections: what we learned, what is coming, dates to remember, one thing to do at home.

Rules:

- Under 300 words, headings, scannable in thirty seconds
- Dates in full – day, date, month – never "next Tuesday"
- The home suggestion takes under ten minutes and needs no printing, internet, or subject knowledge
- No school jargon, no acronyms
- Written for any adult at any reading level

Give me the newsletter, then a five-line version for families who will not read the full one.

Use only what is in my notes. If a date or detail is missing, ask rather than filling it in.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Check every date against the calendar yourself.
- Has anything been invented to fill a section?

PC-019**Create a concise weekly learning update for families**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Same shape every week, so families know where to look.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Build a repeatable weekly update format for [GRADE] [SUBJECT] families.

Give me:

- A fixed structure, four sections maximum, in the same order every week
- What goes in each, written as a rule so I can fill it in five minutes
- This week's version, using: [YOUR NOTES]
- The one section families will actually read, placed first
- What to do in a week where little happened, without padding

Under 200 words.

Then tell me what makes families stop reading a weekly update, so I can avoid building that in from the start.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Could you fill this in five minutes every week? If not, simplify it.
- Is the most-read section first?

PC-021**Audit a class newsletter for dates, jargon, access and action items**

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Before three families turn up on the wrong day.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Audit this newsletter for [GRADE] families.

Check:

- Every date and day-of-week – flag any that is ambiguous, relative, or that I should verify
- School jargon, acronyms and internal shorthand, quoted
- Anything assuming internet, a printer, money, transport, or a free adult
- Anything a family is being asked to do that is not stated clearly as an ask
- Whether the reading level suits every family, not most of them
- Whether the most important item is buried

Then tell me the three items to move to the top, and everything I could cut without loss.

NEWSLETTER:

[PASTE IT]

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Verify every flagged date against the school calendar.
- Are the asks unmistakably asks?

PC-020**Rewrite a newsletter as a mobile-friendly plain-text version**

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Most families will open this on a phone, in a queue, with one thumb.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Rewrite this newsletter as plain text for a phone screen.

Rules:

- No formatting that depends on a wide screen – no columns, no tables, no boxes, no indentation carrying meaning
- Most important item first, in the first two lines
- Short paragraphs, two or three lines each, with a blank line between
- Dates in full, on their own line, so they survive being screenshotted
- No attachment and no link required to understand the message
- Under 200 words

Give me:

- The plain-text version
- A three-line version for a text message or messaging app
- Which items I should send separately instead, because they will be lost in a long message

Keep every date and deadline exactly as written.

NEWSLETTER:
[PASTE IT]

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Read it on your own phone before sending.
- Did any date change in the rewrite?

PERMISSIONS AND LOGISTICS

PC-022**Draft a permission notice from verified trip or event details**

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

A form that comes back complete, first time.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Write a permission notice for [EVENT] for [GRADE] families.

Verified details: [DATE, TIMES, LOCATION, TRANSPORT, COST, WHAT TO BRING, WHAT TO WEAR, RETURN DEADLINE, WHO TO CONTACT]

Rules:

- Use only the details I supplied. Invent nothing – not a cost, not a time, not a policy, not a supervision ratio
- If something a permission notice normally contains is missing from my list, list it as missing rather than filling it in
- Plain language, short sentences, translation-ready
- Say clearly what happens if a family cannot pay or cannot consent, without requiring them to explain why
- One clear return deadline and one place to return it

Give me the notice and the tear-off slip.

I will check this against my school's own consent and safeguarding requirements before it goes out.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Check every detail against the actual arrangements.
- Check the form against your school's required consent wording.
- Fill in anything it listed as missing — do not send it with gaps.

PC-023**Create a clear family checklist for materials, dates and return forms**

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

One list, so nothing arrives on the wrong day.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Turn these into a family checklist for [GRADE]:

[LIST WHAT IS NEEDED, WITH DATES]

Rules:

- Grouped by date, earliest first, with the full date each time
- Each item says what, by when, and where it goes
- Say which items are essential and which are optional – families need to know what they can skip
- For anything costing money or needing a purchase, note the school's route for families who cannot
- Nothing requiring a printer at home

Give me the checklist as one page, plus a two-line phone summary of the most urgent items.

Use only my list. If a date is missing, ask.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Is essential versus optional actually accurate?
- Is your school's support route stated correctly?

PC-024**Write a schedule-change notice without inventing school policy**

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Something moved, and families need to know today.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Write a notice about a schedule change for [GRADE] families.

What changed: [OLD ARRANGEMENT → NEW ARRANGEMENT]

Effective: [DATE]

Reason I am permitted to share: [STATE IT, or say none]

Rules:

- Lead with the change. The reason, if any, comes second
- State no policy, procedure or entitlement I have not given you
- If families will ask something this notice cannot answer, say who to ask rather than guessing
- Do not apologise repeatedly; say it once if warranted
- Do not speculate about further changes

Under 100 words, plus a one-line version for a text message.

If the reason I gave should not be shared with families, say so.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Has it stated a policy you did not give it?
- Is the reason yours to share?

PC-025**Audit a logistics message for missing consent, safety and contact details**

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

The message that will generate forty replies asking the same question.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Audit this logistics message to [GRADE] families.

Tell me:

- What a family needs to know that is missing – timing, location, cost, supervision, what to bring, what to do if they cannot
- Any consent, medical or emergency-contact element that appears incomplete
- Every ambiguous date, time or place, quoted
- Anything stated as policy that I should verify before sending
- The three questions families will email me about after reading this
- Anything assuming a family has a car, a smartphone, spare money, or a free weekday

Then tell me the single addition that would prevent the most replies.

I will check all consent and safeguarding elements against my school's own requirements.

MESSAGE:

[PASTE IT]

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Add the missing items before sending, not after the questions arrive.
- Take the consent and safeguarding flags to your school's process.

CLEAR AND ACCESSIBLE LANGUAGE

PC-026**Rewrite school language in plain family-friendly English**

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

The message is accurate and nobody outside the staffroom understands it.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Rewrite this message for [GRADE] families in plain English.

Rules:

- Replace every acronym, initialism and piece of school jargon with what it actually means
- Short sentences, one idea each
- Active voice – say who does what, rather than "it has been decided"
- Keep every fact and every deadline exactly as they are
- Do not make it warmer by making it vaguer

Give me:

- The rewritten message
- A table of what you changed and why
- Any term I must keep for accuracy, with a plain gloss beside it
- Anywhere the original was ambiguous, so I can decide what it meant rather than you guessing

MESSAGE:

[PASTE IT]

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Did any fact or deadline shift in the rewrite?
- Where it flagged ambiguity, decide it yourself.

PC-027**Create a translation-ready message using short unambiguous sentences**

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

It will go through machine translation, and idioms do not survive that.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Rewrite this message for [GRADE] families so it survives machine translation.

Rules:

- One idea per sentence, under 15 words where possible
- No idioms, phrasal verbs, metaphors, humour or cultural references
- No sarcasm, no understatement
- Consistent terms – do not call the same thing two different names
- Dates written in full, unambiguously – not 03/04, which means two different days in two countries
- Avoid words with several meanings where a plainer word exists

Give me the rewritten message, and a list of anything I should have a person check rather than trusting to translation.

Do not lose any fact in the simplification.

MESSAGE:

[PASTE IT]

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Is every date unambiguous?
- Have the facts survived intact?

PC-028**Audit a family message for jargon, idioms and hidden assumptions**

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Checking what the message quietly assumes about a family.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Audit this message to families.

Flag and quote:

- Jargon, acronyms and school shorthand
- Idioms and phrasal verbs that will not translate
- Assumptions about the family: two parents, English at home, a car, internet, a printer, spare money, someone free during the school day, a quiet room, a parent who can help with the subject
- Anything implying a family is not doing enough
- Any sentence with two possible readings
- Anything requiring a reading level above straightforward everyday English

Then give me the single sentence most likely to make a family feel judged, and a replacement.

MESSAGE:

[PASTE IT]

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- The judged-feeling sentence: replace it, do not defend it.
- Which assumption surprised you? That is the useful one.

DIFFICULT CONVERSATIONS

PC-029**Prepare a calm conversation about a repeated classroom concern**

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

It has come up before, and this conversation needs to go better than the last.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Prepare me for a conversation with a family about a repeated concern in [GRADE].

What keeps happening: [OBSERVABLE FACTS, WITH DATES]

What has already been tried: [BY ME, AND BY THE FAMILY IF I KNOW]

What I want from this conversation: [STATE IT]

Give me:

- My opening, under 30 seconds, that states the concern without a preamble that
 - makes it sound worse
- The facts in the order I say them
- What I say when the family disagrees with the facts
- What I say when the family becomes upset
- What I say when the family says it is my responsibility, or the school's
- The point at which I stop and listen rather than continuing
- How I close if nothing is resolved

Do not script the family's side. Do not assume they will be difficult.

Nothing here should involve me guessing at causes at home.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Are the facts verified, with dates?
- Are you prepared to actually stop and listen at that point?

PC-030**Create a fact-based communication plan for disagreement with a family**

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

You and the family see it differently, and it needs handling rather than winning.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Help me plan communication with a family who disagrees with me about [ISSUE]
in
[GRADE].

Their position, as I understand it: [DESCRIBE IT FAIRLY]
My position, and the evidence: [DESCRIBE IT]

Give me:

- What we actually agree on, which is usually more than it feels like
- Where the disagreement genuinely sits – fact, interpretation, or what should happen next. These need different handling and I want to know which this is
- What I would need to see to change my view, stated honestly
- What is not negotiable, and why, in one sentence a family can accept
- What I put in writing and what stays a conversation
- When this stops being mine to handle alone, and who I involve

Do not tell me how to win this. If the family may be right, say so.

I will follow my school's procedures for anything formal.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- If it said the family may be right, sit with that before replying.
- Involve your school's process at the point it named, not later.

Chapter 6 — Report Card Comments

30 PROMPTS

Twenty-eight comments in one sitting is the job nobody plans for and everybody dreads. These prompts do the drafting so you can do the judging — every comment tied to something you actually recorded, with one next step the student can act on.

WHAT'S IN HERE

GROUP	PROMPTS	USE WHEN
Comment banks	10	Build once, reuse every term
Strengths and next steps	7	The core shape of a good comment
Subject-specific comments	7	Language that fits the subject
Bulk drafts from evidence	4	A whole class in one pass
Tone and rewriting	3	Honest, but survivable to read

WORTH KNOWING BEFORE YOU START

Use initials or "Student A". These comments go into a permanent record. The drafting should not put a child's name into an AI tool.

Give it your real evidence — scores, dates, things you wrote down. A comment built on nothing reads like a comment built on nothing.

Do not let it invent a strength to balance the structure. A manufactured compliment is the fastest way for a family to stop trusting the rest.

Vary the openings. Twenty-eight comments that all begin the same way are recognisable as generated, and parents compare.

COMMENT BANKS

RC-001

Build an evidence-safe comment bank

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Build it once in January and use it every term after.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Build a report comment bank for [GRADE] [SUBJECT].

Give me 6 comments for each of these bands: excelling, secure, approaching, and inconsistent evidence.

Every comment must contain:

- [NAME] once, at the start
- [SPECIFIC EVIDENCE] – a blank I fill with something real from my records
- One next step the student can act on themselves

Rules:

- No comment may be sendable without filling the evidence blank. Write them so the gap is obvious
- Describe what the student did, never what kind of learner they are
- No praise for effort, attitude, behaviour or personality unless I add it
- Vary the openings across the bank – list them so I can check no two match
- Nothing that predicts or promises future performance

Then tell me which band is hardest to write honestly, and why.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Could any comment be sent without filling the evidence blank? Tighten it.
- Do the openings genuinely differ?

RC-004**Create comment starters for four levels of demonstrated mastery**

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Openings that describe the learning rather than rank the child.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Write comment openings for [GRADE] [SUBJECT] at four levels of demonstrated mastery.

Give me 5 openings per level. Each must:

- Describe what the student has demonstrated, in the work
- Be followed naturally by a specific piece of evidence
- Avoid comparison with other students or with a class average
- Avoid any word implying fixed ability – bright, weak, able, gifted, slow, natural, struggles

For the lowest band especially: the opening must be honest without being a verdict on the child. Show me the difference between an honest opening and a discouraging one, with an example of each.

Then tell me which openings would sound wrong if a family read four of them in a row from different teachers.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Would you be comfortable if a family compared four of these?
- Any fixed-ability words left?

RC-005**Build modular strength, evidence and next-step sentence parts**

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Mix and match, so thirty comments do not read as one.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Build modular comment parts for [GRADE] [SUBJECT] that I can combine.

Give me three separate lists:

- 8 strength openings
- 8 evidence connectors, each leading into a [SPECIFIC EXAMPLE] blank
- 8 next-step closings

Every combination must produce a grammatical, natural comment. Show me four assembled examples using different combinations.

Rules:

- No part may contain a fact – the facts come from my blanks
- Next steps must be things the student can do, not things that will happen to them
- No closing may promise a result

Then tell me which combinations sound wrong together, so I avoid them at 10pm.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Assemble three at random. Do they read naturally?
- Do any parts carry a claim you have not verified?

RC-006**Create a comment bank that avoids fixed-ability labels**

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Language that describes this term, not the child's ceiling.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Build a comment bank for [GRADE] [SUBJECT] that describes learning as it stands now, not as a fixed trait.

Banned outright: bright, able, gifted, weak, low, high, slow, natural, struggles with, is not a [subject] person, lacks ability, and any comparison to peers.

Give me:

- 12 comments describing current demonstrated learning
- For each, the fixed-ability phrasing it replaces, so I can see the swap
- The three phrases teachers reach for most that sound neutral but are not
- How to describe a student who is genuinely far behind, honestly, without making it sound permanent

That last one is the point of this prompt. Do not avoid it by being vague.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Is the far-behind comment honest, or has it gone vague to be kind?
- Check your own habitual phrases against the list of three.

RC-007**Write concise comments within a strict character limit**

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

The reporting system allows 250 characters and no argument.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Write [GRADE] [SUBJECT] report comments within [NUMBER] characters including spaces.

Evidence: [PASTE WHAT YOU HAVE – no names]

Rules:

- Count the characters and state the count after each comment
- Cut adverbs and hedging before cutting substance
- The next step survives the cut. If something has to go, it is not that
- No abbreviations a family would have to decode
- Still specific – a short comment is not an excuse for a generic one

Give me each comment with its character count, and tell me what you dropped to fit.

If the evidence genuinely cannot be said in [NUMBER] characters without becoming meaningless, say so rather than producing something empty.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Verify the character counts yourself. They are often wrong.
- Did the next step survive?

RC-008**Create neutral pronoun variants without changing the evidence**

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

One comment, correct for any student, no rewriting at 11pm.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Rewrite these [GRADE] [SUBJECT] comments so pronouns are not baked in.

Give me each comment in two forms:

- Using the student's name where a pronoun would go, so it works for anyone
- With a [PRONOUN] placeholder and a note on which forms are needed – subject, object, possessive

Rules:

- The evidence and the next step must be identical across versions
- Do not add or remove meaning in the rewrite
- Keep the sentences natural – repeated names every clause reads oddly, so restructure rather than substitute mechanically

Flag any sentence that cannot be made pronoun-neutral without becoming awkward,
and give me your best alternative.

COMMENTS:

[PASTE THEM]

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Read one aloud. Does the name repeat too often?
- Is the evidence identical across versions?

RC-009**Build a comment bank with visible placeholders for supporting evidence**

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

So the blank cannot be skipped when you are tired.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Build a [GRADE] [SUBJECT] comment bank where the evidence blanks are impossible to miss.

For each comment:

- Put placeholders in a form that stands out visibly, such as `[[LIKE THIS]]`
- Every comment needs at least one evidence placeholder and one next-step placeholder
- Write a one-line rule beside each placeholder saying what belongs there – the kind of evidence, not an example I might just copy

Give me 10 comments across the range.

Then give me the two-line check I run before submitting: what to search for to confirm no placeholder survived into a final comment.

Do not fill any placeholder with a plausible example. That is exactly how an invented detail ends up in a permanent record.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Search the final file for `[[`. Every one must be gone.
- Has any placeholder been helpfully pre-filled?

RC-010**Audit a comment bank for repetition, vagueness and invented claims**

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Before it goes into use for three years.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Audit this [GRADE] [SUBJECT] comment bank.

Tell me:

- Which comments are the same comment in different words
- Which contain no actual information – quote the empty phrases
- Which make a claim that cannot be evidenced from classroom work
- Which describe personality, effort or attitude rather than learning
- Which imply a fixed ability
- Which would sound identical if a family compared two children's reports
- Which promise or predict a future outcome

Then tell me:

- The comments to delete entirely
- The single vaguest phrase in the whole bank

BANK:

[PASTE IT]

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Delete what it said to delete. A bank of 30 good comments beats 60 mixed.
- Is the vaguest phrase one you use often?

STRENGTHS AND NEXT STEPS

RC-002**Turn evidence into a balanced report comment**

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

The core shape: what they can do, what comes next, both evidenced.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Write a report comment for a [GRADE] [SUBJECT] student.

Evidence I have: [LIST IT – scores, observations, dates, work. No names.]

Structure:

- A strength, with the evidence stated
- A next step, specific and achievable this term
- Nothing else

Rules:

- Every factual clause must trace to something I gave you. Mark any clause you cannot trace, rather than including it
- Do not manufacture a strength to balance the comment. If my evidence shows no clear strength, say so and tell me what to look for
- The next step is something the student does, not something I do
- No prediction, no promise, no praise for effort I did not describe
- [NUMBER] sentences

Give me the comment, plus a note on which clause rests on the thinnest evidence.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Trace every clause to your own records.
- If it said the evidence shows no strength, do not add one.

RC-011**Write a strength statement tied to a specific learning objective**

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

"Doing well" means nothing. This says in what.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Write a strength statement for a [GRADE] [SUBJECT] student.

Objective: [PASTE IT]

What the student did: [THE EVIDENCE – no names]

The statement must name the objective in family-readable language and point at what the student actually produced.

Give me:

- The strength statement, one or two sentences
- The same statement without the jargon, if my objective contains any
- What makes this a strength rather than simply completing the task
- A version for a student whose strength is real but narrow – secure in one part of the objective and not the rest

Do not broaden the claim beyond my evidence. One good piece of work is not a consistent pattern, and should not be described as one.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Has one instance been described as a pattern?
- Would a family understand the objective as written?

RC-012**Convert an error pattern into one achievable next step**

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

One next step. Not four, and not a wish.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Turn this [GRADE] [SUBJECT] error pattern into a single next step:

[DESCRIBE WHAT KEEPS HAPPENING IN THE WORK – no names]

The next step must be:

- One thing, not a list
- Something the student can start without me
- Achievable this term, not aspirational
- Written so the student understands what to do differently

Give me:

- The next step, one sentence
- The same thing said to the student directly
- What I do in class to support it
- How I would know in three weeks whether it worked

Do not write "should continue to practise" or "needs to focus more". Those are not next steps. If the pattern needs teaching rather than practice, say so.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Could the student start this tomorrow, alone?
- Is it one thing?

RC-013**Build a balanced comment from assessment and classroom evidence**

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

The test score and what you see daily do not agree.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Write a report comment combining assessment and classroom evidence for a [GRADE] [SUBJECT] student.

Assessment evidence: [SCORES, DATES]

Classroom evidence: [WHAT YOU OBSERVE – no names]

Where these disagree, say so rather than averaging them into a bland middle.

Give me:

- The comment
- Which evidence you weighted more, and why
- The sentence handling the disagreement honestly, without explaining it away
- What I should say if a family asks why the comment and the grade differ

If the two sources disagree strongly enough that I should gather more evidence before reporting, tell me that instead of writing the comment.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Do you agree with which evidence it weighted?
- Can you answer the family question it prepared you for?

RC-014**Write a comment when evidence is limited or inconsistent**

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Long absence, arrived late in the term, or the evidence simply is not there.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Write a [GRADE] [SUBJECT] report comment where I have limited evidence.

What I have: [LIST IT HONESTLY, INCLUDING GAPS AND WHY – no names]

Rules:

- Say plainly what the comment is based on, and over what period
- Do not extrapolate from a small sample into a general judgement
- Do not fill the gap with attendance commentary, effort, or behaviour
- Do not imply the student is behind if I do not have evidence for that
- Give a next step only if the evidence supports one; otherwise say what I will look for next term

Give me the comment and one line I could add explaining the limited basis without sounding defensive.

Tell me if the honest answer is that I cannot write a meaningful comment yet.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Has thin evidence quietly become a judgement?
- Is the limitation stated plainly?

RC-015**Create a learner-friendly next step that families can understand**

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

The next step should mean something to the child it is about.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Rewrite this next step so a [GRADE] student and their family both understand it:

[PASTE IT]

Give me:

- The next step in student-facing words
- The same for a family, with no subject jargon
- One concrete example of what doing it looks like
- One thing a family could do to help, taking under ten minutes and requiring no subject knowledge

Rules:

- Do not ask a family to teach anything
- Do not assume internet, a printer, purchased resources, or an adult free at a fixed time
- Keep the demand identical to the original – plainer words, same expectation

Flag anything in the original the student could not act on alone.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Does the family suggestion require any teaching? Cut it if so.
- Is the demand unchanged?

RC-016**Add an instructional strategy without promising a future result**

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Saying what you will do, without guaranteeing what will happen.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Add to this [GRADE] [SUBJECT] comment a line about what I will do in class:

[PASTE THE COMMENT]

What I plan to do: [DESCRIBE IT]

Rules:

- State the action, not the expected outcome
- No promise, no prediction, no "this will help them to"
- No timescale I cannot guarantee
- It must be something I will actually do, not a general intention
- One sentence

Give me three versions at different levels of specificity, and tell me which is safest to put in a permanent record.

Then flag any sentence in my original comment that already promises a result.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Will you actually do it? It is now on a record.
- Any promises left in the original?

RC-017**Audit a report comment using a sentence-by-sentence fact trace**

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

The last check before it becomes permanent.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Trace this [GRADE] [SUBJECT] report comment against my evidence.

COMMENT: [PASTE IT]

EVIDENCE: [PASTE WHAT YOU HAVE]

For each sentence, tell me:

- Which piece of evidence supports it
- Whether it is fully supported, partly supported, or unsupported
- Where it generalises beyond what the evidence shows
- Whether it describes learning, or effort, behaviour or personality
- Whether a family could challenge it and be right

Then give me:

- The sentence to cut
- The sentence to soften
- Anything the evidence supports that the comment does not mention

Do not accept a sentence as supported because it sounds reasonable.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Cut what it said to cut.
- Anything unsupported goes, however true it feels.

SUBJECT-SPECIFIC COMMENTS

RC-018**Write a mathematics comment about concepts, procedures and reasoning**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

"Good at maths" hides which of the three is actually strong.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Write a [GRADE] mathematics report comment.

Evidence: [WHAT THE WORK SHOWS – no names]

Separate three things, because a student can be strong in one and not the others:

- Conceptual understanding – do they know what it means
- Procedural fluency – can they carry it out reliably
- Reasoning and explanation – can they justify and communicate it

Give me:

- The comment, naming which of the three is the strength and which is the next step
- The sentence a family will understand, since these three sound alike to non-teachers
- What a student who is procedurally fluent but conceptually shaky looks like, so I can check I have read my evidence correctly

If my evidence only covers one of the three, say so rather than commenting on all three.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Does your evidence actually cover what the comment claims?
- Would a family understand the distinction as written?

RC-019**Write a science comment about investigation, evidence and explanation**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Practical work and written explanation are different skills.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Write a [GRADE] science report comment.

Evidence: [WHAT THE WORK AND PRACTICALS SHOW – no names]

Distinguish:

- Working scientifically – planning, controlling variables, measuring, recording
- Handling evidence – reading data, spotting patterns, noting limitations
- Explaining – using scientific ideas to account for what was observed

Give me:

- The comment, naming which of these the evidence supports
- The distinction between a student who follows a method well and one who understands why the method is designed that way
- A next step for a student strong in practical work and weak in written explanation, that is not simply "write more"

Do not credit understanding from a neat write-up alone.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Are you crediting understanding, or presentation?
- Is the next step more than "write more"?

RC-020**Write an English language arts comment about reading and writing evidence**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Reading and writing are separate, and so is talking about them.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Write a [GRADE] English report comment.

Evidence: [READING AND WRITING EVIDENCE – no names]

Keep reading and writing separate. A student can comprehend well and write poorly, and the comment should not blur them.

For reading, distinguish: decoding, literal comprehension, inference, and response to a text.

For writing, distinguish: ideas, structure, sentence control, and technical accuracy.

Give me:

- The comment, naming specifically where the strength and next step sit
- Why technical accuracy should not dominate the comment if the ideas are strong
- A next step for a student whose ideas outrun their sentence control

Do not describe a student as a "reluctant" or "confident" reader or writer. Those are dispositions, not evidence.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Has technical accuracy swamped everything else?
- Any disposition language left?

RC-021**Write a social studies comment about sources, claims and perspective**

Grades 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Content recall and historical thinking are not the same achievement.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Write a [GRADE] social studies report comment.

Evidence: [WHAT THE WORK SHOWS – no names]

Distinguish:

- Knowledge of content
- Using sources – reading them, questioning them, weighing them
- Constructing an argument with evidence
- Recognising perspective and that accounts differ

Give me:

- The comment, naming which of these the evidence supports
- The difference between a student who recounts and one who argues
- A next step for a student with strong recall and weak source handling

Where the subject matter is contested or sensitive, keep the comment about the student's reasoning, not about the positions they took.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Is it commenting on reasoning, or on views?
- Does your evidence cover source work at all?

RC-022**Write an arts comment about process, technique and reflection**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

The finished piece is not the whole of the learning.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Write a [GRADE] [ART FORM] report comment.

Evidence: [PROCESS, TECHNIQUE, FINISHED WORK, REFLECTION – no names]

Distinguish:

- Process – development, iteration, responding to feedback
- Technique – the specific skills demonstrated
- Reflection – can they talk about choices and why they made them

Give me:

- The comment, naming which the evidence supports
- Language for a student whose technique is developing but whose process is strong, that does not read as consolation
- A next step tied to a specific technique or process, not to "creativity"

Do not comment on talent, flair, or natural ability. Comment on what was done and what was learned.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Does the developing-technique version read as consolation?
- Any talent language left?

RC-023**Write a physical education comment using observable skill evidence**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Comment on the learning, not on the body.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Write a [GRADE] physical education report comment.

Evidence: [OBSERVED SKILLS, DECISION-MAKING, PARTICIPATION IN LEARNING – no names]

Rules – these matter more than the wording:

- Comment on skill, technique, tactical decisions and application of learning
- Say nothing about a student's body, size, shape, weight, speed relative to peers, or fitness as a personal quality
- Say nothing about natural athleticism or talent
- Do not use participation as a proxy for learning
- A student with limited mobility or a medical restriction must be reportable on the same terms, on what they demonstrated

Give me the comment, and a version for a student whose physical performance is limited but whose understanding and decision-making are strong.

Flag any phrase in this that could read as a comment on the child rather than the learning.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Read it as the child. Is any of it about their body?
- Would it work for a student with a restriction?

RC-024**Audit subject-specific terminology for accuracy and family clarity**

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

The words are correct and the family has no idea what they mean.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Audit the subject terminology in these [GRADE] [SUBJECT] comments.

For each term:

- Is it used accurately
- Would a family outside education understand it
- Does it mean something different in everyday English – flag those especially
- Could it be replaced without losing precision, and what is the replacement

Then tell me:

- Which terms to keep and gloss in place, because precision matters
- Which to replace outright
- Any term used inconsistently across the set
- Anything that sounds more serious to a family than I intend, or less

COMMENTS:

[PASTE THEM]

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- The "sounds more serious than intended" flag matters most. Act on it.
- Is your terminology consistent across the whole set?

BULK DRAFTS FROM EVIDENCE

RC-025**Create distinct comment drafts from a fictional evidence table**

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Testing your evidence format before you use it on a real class.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Create a worked example of bulk comment drafting for [GRADE] [SUBJECT].

Invent a fictional evidence table for 6 students – label them Student A to F and state clearly that they are fabricated. Include a range: strong, secure, approaching, inconsistent, limited evidence, and one where the assessment and classroom evidence disagree.

Then draft a comment for each.

Give me:

- The fictional table
- The 6 comments
- For each, which column of the table produced which clause
- The evidence format that made drafting easiest, so I know what to record during term

This is a template test, not real reporting. Do not present the fictional students as real.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Does the recommended evidence format match what you can realistically collect?
- Are the six genuinely different in shape?

RC-026**Generate bulk comments without mixing one learner's evidence with another**

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Thirty comments in one pass, and nothing may cross between them.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Draft report comments from this evidence table for [GRADE] [SUBJECT].

[PASTE YOUR TABLE – use initials or Student A, B, C. No full names.]

Rules – the first is the one that matters:

- Every clause in a comment must come from that student's own row. Never carry a detail, a phrase or an achievement from one row into another
- If a row is thin, write a shorter comment. Do not borrow to fill it
- Vary structure and openings across the set
- Mark any clause you could not source to the row

Give me the comments, and afterwards a checklist: for each student, the row facts used and any facts unused.

Then flag any two comments similar enough that a family comparing them would notice.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Check the used-facts list against your table, row by row.
- This is where evidence leaks between students. Do not skip this check.

RC-027**Vary sentence structure while preserving every supplied fact**

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Thirty accurate comments that do not read as one comment thirty times.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Rewrite these [GRADE] [SUBJECT] comments so they vary in structure, without changing a single fact.

Give me:

- Each comment rewritten
- A note confirming every fact from the original is present in the rewrite
- Anything I should check because the rewording shifted the emphasis
- The list of opening words used across the whole set, so I can see none repeats

Rules:

- No fact added, removed, softened or strengthened
- Vary sentence length as well as opening – thirty comments of identical rhythm
read as generated even when the words differ
- Keep every next step exactly as demanding as it was

COMMENTS:

[PASTE THEM]

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Spot-check three rewrites against the originals for changed emphasis.
- Do the openings genuinely differ?

RC-028**Audit a bulk comment set for duplicates, contradictions and evidence leakage**

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

The final pass before thirty comments go on thirty permanent records.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Audit this set of [GRADE] [SUBJECT] report comments against the evidence table.

Check for:

- Any detail appearing in a comment that belongs to a different student's row
- Comments similar enough that a family comparing two would notice
- Any comment contradicting its own evidence row
- Any claim not sourced to the table at all
- Any placeholder left unfilled
- Any comment about effort, behaviour or personality rather than learning
- Repeated opening words or repeated closing sentences

Report leakage first and separately. That is the error that does real damage.

EVIDENCE TABLE: [PASTE IT]

COMMENTS: [PASTE THEM]

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Verify every leakage claim against your table yourself.
- Search for unfilled placeholders one more time.

tone and rewriting

RC-003**Rewrite a comment for clarity and fairness**

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

You know what you mean. This makes it survivable for a family to read.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Rewrite this [GRADE] [SUBJECT] report comment so it is honest but not deflating.

Keep every fact. Do not soften it into meaninglessness – a family must still understand there is a concern and what happens next.

Give me three versions: gentle, direct, and firm.

For each, tell me:

- What changed from my original
- What a family would take away
- What the student would take away, if they read it

Then tell me which version fits what I described, and flag anything in my original that is a judgement rather than an observation.

COMMENT:

[PASTE IT]

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Are all the facts still present in the version you pick?
- Read it as the student. Would you keep going after reading it?

RC-029**Replace harsh or vague judgments with verified learning evidence**

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

The comment says something about the child that the evidence does not.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Rewrite this [GRADE] [SUBJECT] comment, replacing judgement with evidence.

COMMENT: [PASTE IT]

EVIDENCE: [PASTE WHAT YOU ACTUALLY HAVE]

For each judgement in the original:

- Quote it
- Say what it claims about the student
- Say whether my evidence supports it
- Replace it with what the evidence actually shows

Pay particular attention to: lazy, careless, unmotivated, does not try, capable but, could do better, disruptive, immature, and anything about attitude.

If a judgement is unsupported, do not soften it – remove it. A gently worded unsupported claim is still an unsupported claim on a permanent record.

Then tell me what the comment says once every unsupported claim is gone.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- If little is left, that is the finding. Gather evidence rather than rewording.
- Any attitude language surviving?

RC-030**Shorten a report comment without removing the material concern**

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Over the limit, and the concern is the part that must not go.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Shorten this [GRADE] [SUBJECT] comment to [NUMBER] characters or [NUMBER] words.

COMMENT: [PASTE IT]

Rules for what goes first:

1. Hedging, adverbs and repetition
2. The second example, if there are two
3. Restatement of the strength

What must survive, in order:

1. The concern, stated plainly
2. The next step
3. One piece of evidence

Give me the shortened version, the count, and a list of what you removed.

Then tell me whether the shortened version still conveys the concern with the same weight. If it does not, say so – going over the limit and asking for an exception is better than a comment that no longer says what I meant.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Does the shorter version still land the concern?
- Verify the count yourself.

Chapter 7 — Classroom Management and SEL

25 PROMPTS

Most behaviour problems are routine problems wearing a disguise. These prompts work on the structures — how a transition runs, what you say in the first ten seconds, how a conversation gets repaired afterwards — rather than on the student.

WHAT'S IN HERE

GROUP	PROMPTS	USE WHEN
Routines and transitions	6	The same four minutes lost, every day
Behaviour reset support	5	It went wrong; you want it back
Restorative conversations	4	Repair, not punishment
Social-emotional learning	4	Building it into normal lessons
Morning meetings	3	Openings a shy student can join
Seating and grouping	3	Who sits where, on purpose

WORTH KNOWING BEFORE YOU START

This chapter has the firmest limit in the book. If a situation involves harm, abuse, or immediate danger, stop and follow your school's safeguarding procedure. Do not work it through with an AI tool. Nothing here is a substitute for that process, and several prompts are written to say so and stop.

Focus on the behaviour and the repair. Nothing here should produce a judgement about a child's character, home life or motivation.

A restorative conversation is not a forced apology. If a draft demands one, change it — several prompts rule it out explicitly.

Keep in-the-moment scripts under fifteen words. Anything longer becomes an audience.

ROUTINES AND TRANSITIONS

CM-001

Design and teach a classroom routine

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

The same four minutes disappear every day at the same point.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Design a routine for [WHAT – entry, packing up, handing work in, moving to the carpet] in [GRADE].

Class size: [NUMBER]. Room: [DESCRIBE].

What currently happens: [DESCRIBE THE MESS]

Give me:

- The routine as a sequence of steps, one action per step
- The exact words I say to start it, under 10 seconds
- The signal that tells me everyone has finished
- How I teach it in the first week: what I model, what they practise, what I correct
- What I do on day 20 when it starts to slip

Do not build in a reward, a points system, or a competition. The routine should work because it is clear, not because it is incentivised.

Keep it to steps a [GRADE] student can hold in their head.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Can a student hold all the steps at once? Cut one if not.
- Would these words sound like you saying them?

CM-003**Teach an efficient entry routine with an immediate learning start**

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

The first five minutes are the ones you never get back.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Design an entry routine for [GRADE] [SUBJECT] where learning starts before I have finished the register.

Constraints: [DESCRIBE – do they queue outside, arrive from different lessons, need equipment handed out]

Give me:

- What is on the board or on desks before they arrive
- What a student does in their first 60 seconds without being told
- What I do during that time
- How a late arrival joins without disrupting or being announced
- What I do about the student who arrives with nothing

Do not make the opening task new content – it must be startable by a student who missed the last lesson.

Tell me what to change if my room is entered through a single narrow door.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Could a student who missed yesterday still start?
- Does the late arrival keep their dignity?

CM-004**Create a calm transition between whole-group and independent work**

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

The moment the noise doubles and half the class stops working.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Design the transition from whole-group teaching to independent work in [GRADE] [SUBJECT].

Give me:

- The exact words, under 15 seconds, one instruction at a time
- The order things happen in – instructions before materials, always
- How students know what to do if they are stuck in the first minute, without queuing at my desk
- What I do in the first 90 seconds, and where I stand
- The signal for a student who needs me, that does not involve a raised hand held for four minutes

A [GRADE] class will do the first thing you say and forget the rest. Write accordingly.

Then tell me the single most common reason this transition fails.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Is each instruction one action?
- Are materials handed out after the instructions, not during?

CM-005**Build a materials routine that reduces waiting and lost equipment**

Grades K-2, 3-5, 6-8

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Handing out and collecting eats more time than anyone admits.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Design a materials routine for [GRADE] [SUBJECT].

What gets distributed: [LIST IT]

Class size: [NUMBER]. Layout: [DESCRIBE]

Give me:

- How materials get to students without me walking to every desk
- Who does what, and how those jobs rotate so they are not a status
- The collection routine, and how I know instantly what is missing
- What happens when something is missing, that does not turn into an investigation
- What I do about the student who never has a pen, without making it a public event

Do not build a system that requires students to pay, replace, or be publicly recorded as having lost something.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Is the no-pen student handled quietly?
- Do the jobs rotate, or become a privilege?

CM-006**Plan a dismissal routine that protects safety and learning time**

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

The last four minutes, which are also the least safe four minutes.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Design a dismissal routine for [GRADE].

Context: [WHERE THEY GO NEXT, WHETHER THEY COLLECT BAGS, CORRIDOR OR PLAYGROUND]

Give me:

- When packing up starts, and why not earlier
- The order students leave in, and how that is decided fairly
- The 30-second closing that means the lesson ends rather than stops
- What I do if the bell goes mid-sentence
- How I hold back one student for a word without the class registering it as trouble

I will check anything about supervision, corridors or leaving the site against my school's own procedures.

Do not use leaving early as a reward, or leaving last as a consequence.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Check supervision arrangements against your school's policy.
- Would holding one student back be noticed by the class?

CM-007**Audit a routine using timing, participation and independence evidence**

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

The routine exists. You are not sure it is earning its place.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Audit this [GRADE] routine: [DESCRIBE IT]

What actually happens: [DESCRIBE, INCLUDING HOW LONG IT TAKES]

Tell me:

- Where the time actually goes, step by step
- Which step needs me, and whether it should
- Where students wait with nothing to do
- Whether a student who joined this term would know what to do
- Whether it depends on my presence, my voice, or my mood on the day
- Whether any part singles a student out

Then tell me:

- The one step to remove
- Whether this routine is worth its time at all

Be blunt about a routine that has become habit rather than function.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Time it honestly next lesson before deciding.
- Does it work when you are tired? That is the real test.

BEHAVIOUR RESET SUPPORT

CM-008**Create a brief private behaviour-reset conversation**

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Something needs saying, and it must not become a performance.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Prepare a brief private conversation with a [GRADE] student about a classroom behaviour.

What happened, observably: [DESCRIBE THE BEHAVIOUR – not the student]

What I want: [THE SPECIFIC CHANGE]

Give me:

- What I say in the moment, under 15 words, with no audience
- What I say one-to-one afterwards – opening, the point, the ask
- One question that gives the student a chance to say something I do not know
- How I close so the student can return without a face to save
- Three things NOT to say, and why each makes it worse

Rules:

- Address the behaviour and its effect, never the character
- Do not ask a student to explain themselves in front of others
- Do not require an apology
- Do not speculate about home, mood, or what is going on for them

If what I described suggests harm, danger or a safeguarding concern, stop and tell me to follow my school's process instead.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Is the in-the-moment line short enough to say without a pause?
- Is anything here about the child rather than what they did?

CM-009**Write neutral redirection language for a recurring disruption**

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

The twelfth time today, and your tone is starting to show.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Write redirection language for this recurring [GRADE] classroom behaviour:

[DESCRIBE IT – what happens, how often, in what part of the lesson]

Give me:

- Four redirections, escalating in directness, each under 12 words
- A non-verbal option for the first level
- The exact wording that names the expected action rather than the problem – "pen in your hand" rather than "stop fiddling"
- What I say the fifth time in one lesson, that is not the fourth said louder
- The point at which continuing to redirect is the wrong response, and what replaces it

Rules: no sarcasm, no rhetorical questions, no comparisons to other students, no public countdowns, and nothing that requires the student to respond verbally in front of the class.

Then tell me what the behaviour might be communicating that redirection cannot address.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Say them aloud. Any sarcasm you did not intend?
- Do they name the wanted action rather than the problem?

CM-010**Plan a re-entry routine after a learner leaves the classroom**

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

They come back, and how that goes decides the rest of the lesson.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Plan how a [GRADE] student returns to the classroom after leaving it.

Context: [WHY THEY LEFT, HOW LONG, WHERE THEY WENT]

Give me:

- What I say as they come in, under 10 words, that does not restart the incident
- How they rejoin the work without needing a long explanation
- When the conversation about what happened takes place – not now
- What the rest of the class sees, and how I keep it unremarkable
- What I do if they return still upset

Rules:

- Re-entry is not the moment for consequences or a conversation about behaviour
- Do not require the student to apologise before rejoining
- Do not have them stand at the door waiting for permission in front of everyone

I will follow my school's procedures for anything involving where a student went and who supervised them.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Does re-entry stay separate from the conversation?
- Would the class notice anything?

CM-011**Create a reset menu that preserves dignity and instructional access**

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Options a student can take before things escalate.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Build a short menu of reset options for [GRADE] students who need a moment.

Room and supervision constraints: [DESCRIBE]

Give me:

- 4-5 options, from smallest to largest – a change of position, a task with hands, a short walk with a purpose
- How a student takes one without asking in front of the class
- How each keeps the student in the room and in the lesson where possible
- What each is not: not a reward, not a punishment, not time out
- How the student returns to work afterwards

Rules:

- Nothing that removes access to the learning
- Nothing visible enough to mark a student out
- Nothing requiring supervision I do not have
- Nothing that can be earned or lost

Then tell me which option is most likely to be misused, and how to handle that without withdrawing it from everyone.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Does any option cost the student the lesson?
- Can a student take one privately?

CM-012**Audit a response plan for escalation, shame and inconsistent expectations**

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Before the plan is in place for a term.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Audit this [GRADE] behaviour response plan: [PASTE OR DESCRIBE IT]

Tell me:

- Where a step escalates rather than de-escalates
- Anything that makes a student's behaviour visible to the class – a chart, a name on the board, a public warning, a colour change
- Anywhere the response depends on my mood, energy, or how the day has gone
- Where the same behaviour would get different responses from different students, and why that might be happening
- Anything that removes learning as a consequence
- Whether there is a route back for a student who has had a bad day

Then tell me the single step most likely to make a situation worse, and what replaces it.

Be direct about anything that shames a child, whatever it is called.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Is anything public that should be private?
- Is there a genuine route back?

RESTORATIVE CONVERSATIONS

CM-002**Prepare a restorative conversation**

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Something happened between students, and it needs repair rather than a verdict.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Prepare a restorative conversation between [GRADE] students.

What happened, observably: [DESCRIBE – no names, no interpretation]

Who is involved: [ROLES ONLY, e.g. two students, one affected]

Give me:

- How I open, so nobody arrives expecting a trial
- Neutral questions for each person, in order
- The question that moves it from what happened to what it did to someone
- How the affected student says what they need, without being put on the spot
- How we close, whether or not agreement is reached

Rules – these are not optional:

- No forced apology, and no requirement that anyone accept one
- No requirement that anyone disclose feelings they do not want to share
- Either student may stop, and stopping is not a failure
- I do not determine guilt in this conversation

If what I described involves harm, abuse, bullying or immediate danger, stop and tell me to follow my school's safeguarding process instead of continuing.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- If it flagged safeguarding, stop and use your school's process.
- Is any question really an accusation?

CM-013**Create questions that explore impact, needs and possible repair**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Questions that open something rather than extract a confession.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Write restorative questions for a [GRADE] situation: [DESCRIBE IT NEUTRALLY]

Give me four sets:

- What happened – factual, without inviting justification
- Who was affected and how
- What is needed now
- What could be different next time

Rules:

- No question beginning "why did you", which produces defence, not reflection
- No question a student can only answer by admitting fault
- Every question answerable by a student who is upset, embarrassed, or monosyllabic
- Include the shorter version of each for a student who cannot manage the full question

Then tell me:

- Which question most often gets a shrug, and what to do with a shrug
- Which question I should skip if the student is not ready

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Any "why did you" left?
- Could an embarrassed student answer these?

CM-014**Build a voluntary repair agreement with a scheduled follow-up**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Something agreed, that both students actually agreed to.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Build a repair agreement after a restorative conversation between [GRADE] students.

What was discussed: [SUMMARISE – no names]

What was offered: [BY WHOM]

Give me:

- The agreement in the students' own kind of language, not mine
- What each person will do, only where they offered it
- A follow-up date, and who initiates it
- What happens if it does not hold – which is not a punishment
- How the agreement ends, so it is not open forever

Rules:

- Nothing in it that was not voluntarily offered
- No apology as a required item
- No public element – nothing performed in front of the class
- The affected student is not required to forgive, accept, or be satisfied

If either student was not genuinely willing, say so and tell me the agreement should not be written.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Was every item genuinely offered, not extracted?
- Is there an end date?

CM-015**Audit a restorative script for coercion, blame and safeguarding limits**

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Restorative language can carry coercion inside it.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Audit this restorative script or plan: [PASTE IT]

Tell me:

- Any question that assigns blame while appearing neutral, quoted
- Anywhere a student is required to apologise, forgive, or say they are fine
- Anywhere disclosure of feelings is compulsory rather than invited
- Anything that would be unsafe if there is a power imbalance between the students
- Anywhere the process continues when a student clearly wants to stop
- Anything that belongs in a safeguarding process rather than a classroom conversation

Then tell me:

- The single most coercive element, however gently worded
- The point at which this should stop being handled by me

Be direct. A script that pressures a child into performing reconciliation is worse than no script.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Act on the power-imbalance flag before running the conversation.
- Where it says stop being yours to handle — take that to your school.

SOCIAL-EMOTIONAL LEARNING

CM-016**Create an age-appropriate lesson on naming and managing emotions**

Grades K-2, 3-5, 6-8

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Teaching the vocabulary before it is needed in an argument.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Plan a [MINUTES]-minute [GRADE] lesson on naming and managing emotions.

Give me:

- The emotion vocabulary appropriate for [GRADE], and the words to leave out because they are clinical rather than everyday
- A way in that uses fictional characters or scenarios, never students' own experiences
- One strategy taught properly rather than five mentioned
- Practice using the strategy on a fictional situation
- What students take away that they could use tomorrow

Rules:

- No student is asked to share a personal feeling or experience
- Nothing that asks students to rate, chart or report their own mood publicly
- No language that pathologises ordinary feelings
- This is teaching vocabulary and strategy, not therapy

If any part of what I have asked for belongs with a counsellor rather than a teacher, say so.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Is any student required to disclose anything?
- Is the vocabulary everyday, not clinical?

CM-017**Teach a practical strategy for pausing before responding**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

One strategy, taught well enough to be used under pressure.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Teach [GRADE] students one strategy for pausing before responding.

Give me:

- The strategy, in three steps a student can remember when upset
- Why it works, in language a [GRADE] student accepts – not neuroscience
- How I teach it when nobody is upset, which is the only time it can be taught
- Three fictional scenarios to practise on
- The cue I use in the moment that is not "calm down"
- What I say when a student uses it and it does not work

Rules:

- Nothing requiring a student to breathe in a particular way in front of others
- Nothing visible enough to mark a student out as needing it
- The strategy belongs to the student, not to me – they choose to use it

Then tell me what this strategy cannot do, so I do not expect too much of it.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Can a student use it without anyone noticing?
- Is "why it works" believable to a student, or a lecture?

CM-018**Build an empathy activity without requiring personal disclosure**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Empathy work that does not turn into an exercise in exposure.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Design a [MINUTES]-minute [GRADE] empathy activity.

Topic or context: [DESCRIBE]

Rules – these define the task:

- Students work with fictional characters or scenarios only
- No student is asked to share a personal experience, feeling, or family circumstance
- No activity where students imagine being someone with a specific identity, disability or circumstance as a simulation
- Nothing that could expose a student's own situation by how they respond

Give me:

- The activity
- The fictional scenarios, written so no student would recognise themselves
- The discussion questions
- What I do if a student volunteers something personal anyway
- The closing that does not require anyone to have been moved

Then tell me what could go wrong with this activity in a class where I do not know everyone's circumstances.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Could a scenario be someone's actual life? Change it if so.
- Do you know what to do if a student discloses?

CM-019**Audit an SEL activity for privacy, culture and clinical overreach**

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

SEL work goes wrong quietly, and usually with good intentions.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Audit this [GRADE] SEL activity: [PASTE OR DESCRIBE IT]

Tell me:

- Anywhere a student is asked or nudged to disclose something personal
- Anywhere a response would reveal a student's home, family or circumstances to the class
- Anything assuming a family shape, faith, culture or way of expressing emotion
- Anything crossing from teaching into counselling or therapy
- Any use of clinical language a teacher should not be applying to a child
- Anything a student could not opt out of without being noticed

Then tell me:

- The single element most likely to harm a child who is already struggling
- Whether this activity should be run by me at all

Be direct. Good intentions are not the standard here.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- If it says this is not yours to run, take that seriously.
- Can a student opt out invisibly?

MORNING MEETINGS

CM-020**Plan a 10-minute morning meeting with a clear community goal**

Grades K-2, 3-5

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Ten minutes that set the day, rather than filling it.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Plan a 10-minute morning meeting for [GRADE].

This week's focus: [WHAT YOU WANT TO BUILD]

Give me:

- A greeting that works for [NUMBER] students in the time available
- A share prompt about something students choose, never about home or feelings
- A short activity, 2-3 minutes, needing no materials
- The closing line that sends them into the day
- Realistic timing – greetings take longer than anyone plans

Rules:

- Every part is joinable by a student who does not want to speak
- No prompt about family, home, weekend, holidays, possessions or feelings
- No student is the focus unless they chose to be

Then tell me what to cut when the meeting has to be six minutes.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Does any prompt touch home, money, or family?
- Can a silent student take part?

CM-021**Create inclusive check-in options that do not force disclosure**

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Checking in without requiring anyone to perform being fine.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Design check-in options for a [GRADE] class that do not require disclosure.

Give me:

- 4 ways a student can check in, including at least one entirely non-verbal and
 - one that involves no signal at all
- What I actually learn from each, honestly
- How a student signals they want to talk later, privately
- What I do with what I notice, and what I do not do with it
- How I avoid a check-in becoming a public mood display

Rules:

- No mood charts, colour cards, or anything the class can see
- No question requiring a student to say they are not fine in order to be heard
- Opting out must be invisible and unremarkable
- I am not collecting data on children's emotional states

Then tell me what a check-in cannot tell me, so I do not read too much into it.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Is opting out genuinely invisible?
- What are you doing with what you notice? Decide before you start.

CM-022**Build a weekly morning-meeting sequence without repetitive prompts**

Grades K-2, 3-5

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Five days that build, rather than five days of the same question.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Plan five morning meetings for [GRADE], 10 minutes each, threaded around [THEME].

Give me:

- Five days, each with a greeting, a share prompt, and a short activity
- How Friday connects back to Monday, so the week is one thing
- Prompts that vary in kind, not just in wording – one about noticing, one about choosing, one about explaining
- The day most likely to fall flat, and the backup for it

Rules:

- No prompt about home, family, feelings, possessions or weekend activities
- Nothing requiring a student to speak
- No prompt that a student who has had a bad morning cannot answer

Then give me the three prompts I could reuse in any week, so I always have something ready.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Do the five genuinely differ in kind?
- Could a student having a bad morning answer each one?

SEATING AND GROUPING

CM-023**Create a seating plan from classroom access and learning constraints**

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

A plan built on needs, not on who annoys whom.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Build a seating plan for [GRADE] [SUBJECT].

Room: [LAYOUT, NUMBER OF DESKS, WHERE THE BOARD AND DOOR ARE]

Class size: [NUMBER]

Constraints, described as needs not students: [e.g. two students need to be near the front for vision, one needs a clear exit route, three should not be adjacent]

Give me:

- The plan, described so I could draw it
- Why each constrained position is where it is
- How the plan looks unremarkable, so no seat reads as a designation
- What I say when a student asks why they are sitting there
- What changes when two students are absent

Rules:

- No student named or described in a way that identifies them
- No seat that is visibly the special seat, the front-for-behaviour seat, or the isolation seat
- Everyone can see the board and reach the door

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Does any seat read as a designation?
- Can everyone genuinely see and exit?

CM-024**Build a transparent regrouping plan using temporary learning evidence**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Groups that change, and are seen to change.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Build a regrouping plan for [GRADE] [SUBJECT] based on this evidence:

[DESCRIBE THE LEARNING PATTERNS – no names]

Give me:

- The groups, defined by what they are working on rather than by level
- What I tell students about why groups change, in one sentence
- How often groups change, and what triggers a change
- How a student moves group without it being an event
- The evidence I gather that would move someone

Rules:

- Groups are named after the work, not after a level or an animal that everyone decodes within a week
- No group is permanent, and the plan states when they end
- No student stays in the same group all term by default

Then tell me the sign that these have quietly become fixed ability groups.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Is there a stated end date?
- Would the class decode the group names?

CM-025**Audit seating and grouping decisions for labels, isolation and accessibility**

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Before the arrangement becomes permanent by inertia.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Audit this [GRADE] seating and grouping arrangement: [DESCRIBE IT]

Tell me:

- Whether any seat or group is identifiable as being for a particular kind of student
- Whether anyone is isolated – physically apart, or the only one of something
- Whether every student can see, hear, reach the door, and access materials
- Whether the arrangement is doing what it was set up to do, or is just habit
- Whether any student has been in the same position or group all term
- What a student in the least desirable position would say about it

Then tell me:

- The one change that would most improve it
- Whether this arrangement should be rebuilt from scratch

Be direct about anything that isolates a child, however practical the reason.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Answer the "least desirable position" question honestly yourself.
- When did you last change it?

Chapter 8 — Teacher Admin and Paperwork

25 PROMPTS

None of this is teaching, and all of it takes teaching time. These prompts clear the paperwork quickly and in a professional register — brief, specific, and asking plainly for what you need.

WHAT'S IN HERE

GROUP	PROMPTS	USE WHEN
Staff emails	5	Short, clear, with the ask up front
Agendas and minutes	4	Meetings that end on time and produce something
Professional goals	4	Measurable, and actually achievable
Observation reflections	3	After a lesson observation
Field trip logistics	3	The list you will forget one item from
Clubs and duty plans	3	Running the thing outside lessons
Grants and proposals	3	Asking for money or resources

WORTH KNOWING BEFORE YOU START

Put the ask in the first line. Everything after it is context, and half your readers will not reach it.

Do not promise a student outcome in a professional goal. "I will do X and gather evidence Y" is a goal you control; "scores will rise 10%" is not.

Anything with a date, an approval, a cost or a policy reference — check it against the real document. The model will produce a plausible date.

Ask for the one-line hallway version alongside the email. You will use it more.

STAFF EMAILS

AD-003**Write a concise staff email with one clear action**All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

An email that gets done rather than filed.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Write a staff email.

To: [ROLE OR TEAM]

What I need: [THE ONE ACTION]

By when: [DATE]

Context they need: [ONLY WHAT IS NECESSARY]

Rules:

- The ask is in the first line. Context comes after
- One action only. If I have given you two, tell me to send two emails
- Under 120 words
- Subject line under 8 words, naming the action and the deadline
- No apology for emailing, no "just", no "sorry to bother"
- Say what happens if they do nothing, if that matters

Give me the email, the subject line, and a one-line version for a corridor conversation.

Use only the facts I supplied. Do not invent a date, a policy or a reason.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Is the ask genuinely in the first line?
- Is it one action?

AD-004**Turn rough notes into a professional colleague update**

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Bullet points in your head, something readable out.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Turn these notes into an update for [WHO]:

[PASTE YOUR ROUGH NOTES]

Give me:

- The update, organised so the most important thing is first
- What is a decision, what is progress, and what is a problem – kept separate
- Anything in my notes that is my opinion rather than fact, marked as such
- Anything I have implied but not stated, so I can decide whether to state it
- Under 200 words

Do not add anything I did not write. If a note is too cryptic to expand, quote it back and ask.

Then tell me what a reader would still not know after reading this.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Has anything been added that you did not write?
- Is opinion clearly separated from fact?

AD-005**Draft a meeting request with purpose, preparation and time limit**

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

So the meeting is short and the right people come prepared.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Write a meeting request.

Purpose: [WHAT MUST BE DECIDED OR RESOLVED]

Who: [ROLES]

Length: [MINUTES]

Options: [TWO SPECIFIC DATES AND TIMES]

Give me:

- The request, with the purpose in one sentence
- What each person should bring or think about beforehand
- The decision the meeting exists to reach
- What happens if we cannot meet – the asynchronous alternative
- Under 120 words

Rules:

- Say plainly whether attendance is required or optional
- Do not schedule a meeting for something that could be an email – if that is what I have described, say so
- No agenda longer than the meeting can hold

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- If it said this could be an email, it probably could.
- Is the preparation realistic for people's actual week?

AD-006**Write a follow-up email that separates decisions from open questions**

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

So nobody leaves the meeting with a different version of what happened.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Write a follow-up after a meeting.

What was discussed: [YOUR NOTES]

What was decided: [LIST IT]

What was not resolved: [LIST IT]

Structure it in three clearly separated parts:

- Decisions, each with who and by when
- Open questions, each with who will resolve it and by when
- Everything else, briefly

Rules:

- Record only decisions actually made. If something was discussed but not decided, it goes in open questions, not decisions
- Every item has a named owner. No unowned items
- No decision attributed to a person who did not make it
- Invite correction

Flag anything in my notes that I have recorded as agreed but reads as unresolved.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Has anything moved from "discussed" to "decided"?
- Does every item have an owner?

AD-007**Audit a staff email for tone, recipients, dates and unnecessary detail**

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Before you send it to twelve people, one of whom will forward it.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Audit this staff email: [PASTE IT]

Tell me:

- Whether the ask is clear, single, and in the first two lines
- Every date, name and figure I should verify before sending
- Anything that reads as blame, frustration or passive aggression, quoted
- Anyone on the recipient list who does not need this, and anyone missing
- What could be cut with no loss
- Anything that would read badly if forwarded to someone I did not intend

Then tell me the one sentence I should delete, and whether this needs to be an email at all.

Be direct about tone. I wrote it and cannot hear it any more.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- The tone flags: trust them over your own ear.
- Verify every date and figure.

AGENDAS AND MINUTES

AD-008**Build a timed agenda around decisions that must be made**

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

A meeting that ends on time because it was built to.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Build an agenda for a [MINUTES]-minute meeting.

Purpose: [WHAT MUST BE DECIDED]

Attendees: [ROLES]

Items I have been given: [LIST THEM]

Give me:

- The agenda with minutes per item, adding up to less than the meeting length
- Each item labelled: decision, discussion, or information
- Information items grouped at the end or moved to writing entirely
- The decision that matters most, placed first
- What we do if we run out of time on item one
- What each attendee needs before the meeting

Rules:

- No item without a stated outcome
- If the items cannot fit honestly, say which to drop rather than compressing everything
- Anything purely informational should not be in a meeting; say so

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Do the minutes add up with slack, or exactly?
- Are the information items really necessary in the room?

AD-001**Turn notes into accountable meeting minutes**

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Minutes people can act on rather than skim.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Turn these meeting notes into minutes:

[PASTE YOUR NOTES]

Structure:

- Decisions: what was decided, who decided, effective when
- Actions: what, who, by when
- Open: what was raised and not resolved, and who is picking it up
- Noted: information shared, briefly

Rules:

- Record only what my notes contain. Do not smooth a disagreement into consensus, and do not record agreement that was not stated
- Every action has a named owner and a date. If my notes lack one, write [OWNER?] or [DATE?] rather than assigning it yourself
- Where people disagreed, record that they disagreed
- No interpretation of anyone's tone or intent

Then list every point where my notes were ambiguous about who agreed to what.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Fill in every [OWNER?] and [DATE?] before circulating.
- Has any disagreement been smoothed over?

AD-009**Convert discussion notes into decisions, actions and a parking lot**

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

An hour of discussion, and you need to know what actually came of it.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Sort these discussion notes into three piles:

[PASTE THE NOTES]

- DECIDED: settled, with who and when
- ACTION: someone will do something, with who and by when
- PARKING LOT: raised, not resolved, and not being carried forward now

Rules:

- A thing is only DECIDED if my notes show it was decided. Being discussed at length is not deciding
- Nothing in ACTION without an owner. Mark [OWNER?] where my notes do not say
- The parking lot needs a date to revisit, or it needs deleting – say which

Then tell me:

- What we spent the most time on, and which pile it ended in
- Anything that will come back at the next meeting because it was not settled

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Is anything in DECIDED that was only discussed?
- Does the parking lot have a revisit date, or should it be dropped?

AD-010**Audit meeting minutes for invented consensus, owners or deadlines**

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Minutes become the record. Getting them wrong is expensive later.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Audit these minutes against my notes.

MINUTES: [PASTE THEM]

MY NOTES: [PASTE THEM]

Tell me:

- Anything recorded as agreed that my notes do not support
- Any owner assigned who did not accept the action
- Any deadline that appears in the minutes but not in my notes
- Anywhere disagreement has been smoothed into consensus
- Anything attributed to a person who did not say it
- Anything in my notes that is missing from the minutes

Quote each one.

Then tell me which entry would cause the most trouble in three months if it is wrong.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Anything it flagged as invented: remove it, do not soften it.
- Circulate for correction before treating these as final.

PROFESSIONAL GOALS

AD-002**Draft a measurable professional growth goal**

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

A goal you control, not a wish about your students.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Draft a professional growth goal for this year.

What I want to get better at: [DESCRIBE IT]

Why: [WHAT PROMPTED THIS]

Time available: [BE HONEST]

Rules – the first one matters most:

- The goal must be about what I will do, not what students will achieve. I do not control their outcomes and should not be held to them
- No percentage improvements in student scores
- The action must fit the time I stated. If it does not, say so
- The evidence must be something I can actually gather while teaching full time

Give me:

- The goal in one sentence
- The specific actions, with when
- The evidence I collect, and how long collecting it takes each week
- What would make me revise this goal mid-year

Then tell me what this goal will cost me, honestly.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Is it about your practice or students' scores?
- Could you actually gather that evidence in a normal week?

AD-011**Turn baseline evidence into a realistic semester action plan**

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Starting from where you actually are.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Build a semester action plan from this baseline:

Where I am now: [DESCRIBE, WITH EVIDENCE]

Where I want to be: [DESCRIBE]

Constraints: [TIME, TEACHING LOAD, ANYTHING ELSE]

Give me:

- A plan across [NUMBER] weeks, with what happens in which week
- The two weeks in the term where this will not happen – reports, exams, whatever I told you – and how the plan survives them
- What I stop doing to make room. A plan that adds without removing will fail
- The smallest version of this plan, for a bad term

Do not plan for an ideal term. Plan for a normal one.

Then tell me the week this plan is most likely to be abandoned, and what would keep it alive.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Does it say what you stop doing? If not, it will not survive.
- Is the smallest version still worth doing?

AD-012**Create leading and outcome indicators for a teaching goal**

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Knowing in week four whether this is working.

COPY THIS PROMPT

For this professional goal – [PASTE IT] – give me indicators.

Two kinds, kept separate:

- Leading indicators: things I can see within weeks, about what I am doing
- Outcome indicators: things that would show it made a difference, later

For each:

- What it is, specifically
- How I measure it, in under five minutes a week
- What a good early sign looks like, and what a bad one looks like

Rules:

- Leading indicators must be about my practice, not student results
- Outcome indicators may involve students, but state honestly how much I can attribute to this goal – probably less than I would like
- No indicator requiring extra data collection I will not sustain

Then tell me which indicator I will stop tracking first, and whether that matters.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Which will you stop tracking? Be honest, then drop it now.
- Is the attribution claim honest?

AD-013**Build midpoint decision rules for revising a professional goal**

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Deciding in advance what would make you change course.

COPY THIS PROMPT

For this goal – [PASTE IT] – write midpoint decision rules.

Give me:

- What I check at the midpoint, and how long that check takes
- Three outcomes: on track, partly working, not working
- For each, the specific decision – continue, adjust how, or stop
- What "not working" actually looks like, described concretely enough that I cannot talk myself out of it
- What I would need to see to justify abandoning this goal entirely

Rules:

- Write the rules now, so the midpoint me cannot rationalise
- Abandoning a goal that is not working is a legitimate outcome. Say so
- Do not build in a rule that always produces "keep going"

Then tell me which outcome I am most likely to misread as success.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Is "not working" described concretely enough to be undeniable?
- Would you accept stopping as an outcome?

OBSERVATION REFLECTIONS

AD-014**Write an evidence-based reflection after a classroom observation**

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

After the observation, before the meeting.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Help me write a reflection after a classroom observation.

What happened in the lesson: [DESCRIBE – no student names]

Feedback I received: [PASTE OR SUMMARISE]

How I feel about it: [BE HONEST – this is for my thinking, not the document]

Give me:

- The reflection, based on observable events rather than on how it felt
- Where I agree with the feedback, and why
- Where I do not, stated professionally with the evidence for my view
- What I genuinely do not know yet
- One thing I will do differently, and how I will know whether it helped

Rules:

- Do not simply agree with everything to be safe
- Do not be defensive either
- Keep my feelings out of the written version, but tell me if they are pointing
at something worth examining

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Does the disagreement read as professional or defensive?
- Is the "one thing" small enough to actually do?

AD-015**Separate observed events, interpretation and next action**

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Feedback that mixes what happened with what it meant.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Sort this observation feedback into three columns:

[PASTE THE FEEDBACK]

- OBSERVED: what actually happened in the room
- INTERPRETED: what the observer concluded from it
- RECOMMENDED: what they suggest

For each interpretation, tell me:

- Which observation supports it
- Whether another interpretation would fit the same observation
- Whether the observer had context they may not have had – a prior lesson, a student's circumstances, what I was deliberately doing

Then tell me:

- Which recommendation follows clearly from the evidence
- Which rests on an interpretation I could reasonably question
- The one recommendation to act on first

Do not dismiss feedback because an alternative interpretation exists.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Are you questioning an interpretation, or avoiding the feedback?
- Does the observer's missing context actually change it?

AD-016**Turn observer feedback into one measurable instructional experiment**

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Six suggestions, and you have room for one.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Turn this feedback into one small experiment I can run:

[PASTE THE FEEDBACK]

Constraints: [TIME, CLASSES, WHAT IS ALREADY ON]

Give me:

- The single change, small enough to try in a fortnight
- Exactly what I do differently, described so I could do it tomorrow
- What I look for to know whether it worked
- How long before I judge it – long enough to be fair, short enough to matter
- What I do if it makes things worse

Rules:

- One change. If I try three I will not know which did anything
- It must be something I can sustain, not something that works because I am paying it unusual attention
- Say which of the suggestions I am setting aside, so I know what I am not doing

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Is it genuinely one change?
- Could you sustain it after the novelty wears off?

FIELD TRIP LOGISTICS

AD-017**Build a field-trip planning checklist from official requirements**

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

The list you will otherwise forget one item from.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Build a planning checklist for a trip.

Destination and activity: [DESCRIBE]

Date, group size, year group: [STATE THEM]

My school's stated requirements: [PASTE OR SUMMARISE WHAT YOU HAVE]

Give me a checklist ordered by deadline, working backwards from the trip date, covering: approvals, consent, transport, staffing, medical and dietary information, money, communication, and what happens on the day.

Rules:

- Use only the requirements I supplied. Do not state a ratio, a form, a timescale or a policy I did not give you
- Where a standard requirement is missing from what I supplied, list it as [CHECK WITH SCHOOL] rather than filling it in
- Mark which items are legal or policy requirements versus good practice, only where I told you which is which

I will verify every item against my school's own procedures before relying on this.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Take every [CHECK WITH SCHOOL] to the person who actually knows.
- Do not treat any stated ratio or timescale as authoritative.

AD-018**Create a trip-day schedule with owners, counts and contingency fields**

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

The single sheet every adult carries on the day.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Build a trip-day schedule.

Timings: [WHAT YOU KNOW – departure, arrival, activities, return]

Adults: [HOW MANY, AND THEIR ROLES]

Students: [NUMBER, GROUPS]

Give me a one-page schedule with:

- Each time slot, what happens, and which adult is responsible
- Head-count points, with a box to write the number and the time
- Where each group is at any given moment
- Blank fields for contact numbers and the meeting point
- What to do if the group is running late – who is told, in what order
- What to do if a student is separated from the group

Rules:

- Every slot has a named responsible adult. No unowned time
- Leave [BLANK] for anything I did not give you, including emergency contacts
- It must be readable on paper, on a windy pavement, folded in a pocket

I will check the emergency and safeguarding elements against my school's procedures.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Fill every [BLANK], especially contacts.
- Print it. It has to work without a phone.

AD-019**Audit a field-trip draft for permissions, access, safety and unknowns**

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Before it goes to whoever approves trips.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Audit this trip plan: [PASTE IT]

Tell me:

- What is missing that a trip plan normally contains
- Every consent, medical or emergency element that appears incomplete
- Anything assuming a student can walk far, climb stairs, tolerate noise, eat a standard meal, swim, or afford a cost
- What happens to a student whose family cannot pay, and whether that is stated
- Anything stated as a school or venue policy that I should verify
- What is not planned for: bad weather, a late coach, a student who is unwell, a group returning after the school day ends
- Every unknown I have written as though it were settled

List the accessibility gaps separately. A trip a student cannot join is a problem to solve before booking, not on the day.

I will verify all safeguarding and consent requirements with my school.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Solve the accessibility gaps before booking, not after.
- Every "verify" flag goes to the person who approves trips.

CLUBS AND DUTY PLANS

AD-020**Create a club launch plan with purpose, routines and supervision fields**

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Starting something that will still be running in March.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Plan the launch of a [CLUB OR ACTIVITY] for [GRADE] students.

When and where: [DETAILS]

How many students: [NUMBER OR LIMIT]

What I have: [SPACE, EQUIPMENT, OTHER ADULTS]

Give me:

- The purpose in one sentence, so I can say no to things that are not it
- The first three sessions, in enough detail to run them
- The routines: arriving, starting, packing up, leaving
- How students join, and what happens if more want to come than I can take
- What I need to confirm before the first session – supervision, permission, access – as [CONFIRM] items rather than assumptions
- What makes this sustainable in week ten, when the novelty is gone

Do not state a supervision requirement or ratio. Mark it [CONFIRM WITH SCHOOL].

Then tell me the most likely reason this club stops running.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Every [CONFIRM] before session one, not after.
- Is the week-ten answer honest?

AD-021**Build a fair duty rota from supplied availability and policy**

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

A rota nobody can reasonably call unfair.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Build a duty rota.

Duties to cover: [LIST THEM, WITH TIMES]

People available: [LIST, WITH THEIR CONSTRAINTS AND ANY EXEMPTIONS]

Period: [HOW MANY WEEKS]

Rules I have been given: [PASTE THEM]

Give me:

- The rota, week by week
- A count of duties per person, so the distribution is visible
- Who has the least desirable slots, and how those rotate
- What happens when someone is absent
- Anything I asked for that cannot be covered with the people available

Rules:

- Use only the availability and constraints I gave you
- Do not assume anyone can cover outside their stated availability
- If the rota cannot be filled fairly, say so plainly rather than producing an uneven one that looks complete

Then tell me who will feel hardest done by, and whether they would be right.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Check the duty counts yourself.
- If it says it cannot be filled fairly, take that upward.

AD-022**Audit a club or duty plan for gaps, overload and unclear responsibility**

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Before it runs and the gap becomes obvious.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Audit this club or duty plan: [PASTE IT]

Tell me:

- Any time period with no named adult responsible
- Any handover point where responsibility is ambiguous – arriving, leaving, between activities
- Anyone carrying noticeably more than others
- What happens when a person is absent, and whether that is planned or assumed
- Anything requiring an adult to be in two places
- Anything assuming a student can stay late, get home afterwards, or afford to take part

Then tell me:

- The single riskiest gap
- Whether this plan works on a week when two people are ill

I will confirm all supervision requirements with my school.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Close the riskiest gap before it runs.
- Does it survive two absences?

GRANTS AND PROPOSALS

AD-023**Turn a verified classroom need into a concise proposal outline**

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Asking for something, briefly and credibly.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Outline a proposal for [WHAT YOU WANT].

The need, with evidence: [DESCRIBE WHAT YOU HAVE OBSERVED OR RECORDED]

Who I am asking: [ROLE OR BODY]

Rough cost: [IF KNOWN]

Give me an outline covering:

- The need, in two sentences, evidenced
- What I am asking for, specifically
- What changes if it is funded, stated as what becomes possible rather than what will be achieved
- What happens if it is not
- How I would know afterwards whether it was worth it

Rules:

- Use only the evidence I gave you. Do not invent a statistic, a comparison school, or a research finding
- No claim about improved outcomes that I cannot support
- If my evidence is too thin to justify the ask, say so and tell me what to gather first

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- If it said the evidence is thin, gather more before asking.
- Any statistic in there that you did not supply? Remove it.

AD-024**Build a grant budget narrative from supplied costs and restrictions**

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Explaining the numbers so they are believed.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Write the budget narrative for a proposal.

Costs: [ITEMISE WHAT YOU HAVE, WITH SOURCES]

Restrictions: [WHAT THE FUNDER WILL AND WILL NOT COVER]

Total requested: [AMOUNT]

Give me:

- A narrative explaining each cost and why it is necessary
- The arithmetic, shown, so a reader can check it
- Anything that falls outside the stated restrictions, flagged
- What is ongoing versus one-off, and who covers the ongoing part
- What I would cut first if only part is funded

Rules:

- Use only the figures I supplied. Do not estimate, round, or add a contingency
 - I did not state
- Check every total and state that you have
- Where a cost is missing that a funder would expect, list it as missing

I will verify all figures and the funder's terms myself before submitting.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Re-add every column yourself.
- Check the restrictions against the funder's actual terms.

AD-025**Audit a proposal for unsupported claims, missing evidence and compliance**

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

The last read before it is submitted.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Audit this proposal: [PASTE IT]

Requirements I was given: [PASTE THEM, IF ANY]

Tell me:

- Every claim not supported by evidence in the proposal itself, quoted
- Every statistic, research reference or comparison – and whether I supplied it
or it appeared from nowhere
- Any promise about outcomes I cannot guarantee
- Any requirement from the guidance that the proposal does not address
- Any arithmetic error
- Anything a sceptical reader would ask that this does not answer

Then tell me:

- The weakest claim, which is where it will be challenged
- Whether the ask is proportionate to the evidence

Do not soften this. A proposal declined for overreach is worse than one that asked for less.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Any statistic you did not supply: delete it, do not verify it later.
- Re-check the arithmetic yourself.

Chapter 9 — Subject Deep Dives

15 PROMPTS

The rest of the book works across subjects. This chapter does not — each prompt is built around how one subject actually behaves, and what goes wrong when a general tool is pointed at it.

WHAT'S IN HERE

GROUP	PROMPTS	USE WHEN
Mathematics	3	Concepts, representations, error analysis
Science	3	Investigations, evidence, explanation
English language arts	3	Close reading, writing, revision
Social studies	3	Sources, corroboration, claims
Arts, PE and electives	3	The subjects general tools ignore

WORTH KNOWING BEFORE YOU START

Verify everything factual in this chapter. Historical dates, scientific values, quotations from texts, worked calculations — this is where a confident wrong answer does the most damage, because it looks exactly like a right one.

For science, never accept invented data. Predicted patterns and measured results are different things, and these prompts keep them apart.

For social studies, ask for the contested question rather than the settled summary. That is where the thinking is.

For arts and PE, be specific about equipment and space. Generic plans assume a room you do not have.

MATHEMATICS**SD-001****Create a concept-first mathematics explanation**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

They can do the procedure and have no idea what it means.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Explain [MATHEMATICAL CONCEPT] for [GRADE], starting from what it means rather than how to do it.

Give me:

- What the concept actually is, in a sentence I could say to a [GRADE] student
- Why it exists – the problem it solves that could not be solved without it
- A concrete situation where the idea is visible before any notation appears
- Where the notation comes in, and what each part of it is standing for
- The moment students typically stop understanding and start following steps, and the question I ask to catch that
- Two misconceptions this explanation should prevent, and one it might create

Do not open with a definition or a rule. Do not use "just" or "simply" anywhere.

Check every calculation you use. Flag anything you are not certain of rather than stating it confidently.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Work every example yourself.
- Does the notation arrive after the need for it?
- Any "just" or "simply" left?

SD-003**Connect concrete, visual and symbolic mathematics representations**

Grades K-2, 3-5, 6-8

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Three representations that students never connect to each other.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Show [MATHEMATICAL IDEA] for [GRADE] across three representations.

Give me:

- Concrete: what students physically handle, using ordinary classroom materials
- Visual: what they draw, described so I can draw it on a board
- Symbolic: the notation

Then the part that matters most:

- The explicit link between each pair – what in the drawing corresponds to what
in the objects, and what in the notation corresponds to what in the drawing
- The exact question I ask to make a student point at the correspondence
- Where the concrete representation breaks down, because every model has a limit
- What a student who can do all three separately but has not connected them looks like

Do not present the three as three ways to get the answer. They are one idea seen three times.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Does the concrete model use materials you actually have?
- Is the limit of the model named honestly?

SD-004**Build a mathematics error-analysis lesson with verified solutions**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Finding the mistake teaches more than avoiding it — if the mistakes are real.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Build an error-analysis lesson on [TOPIC] for [GRADE] mathematics.

Use fictional students – Student A, Student B – and invented work. State clearly that the work is fabricated for teaching.

Give me four pieces of work:

- A single conceptual error carried consistently through
- A correct method with an arithmetic slip
- A method that works here but fails in the general case
- A correct solution using an unusual but valid approach

For each: the work, what went wrong, where exactly, and what the student was thinking. Then the answer students should give.

Then verify: recompute every piece of work and every correct answer, show your working, and state explicitly that you have checked. Flag anything you are not certain about.

The fourth one must be genuinely correct. An "unusual" method that is actually wrong would teach the opposite of what I want.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Recompute all four yourself, especially the "correct but unusual" one.
- Does the method-that-fails-in-general genuinely work for this case?

SCIENCE

SD-002**Design an evidence-based science investigation**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Practical work where the thinking is in the design, not the worksheet.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Design an investigation into [QUESTION] for [GRADE] science.

Equipment I actually have: [LIST]

Room: [DESCRIBE – benches, sinks, space, class size]

Time: [MINUTES]

Give me:

- The question in student words, answerable with what I have
- What is varied, what is measured, and what must be held constant – with the ones students usually forget
- How many measurements, and why repeats matter here specifically
- The recording table, laid out exactly
- What students do with anomalous results, which is not "ignore them"
- The safety points specific to this activity, as instructions rather than warnings
- What we can and cannot conclude from this design

Do not invent results. Do not tell students what they should find.

Flag anything needing equipment I did not list. Do not assume a fume hood, gas, or running water unless I said so.

I will check all safety guidance against my school's own procedures.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Check every safety point against your school's policy, not this draft.
- Does it tell students what to expect? Remove that if so.

SD-008**Build a claim-evidence-reasoning task from supplied observations**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Students who write conclusions that are really restatements.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Build a claim-evidence-reasoning task for [GRADE] science.

The observations students will have: [DESCRIBE OR PASTE THE DATA]

Give me:

- The question their claim answers
- What a strong claim looks like, and what a restatement of the data looks like
 - students confuse these constantly
- What counts as evidence here, and which observations are relevant
- The reasoning step: the scientific idea linking evidence to claim, which is the part almost always missing
- A model response, and a response with good evidence and no reasoning
- Sentence frames for the reasoning step only

Use only the observations I supplied. Do not add data, and do not assume what the results were if I have not told you.

Then tell me what a student could legitimately claim that I might mark wrong.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Has it added any data you did not give it?
- Consider the legitimate-but-unexpected claim before you mark.

SD-009**Audit a science explanation for causation, uncertainty and safety**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Explanations that are nearly right, which is the hardest kind to spot.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Audit this [GRADE] science explanation: [PASTE IT]

Tell me:

- Anywhere correlation is presented as causation
- Anywhere a hedged scientific claim has been stated as certain
- Any factual or numerical error – recompute anything computable and show your working
- Any simplification that will become a misconception students must later unlearn
- Whether the level of certainty matches what the evidence supports
- Any safety-relevant statement that is incomplete or wrong
- Any anthropomorphism that will cause trouble later – atoms that "want", organisms that "try to"

For each, quote it and give the correction.

Where you cannot verify something independently, say so rather than agreeing with it by default.

I will check safety statements against my school's procedures.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Verify any correction it offers. It can be wrong about being right.
- The unlearn-later simplifications: decide which you accept.

ENGLISH LANGUAGE ARTS

SD-005**Build a close-reading lesson from an authorized supplied text**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

One text, worked properly, in its own words.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Build a close-reading lesson on the text below for [GRADE], [MINUTES] minutes.

Use only the text I paste. Do not quote from memory, do not add lines, and do not reference a version of this text other than the one here.

Give me:

- A first read with a single narrow purpose
- A second read that goes deeper, not wider
- Four text-dependent questions from literal to inferential, each with the exact lines that answer it – quoted from my text
- The two or three places students will get stuck, quoted
- The vocabulary that genuinely blocks meaning, with a gloss
- A writing or discussion task using evidence from the text

If a question cannot be answered from the text alone, say so and cut it.

TEXT:

[PASTE THE FULL TEXT – only text I am permitted to use]

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Check every quoted line appears in your text, exactly.
- Is the second read deeper, or just more?

SD-006**Create an evidence-based writing task with a clear mentor model**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Students who cannot picture what you are asking for.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Create a writing task for [GRADE] on [TOPIC OR TEXT].

Give me:

- The task, with the command word doing real work and the audience named
- A mentor model of the exact kind I am asking for, written at [GRADE] level – good but achievable, not a polished adult piece
- An annotation of the model: what each part does, and why it is there
- What a competent piece that misses the point looks like
- The success criteria, drawn from the model
- One sentence frame for the move students find hardest here

Rules:

- The model must be original, not a real published piece
- It should be a piece a strong student in this class could plausibly write
- Do not make it impressive at the cost of being imitable

Then tell me the risk of giving a model at all, and how to reduce it.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Could a strong student in your class write this? If not, lower it.
- Is the model original?

SD-007**Design a revision lesson that separates ideas, organization and conventions**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Revision that is currently just checking spelling.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Design a revision lesson for [GRADE] writing on [TASK].

Separate three passes, in this order, and say why the order matters:

- Ideas: is there enough here, and is it the right thing
- Organisation: is it in an order a reader can follow
- Conventions: sentences, punctuation, spelling

Give me:

- What students do in each pass, and how long each gets
- One specific question per pass, not "does it make sense"
- Why conventions come last, in words I can say to a student who wants to fix spelling first
- What I do about the student who changes nothing
- A partner step, with what the partner is looking for – one thing only

Rules:

- Do not let conventions dominate. If the ideas are thin, spelling is not the problem
- Revision means changing something, not recopying it neatly

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Does the ideas pass get real time, or a token minute?
- Is the partner looking for one thing, or everything?

SOCIAL STUDIES

SD-010**Create a source-analysis lesson using origin, purpose and context**

Grades 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Students who read a source as information rather than as evidence.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Build a source-analysis lesson for [GRADE] on this source: [PASTE IT, WITH ITS ATTRIBUTION]

Use only the source and attribution I supplied. Do not add historical facts, dates or context I have not given you – if context is needed, say what I should supply.

Give me:

- Questions on origin: who made this, when, and how we know
- Questions on purpose: who was it for, what was it trying to do
- Questions on context: what was happening that this responds to
- What this source is good evidence for, and what it is not
- The most common misreading of a source like this
- A task where students state a claim this source supports, with its limits

Do not treat the source as simply true or simply biased. Both are ways of not reading it.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Supply the context it asked for rather than letting it fill in.
- Check any date or fact it did use against a real reference.

SD-011**Build a corroboration task with multiple supplied perspectives**

Grades 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Two accounts that disagree, which is where history actually is.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Build a corroboration task for [GRADE] using these sources:

[PASTE EACH SOURCE WITH ITS ATTRIBUTION]

Use only what I supplied. Do not add a source, and do not supply facts from outside these documents.

Give me:

- What the sources agree on
- Where they disagree, quoted precisely
- Questions that make students account for the disagreement rather than pick a winner
- What would help resolve it, and whether we have it
- A task where students write what can be said with confidence, what is contested, and what is unknown
- Sentence frames for writing about contested claims

Do not resolve the disagreement for students, and do not present one source as the reliable one unless the sources themselves support that.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Check every quotation against your source text.
- Has it quietly picked a winner?

SD-012**Design a historical claim task that distinguishes evidence from interpretation**

Grades 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

The difference between what happened and what it meant.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Design a task for [GRADE] on [HISTORICAL QUESTION] using the evidence below.

EVIDENCE: [PASTE WHAT STUDENTS WILL HAVE]

Give me:

- The question, genuinely open – one where historians differ
- What the evidence establishes as fact
- What is interpretation, including interpretations I might hold without noticing
- Two defensible answers to the question, each with its strongest evidence
- The weakest point in each
- A task where students argue one and acknowledge the other

Rules:

- Use only the supplied evidence. Do not add facts, dates or events
- Do not present the interpretation most common in textbooks as the neutral one
- Where the topic touches on people alive today or on contested identity, keep the task about the reasoning and the evidence

Then tell me which interpretation students will find easier, and why that may not mean it is better supported.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Verify every date and event it used.
- Are both interpretations genuinely defensible?

ARTS, PE AND ELECTIVES

SD-013**Create a skill-development lesson with modelling, practice and reflection**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Skill teaching where practice is deliberate rather than just repeated.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Plan a [MINUTES]-minute [SUBJECT] lesson teaching [SKILL] to [GRADE].

Space and equipment I actually have: [DESCRIBE]

Class size: [NUMBER]

Give me:

- The skill broken into its components, and which one to work on today
- What I model, and the specific thing students should watch for – not "watch me do it"
- Practice designed so students get many attempts, not many queues
- The one cue I repeat, under five words
- What good and not-yet look like, observably, so students can self-check
- A reflection question about the process, not about enjoyment

Rules:

- No component that needs equipment I did not list
- Practice must give every student attempts, not one student demonstrating while the rest watch
- Do not comment on natural ability anywhere

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Count the actual attempts each student gets. Is it enough?
- Is the cue short enough to shout across a hall?

SD-014**Adapt a performance task for space, equipment and physical access**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

The task assumes a room, equipment or a body that not everyone has.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Adapt this [SUBJECT] task for my actual conditions: [PASTE THE TASK]

What I have: [SPACE, EQUIPMENT, TIME, CLASS SIZE]

Access needs, described as needs not students: [e.g. one student uses a wheelchair, one has limited grip strength, one cannot be in a loud space]

Give me:

- The adapted task, achieving the same learning
- What changes, and what deliberately does not
- How a student meets the objective by a different route, with the same standing
 - not a lesser version
- How the adaptation is unremarkable, so nobody is marked out by doing it
- What I assess, which must be identical across routes

Rules:

- Adapt the task, not the expectation
- No adaptation that removes a student from the group activity
- Do not name or describe any student

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Would a student feel singled out by the adapted route?
- Is what you assess genuinely the same?

SD-015**Build an observable process rubric for an arts, PE or elective task**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Marking the learning rather than the finished performance.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Build a rubric for [TASK] in [SUBJECT] for [GRADE], assessing [OBJECTIVE].

Weight process and technique over the finished product, and say how you have weighted them.

Rules – these define the rubric:

- Every criterion must be observable in what the student does, not inferred from what they produce
- Nothing about talent, flair, natural ability, or how much they seem to enjoy it
- Nothing about a student's body, size, or physical attributes
- Nothing requiring equipment, coaching or resources outside school
- Nothing rewarding a student who arrived already able

Give me:

- The criteria, with descriptors at proficient
- What each looks like for a student who has improved a great deal but is still behind, and how that is credited
- One criterion I could observe during the lesson rather than after it

Then tell me which criterion would advantage a student with outside coaching, and how to reduce that.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Which criterion favours the already-trained student? Fix it.
- Is anything here about the body rather than the learning?

Chapter 10 — Multi-step Workflows

12 WORKFLOWS

Everything so far does one job. This chapter chains them: the output of step one becomes the input to step two, and by the end you have a finished piece of work rather than a pile of drafts.

WHAT'S IN HERE

ID	WORKFLOW	YOU END UP WITH
WF-001	Standard to complete unit	A sequenced unit with checkpoints
WF-002	Mixed-ability lesson pack	One lesson, three routes, one discussion
WF-003	Incident to parent conversation	A documented, careful conversation
WF-004	Scores to report comments	A whole class of comments, traced to evidence
WF-005	Standard to aligned assessment	A paper with a blueprint and a checked key
WF-006	Emergency substitute pack	A day another adult can teach
WF-007	Project launch pack	Brief, milestones and rubric that agree
WF-008	Parent conference pack	Cards for a whole evening of conferences
WF-009	Evidence to intervention-plan draft	A draft to take to your school's process
WF-010	Field-trip planning pack	A plan with its gaps named
WF-011	Weekly teacher admin pack	A week of paperwork cleared
WF-012	Class data reflection	What the data supports, and what it does not

HOW TO RUN THESE

Keep each workflow in one conversation. Steps say things like "using the unit plan above" — that only works if the plan is above. Do not start a fresh chat between steps.

Read each step's output before running the next one. An error in step one becomes the foundation of steps two through six. This is the one place in the book where skipping the check is genuinely expensive.

If a step asks you something, answer it. Pushing on with a gap makes every later step guess.

Stop between steps whenever you want. A workflow is a suggested route, not a contract. Several of these end by telling you what they could not do — that is the workflow working, not failing.

WF-001**Standard to complete unit**

Replaces roughly 3-4 hours

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

A standard, a number of lessons, and nothing in between.

COPY THIS PROMPT

We are going to build a unit together, one step at a time. Do only the step I ask for, then stop and wait. Do not run ahead.

Context for all steps:

- Grade and subject: [GRADE] [SUBJECT]
- Standard, exact wording: [PASTE IT]
- Number of lessons: [NUMBER]
- Already taught: [PRIOR LEARNING]
- Constraints: [TIME, MATERIALS, ANYTHING ELSE]

STEP 1 – Unpack the standard.

Break it into 4-6 things students must be able to do, each teachable and checkable in one lesson. Use only my wording; do not add requirements from other versions of this standard. Say what part of the standard your list does not cover.

Then stop. I will read it and confirm before you continue.

THEN, ONE AT A TIME**COPY THIS PROMPT**

STEP 2 – Design the final assessment.

Using the components from Step 1, design what students do at the end to show they have met the standard. Give me the task, what a strong response contains, and what a response looks like when the knowledge is there but the skill is not.

Then stop.

COPY THIS PROMPT

STEP 3 – Sequence the lessons.

Working backward from the Step 2 assessment, sequence the [NUMBER] lessons. One line per lesson on what it does and why it sits there. Mark which lessons are load-bearing and which could be cut if we lose time. Then stop.

COPY THIS PROMPT

STEP 4 – Place the checkpoints.

Add a checkpoint roughly every third lesson. For each: the actual question, what a poor result would look like, and the specific reteach for the next lesson. No pass percentages. Then stop.

COPY THIS PROMPT

STEP 5 – Review the whole thing.

Audit what we have built: gaps, repetition, whether demand rises, and the two lessons most likely to go wrong. Be blunt. Tell me what you would change.

BEFORE YOU USE IT

- Check the Step 1 unpacking against the standard's real wording before Step 2.
- If Step 5 finds a real problem, go back rather than teaching around it.

WF-002**Mixed-ability lesson pack**

Replaces roughly 2 hours

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

One lesson that works for a class with a wide spread.

COPY THIS PROMPT

We are building a differentiated lesson in steps. Do one step at a time and stop after each.

Context:

- Grade and subject: [GRADE] [SUBJECT]
- Objective: [OBJECTIVE]
- Lesson length: [MINUTES]. Class size: [NUMBER]
- The spread, described as needs not students: [DESCRIBE]
- Materials: [LIST]

STEP 1 – Build the core lesson.

Plan the on-level lesson: opening, modelling, guided practice, independent work, exit ticket. Build it backward from what would show the objective was met. Then stop.

THEN, ONE AT A TIME**COPY THIS PROMPT**

STEP 2 – Add the two other routes.

From the Step 1 lesson, create a scaffolded route and an extension route. Same thinking, same materials, same finishing time. The extension must be harder thinking, not more items. Name the routes neutrally, in no order that reads as a ranking. Then stop.

COPY THIS PROMPT

STEP 3 – Write the shared check.

One check every student completes, regardless of route, from which I cannot tell which route they took. Give me what each level of response looks like. Then stop.

COPY THIS PROMPT

STEP 4 – Plan the closing discussion.

A discussion that works for all three routes without anyone announcing which they did. An opening question everyone can answer, the order I take contributions, and the shared conclusion. Then stop.

COPY THIS PROMPT

STEP 5 – Check the dignity.

Review all three routes. Would the class work out which is the lesser one?

Does

every route have something worth sharing? Tell me the single change that would most equalise them.

BEFORE YOU USE IT

- Answer Step 5 honestly yourself before teaching it.
- Could you tell from the shared check which route a student took?

WF-003**Incident to parent conversation**

Replaces roughly 1 hour, and a lot of worrying

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Something happened, and the conversation has to be right.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Help me prepare a family conversation, one step at a time. Stop after each step.

Before we start: if what I describe involves harm, abuse, or immediate danger, stop and tell me to follow my school's safeguarding process instead of continuing this workflow.

Context:

- Grade: [GRADE]
- What happened, observably, with dates: [DESCRIBE. No student names.]
- What I have already done: [LIST IT]
- What I want from the conversation: [STATE IT]

STEP 1 – Separate fact from interpretation.

Go through what I wrote. List what I observed, and separately what I have concluded or assumed. Flag anything I have written as fact that is actually inference. Then stop.

THEN, ONE AT A TIME**COPY THIS PROMPT**

STEP 2 – Build the factual account.

Using only the observed facts from Step 1, write the account I would give the family: what happened, when, what I did. No character description, no cause, no speculation about home. Then stop.

COPY THIS PROMPT

STEP 3 – Prepare the conversation.

My opening under 30 seconds, the facts in the order I say them, and what I say when the family disagrees, becomes upset, or says it is the school's responsibility. Include the point where I stop and listen. Then stop.

COPY THIS PROMPT

STEP 4 – Write the follow-up.

A summary email recording what was discussed and agreed, with owners and dates.

Record disagreement as disagreement. Invite correction. Then stop.

COPY THIS PROMPT

STEP 5 – Check it.

Review everything: any claim I cannot evidence, anywhere a family could reasonably read blame, anything that belongs in a safeguarding process rather than a conversation with me. Tell me the one sentence to cut.

BEFORE YOU USE IT

- If Step 1 flags inference as fact, fix it before Step 2.
- If any step raises safeguarding, stop and use your school's process.

WF-004**Scores to report comments**

Replaces roughly 3 hours

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Report season, a whole class, one sitting.

COPY THIS PROMPT

We are drafting report comments in steps. Stop after each step.

Context:

- Grade and subject: [GRADE] [SUBJECT]
- Character limit: [NUMBER, or none]
- Evidence table: [PASTE IT. Use initials or Student A, B, C. No full names.]

STEP 1 – Check my evidence.

Look at my table. Tell me which rows have enough to write a meaningful comment,

which are thin, and which are so thin that I should write a shorter comment rather than a padded one. Do not draft anything yet. Then stop.

THEN, ONE AT A TIME**COPY THIS PROMPT**

STEP 2 – Build the comment structure.

A structure: strength with evidence, then one next step. Give me 6 openings and

6 closings I can rotate so thirty comments do not read as one. Then stop.

COPY THIS PROMPT

STEP 3 – Draft the comments.

Draft one comment per row. Every clause must come from that student's own row. Never carry a detail, phrase or achievement from one row into another. For a thin row, write shorter – do not borrow to fill it. Mark any clause you could not source. Then stop.

COPY THIS PROMPT

STEP 4 – Check for leakage.

Go back over the drafts against the table. Report separately: any detail appearing in the wrong student's comment, any two comments similar enough that a family comparing them would notice, any claim not in the table. Then stop.

COPY THIS PROMPT

STEP 5 – Final pass.

Check every comment for: unfilled placeholders, fixed-ability language, comment on effort or personality rather than learning, promises about future performance, and repeated openings. List what needs my attention.

BEFORE YOU USE IT

error that does real damage.

- Verify Step 4's leakage findings against your table yourself. This is the
- Fill every placeholder before submitting.

WF-005**Standard to aligned assessment**

Replaces roughly 2-3 hours

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

A paper that tests what you taught, with a key you can trust.

COPY THIS PROMPT

We are building an assessment in steps. Stop after each.

Context:

- Grade and subject: [GRADE] [SUBJECT]
- Objectives or standard, exact wording: [PASTE THEM]
- Time available: [MINUTES]. Total marks: [NUMBER]
- What was actually taught: [LIST IT]

STEP 1 – Build the blueprint.

A table: each objective, marks allocated with a reason, the type of question that suits it, and how many questions. Say which objectives cannot be assessed in writing and should be assessed another way. Do not write questions yet. Then stop.

THEN, ONE AT A TIME**COPY THIS PROMPT**

STEP 2 – Write the questions.

Using the blueprint, write the paper. Marks shown per question. For any multiple choice, every wrong option must be a real misconception you can name. Then stop.

COPY THIS PROMPT

STEP 3 – Write the key.

A full worked key: answers, working, the most likely wrong answer for each and where it comes from. Check every calculation and show it. Flag anything you cannot verify independently rather than presenting it as checked. Then stop.

COPY THIS PROMPT

STEP 4 – Audit the paper.

Against the blueprint: does each question test what it should, is any wording ambiguous, is the reading demand higher than the subject demand, and does any question allow a second defensible answer? Then stop.

COPY THIS PROMPT

STEP 5 – Time it.

Estimate honestly how long a middling student needs, question by question.

Compare with the time I have. Tell me what to cut if it does not fit, and what evidence I lose by cutting it.

BEFORE YOU USE IT

- Work the entire key yourself. Step 3 flags what it doubts; check the rest too.
- Take Step 5's timing seriously. Papers always run long.

WF-006**Emergency substitute pack**

Replaces roughly 90 minutes, usually at 6am

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

You are ill, and someone else has your classes today.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Build me a substitute pack in steps. Stop after each. Keep it fast – I am writing this while unwell.

Context:

- Grade and subject: [GRADE] [SUBJECT]
- Periods to cover: [NUMBER], each [MINUTES]
- Where the class is up to: [TOPIC]
- What is in the room: [MATERIALS. Say if nothing can be printed.]

STEP 1 – Choose the work.

Propose work that is meaningful, needs no subject knowledge from the substitute, requires no preparation, and does not depend on knowing the class. Tell me why each choice survives a stranger teaching it. Then stop.

THEN, ONE AT A TIME**COPY THIS PROMPT**

STEP 2 – Write the student task.

Write it out in full, ready to photocopy or dictate, with everything students need on the page. Include the answer key. Then stop.

COPY THIS PROMPT

STEP 3 – Write the substitute directions.

Minute by minute. Exactly what goes on the board. What to say. What to do when students say we have done this, when someone finishes early, and when someone refuses. No step requiring subject knowledge. Then stop.

COPY THIS PROMPT

STEP 4 – Write the class note.

Three lines on what this class is like and what to watch for, without describing any individual student. Plus what to leave me a note about, and where work gets collected. Then stop.

COPY THIS PROMPT

STEP 5 – Check it.

Read the whole pack as someone who has never taught this subject and never met this class. Tell me every point where they would have to guess.

BEFORE YOU USE IT

- Fix every guess-point Step 5 finds. That is the whole value of this pack.
- Check the answer key, even at 6am.

WF-007**Project launch pack**

Replaces roughly 3 hours

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

A project where the brief, the milestones and the rubric actually agree.

COPY THIS PROMPT

We are building a project pack in steps. Stop after each.

Context:

- Grade and subject: [GRADE] [SUBJECT]
- Objective: [WHAT STUDENTS SHOULD BE ABLE TO DO]
- Duration: [WEEKS OR LESSONS]
- Constraints: [CLASS SIZE, RESOURCES, WHETHER GROUPS]

STEP 1 – Define the outcome.

The driving question and the final product. The question must be open enough to

sustain the work and narrow enough to finish. Be honest about scope: if the duration is not enough for this product, say so and propose one that fits.

Then

stop.

THEN, ONE AT A TIME**COPY THIS PROMPT**

STEP 2 – Write the student brief.

One page, written for students. What they are making, why, what it must contain with the learning listed first, what is up to them, and the three questions students will ask on day one, answered in advance. Then stop.

COPY THIS PROMPT

STEP 3 – Build the milestones.

One per week, each producing something I can look at in under two minutes per student or group. What on track and behind look like at each, and the specific intervention for behind. Then stop.

COPY THIS PROMPT

STEP 4 – Write the rubric.

Criteria drawn from the objective, not from the format. Most weight on thinking and subject learning; presentation as one small criterion. Nothing rewarding resources a student may not have at home. Then stop.

COPY THIS PROMPT

STEP 5 – Check the three agree.

Compare the brief, the milestones and the rubric. Does the rubric reward what the brief asks for? Do the milestones lead to it? Could a student follow the brief exactly and still score badly? Tell me every mismatch.

BEFORE YOU USE IT

- Step 5 is the point of this workflow. Fix every mismatch before handing it out.
- Could a beautiful project with weak thinking score well? Fix the rubric if so.

WF-008**Parent conference pack**

Replaces roughly 2-3 hours

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Twenty-four families in one evening, ten minutes each.

COPY THIS PROMPT

We are preparing conference cards in steps. Stop after each.

Context:

- Grade and subject: [GRADE] [SUBJECT]
- Minutes per family: [NUMBER]
- My notes: [PASTE THEM. Initials or Student A. No full names.]

STEP 1 – Sort my notes.

For each student, tell me what my notes support saying, and where they are too thin. Flag anywhere I have written an impression as though it were evidence. Do not draft cards yet. Then stop.

THEN, ONE AT A TIME**COPY THIS PROMPT**

STEP 2 – Build the card format.

Half a page I can scan while a family sits down: one strength with evidence, one growth area with evidence, one open question for the family, one thing they could do at home in under ten minutes needing no subject knowledge, and my opening and closing sentences. Then stop.

COPY THIS PROMPT

STEP 3 – Fill the cards.

One card per student, using only that student's notes. Never carry a detail between students. Where my notes are thin, write a shorter card and say what I should observe before the conference. Then stop.

COPY THIS PROMPT

STEP 4 – Prepare for the hard ones.

From my notes, identify which conversations are likely to be difficult. For each: my opening, what I say if the family disagrees, and the point where I say this needs a longer separate meeting. Then stop.

COPY THIS PROMPT

STEP 5 – Check the cards.

Any claim I cannot evidence, any suggestion assuming a family has money, internet, time, or subject knowledge, and any card that reads as a verdict rather than a conversation.

BEFORE YOU USE IT

- Fix anything Step 1 flags as impression before it reaches a card.
- Practise the Step 4 openings aloud once.

WF-009**Evidence to intervention-plan draft**

Replaces roughly 2 hours

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Preparing a draft to take into your school's process — not to act on alone.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Help me draft an intervention plan in steps. Stop after each.

Read this first: this is a draft to take into my school's own process. It is not a decision, a diagnosis, or a referral. If at any step the evidence points toward something requiring a specialist, a safeguarding response, or a formal assessment, say so and tell me to stop and use my school's process instead of continuing.

Context:

- Grade and subject: [GRADE] [SUBJECT]
- What I observe, with dates and frequency: [DESCRIBE. No names.]
- What I have already tried, and what happened: [LIST IT]
- What my school's process expects at this stage: [DESCRIBE IT, or say unknown]

STEP 1 – Sort the evidence.

Separate what I have observed from what I have concluded. Give me three possible explanations consistent with the observations, and what would distinguish them. Name no cause. Then stop.

THEN, ONE AT A TIME**COPY THIS PROMPT**

STEP 2 – Identify what I do not know.

List what I would need to observe or check to tell those explanations apart, and the quickest classroom way to find each out. Then stop.

COPY THIS PROMPT

STEP 3 – Draft the classroom actions.

Specific things I do in the classroom, each small enough to sustain. For each: what I do, how often, and what I record. Nothing requiring resources or staffing

I have not mentioned. Then stop.

COPY THIS PROMPT

STEP 4 – Set the review.

What I look at, when, and the three outcomes: working, partly working, not working. For each, the decision – including escalating to my school's process, which is a legitimate outcome and not a failure. Then stop.

COPY THIS PROMPT

STEP 5 – Check the draft.

Anywhere I have named a cause I cannot know, anywhere this reaches beyond what a class teacher should decide alone, and anything that belongs in my school's formal process now rather than after a review cycle.

BEFORE YOU USE IT

- Take this draft to your school's process. It is not a plan you own alone.
- If any step says stop and escalate, do that.

WF-010**Field-trip planning pack**

Replaces roughly 2 hours

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

A trip plan with its gaps named rather than filled in.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Build a trip planning pack in steps. Stop after each.

Read this first: do not state any ratio, form, timescale, insurance requirement or policy I have not given you. Where a standard requirement is missing from what I supply, write [CHECK WITH SCHOOL] rather than filling it in.

I will verify everything against my school's own procedures.

Context:

- Destination and activity: [DESCRIBE]
- Date, year group, number of students: [STATE THEM]
- Adults available: [NUMBER AND ROLES]
- My school's requirements as I understand them: [PASTE OR SUMMARISE]

STEP 1 – Build the backwards checklist.

Working back from the trip date: approvals, consent, transport, staffing, medical and dietary information, money, communication. Mark every item I did not supply as [CHECK WITH SCHOOL]. Then stop.

THEN, ONE AT A TIME**COPY THIS PROMPT**

STEP 2 – Check accessibility.

Go through the activity and the day. Anything assuming a student can walk far, climb, tolerate noise or crowds, eat a standard meal, or afford a cost. List these separately – a trip a student cannot join is a problem to solve before booking. Then stop.

COPY THIS PROMPT

STEP 3 – Build the day schedule.

One page for every adult: each time slot, the responsible adult by name, head count points with boxes to write the number and time, and blank fields for contacts and the meeting point. Then stop.

COPY THIS PROMPT

STEP 4 – Plan the contingencies.

Late coach, bad weather, a student unwell, a student separated from the group, a return after the school day ends. Who is told, in what order. Mark anything that depends on school procedure as [CHECK WITH SCHOOL]. Then stop.

COPY THIS PROMPT

STEP 5 – List the unknowns.

Everything in this pack I have written as settled that is actually assumed, and everything still marked [CHECK WITH SCHOOL], as one list I can take to whoever approves trips.

BEFORE YOU USE IT

- Step 5's list is what you take to the approver. Do not shorten it.
- Solve the accessibility gaps before booking.

WF-011**Weekly teacher admin pack**

Replaces roughly 90 minutes

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Friday afternoon, and the paperwork has stacked up.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Help me clear this week's admin in steps. Stop after each.

Here is everything, unsorted: [DUMP YOUR NOTES, EMAILS TO WRITE, MEETING NOTES, DEADLINES, THINGS YOU PROMISED SOMEONE. No student names.]

STEP 1 – Sort it.

Into four piles: needs an email, needs a decision from me, needs someone else, and can be dropped. For the drop pile, say why each can go. Tell me which item is most overdue and which has the largest consequence if missed – they are often not the same. Then stop.

THEN, ONE AT A TIME**COPY THIS PROMPT**

STEP 2 – Draft the emails.

For each item needing an email: the ask in the first line, under 120 words, one action each, with a subject line naming the action and deadline. Use only facts from my notes; mark anything I need to verify. Then stop.

COPY THIS PROMPT

STEP 3 – Turn the meeting notes into minutes.

Decisions, actions with owners and dates, and open items. Write [OWNER?] or [DATE?] where my notes do not say – do not assign either yourself. Then stop.

COPY THIS PROMPT

STEP 4 – Build next week's list.

What is genuinely due next week, ordered by deadline. Separately, what I have carried for more than two weeks – those need deciding or dropping, not carrying again. Then stop.

COPY THIS PROMPT

STEP 5 – Tell me what I am avoiding.

From everything I dumped, which item have I clearly been putting off, and what is the smallest first step on it.

BEFORE YOU USE IT

- Fill every [OWNER?] and [DATE?] before circulating minutes.
- Step 5 is usually right. Do the smallest step today.

WF-012**Class data reflection**

Replaces roughly 90 minutes

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

A set of results, and a decision to make about what to do next.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Help me read this class data in steps. Stop after each.

Context:

- Grade and subject: [GRADE] [SUBJECT]
- What the assessment covered: [DESCRIBE]
- The data: [PASTE IT – no student names]
- What I taught, and how: [DESCRIBE BRIEFLY]

STEP 1 – Describe what is there.

Only what the data shows. Patterns, spread, which items were missed most. No explanations yet, no conclusions about students. If the data is too thin to support a pattern, say so. Then stop.

THEN, ONE AT A TIME**COPY THIS PROMPT**

STEP 2 – Explain it, several ways.

For each main pattern, give me three possible explanations – including ones that are not about my teaching, and ones about the assessment itself rather than the learning. Then stop.

COPY THIS PROMPT

STEP 3 – Test the explanations.

For each, what evidence would confirm or rule it out, and how I would get that in a normal week. Tell me which explanation I am most likely to reach for without checking. Then stop.

COPY THIS PROMPT

STEP 4 – Decide the action.

Based on what the data actually supports: what I reteach, what I move on from, and what I gather more evidence on before deciding. For each, why. Then stop.

COPY THIS PROMPT

STEP 5 – Say what this cannot tell me.

What I would be over-reading if I drew it from this data, and what I should not conclude about any individual student from a single assessment.

BEFORE YOU USE IT

- Step 3 names your own bias. Sit with that one.
- Step 5 matters most. Do not carry an over-reading into a report comment.